The Editorial Page: Anna Hazare to Sonam Wangchuk, a tale of two fasts — and a democracy 10

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AS MONSOON SESSION BEGINS, PROTESTS ON STREETS OUTSIDE FIND ECHO IN BOTH HOUSES OF PARLIAMENT

Protesters storm heart of Delhi, police use lathis and tear gas to stop march

Delhi Police personnel disperse the protesters as they attempt to march towards the House, at Parliament Street, on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

CJP submits demands to Centre; protest will continue, say Wangchuk, Dipke

Pragynesh, Sakshi Chand, Devansh Mittal, Drishti Jain, Alok Singh, Tabshir Shams & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 20

TENS OF thousands of protesters demanding the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan took over the heart of Lutyens's Delhi on Monday, breaking through police barricades and attempting to march to Parliament on the first day of the Monsoon Session.

While the main group of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists were confined by police to the vicinity of Jantar Mantar, very large numbers — estimated to be 50,000 or more — of mostly young men and women challenged the security forces at dozens of locations across the New Delhi police district.

Police and anti-riot forces responded with lathicharge, tear gas, and water cannon

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Nadda meets CJP team, but Govt signals: Will listen, won't commit

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, July 20

AFTER NEARLY three weeks of protests at Jantar Mantar by the Cockroach Janta Party, headlined by the hunger strike of activist Sonam Wangchuk, the Government finally swung into action Monday, with Union Minister J P Nadda meeting CJP representatives.

Outlining the Government's approach, even as thousands of protesters marched towards Parliament demanding Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, a senior Minister told *The Indian Express* that the protesters have been given a hearing but there has been no commitment on their demands.

"The protest is over," he

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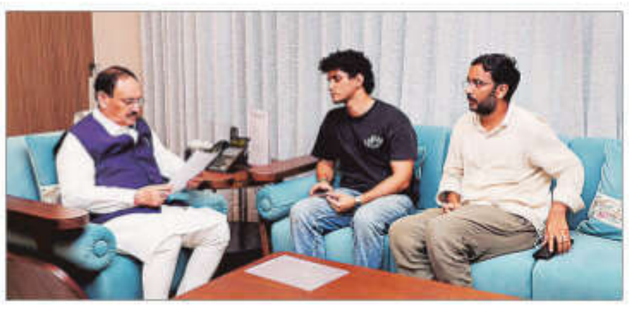

CJP members Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka with Union Health Minister J P Nadda in New Delhi, Monday. ANI

Opp backs protesters, sees chance in 'organic anger' against Govt

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, July 20

AS THE anger over paper leaks spilled onto the streets of central Delhi on Monday and led to pitched battles between the police and protesters demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, the Opposition targeted the Centre and called for a discussion on the matter in Parliament. The demand for Pradhan's resignation found an echo in both Houses, despite attempts by senior BJP leaders

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E. EXPLAINED

Opposition's hopes

In the current demonstrations, some Opposition leaders see an echo of the Anna Hazare movement. The BJP benefitted from Hazare's campaign against corruption, eventually unseating the Congress from power in 2014. That is the sort of impact the Opposition is hoping to achieve this time too.

Russia-Ukraine war: Four Indian sailors among 10 killed as missile hits ship

Shubhajit Roy & Shaju Philip
New Delhi, Thiruvananthapuram, July 20

IN THE first deaths of Indian seafarers in the Russia-Ukraine war, four Indians were among 10 killed in a Russian missile strike on a merchant vessel departing Ukraine's southern port of Odesa on Sunday.

India was quick to condemn the attack, without directly blaming Russia.

According to the Ukrainian Air Force, Russian forces launched three Kh-59/Kh-69 cruise missiles during the attack. One missile struck the starboard side of the *Golden Leo*, a Turkish-owned merchant vessel sailing under the flag of Guinea-Bissau, igniting a fire.

"On the evening of 19 July 2026, the vessel *MV Golden Leo* was attacked while departing the port of Odesa. At the time of the incident, there were 17 crew members on board, including five Indian nationals," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)

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Grain carrier *MV Golden Leo* after it was hit by a Russian missile in the Black Sea close to Odesa, Ukraine, Sunday. AP

THE WORLD PAGE 13
IRAN WAR: HOUTHIS OPEN NEW FRONT ON SAUDI ARABIA

Sons injured, a mother breaks down: 'Attack on country's children'

Injured protesters Devan Rathi (right) and Gaurav (top left) with their mother Santosh at Gurdwara Bangla Sahib. VIDHEESHA KUNTAMALLA

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, July 20

AT AROUND 4 pm, amid the clamour of slogans, ambulance sirens and exploding teargas shells, hundreds of protesters streamed out of the gates of an iconic gurdwara in the heart of Delhi — their refuge on a tumultuous afternoon.

Some clutched damp handkerchiefs to their faces to ward off the teargas, others held half-finished plastic water bottles they had hurriedly filled inside, and a few carried placards that read: "We are with Sonam Wangchuk."

Only minutes earlier, many of them had rushed into Gurdwara Bangla Sahib to escape the police lathi-charge and chaos unfolding on Parliament Street, where thousands of people had joined the CJP-led march to demand the resignation of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

118 personnel injured, 70 protesters detained, says Delhi Police

An injured Delhi Police personnel near Jantar Mantar. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 20

THE DELHI Police said "more than 118 police personnel", including some senior officers, sustained injuries as protesters attacked them with "stones and other objects" and "resorted to large-scale violence" on Monday.

"During the scuffle, around 60 protesters were also reported to (have been)... injured," it said

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EDITORIAL PAGE
CAN'T HAVE SABKA VISHWAS WITH LATHI AND TEAR GAS PAGE 10

INSIDE PAGES 4, 5
HC TO CONSIDER SONAM TRANSFER TO PRIVATE HOSPITAL

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY

Happening today

• **FARMERS FROM PUNJAB** are scheduled to hold a rally in protest against the proposed India-US trade deal at Kisan Ghat in Delhi.

NATION PAGE 3
IN CAPITAL, OMAR LEADS PUSH FOR J&K'S STATEHOOD

Indus Waters Treaty: Govt focus on Chenab projects, renegotiation

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 20

A YEAR after India put the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) "in abeyance" following the Pahalgam terror attack, it is pushing for speedy development of hydropower projects on the Chenab with a combined capacity of over 5,000 megawatts and renegotiation of the six-decade-old pact, government sources said on Monday.

According to sources, the government has assessed that the pact has outlived its utility and is ready to renegotiate it with Pakistan to make it more balanced. "IWT, in its present form, cannot function again," said a top source. Pakistan, sources said, has not shown any signs of ending cross-border terrorism against India — a precondition for resuming cooperation under the IWT.

For any future reactivation of the river water-sharing provisions, the treaty would need to be renegotiated in a modified format — a step that remains contingent on Islamabad

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• LATE GOAL GIVES SPAIN WORLD TITLE, LEAVES ARGENTINA DISTRAUGHT

As curtains fall, Spain have final say: 'Huge feeling of liberation'

EXPRESS AT WORLD CUP

Sandip G
New Jersey, July 20

A SWARM of raging red shirts piled over Ferran Torres when the final whistle blew at the Metlife Stadium, crowning Spain as the World Champions for the second time in their history. Torres's goal in the 106th minute, which decided a turgid and combative 1-0 final win bereft of dramatic twists that defined the tournament, would be as immortalised as Andres Iniesta's extra-time winner in 2010.

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Spain's Ferran Torres lifts the trophy with teammates. REUTERS

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Protesters storm heart of Delhi

across several stretches of Ashoka Road, Janpath, Raisina Road, Dr Rajendra Prasad Road, Firozeshah Road, and Bhai Vir Singh Marg, injuring scores of protesters.

The organisers of the march — the CJP and activist Sonam Wangchuk – had repeatedly called for a peaceful protest; by early afternoon, however, the protest had degenerated into violence, and pitched street battles were being fought at many places.

There was heavy brickbatting at several locations including Connaught Place, where police vehicles were vandalised.

Injured protesters, some of whom had broken bones and cracked skulls, were taken to Ram Manohar Lohia (RML) Hospital and Lady Hardinge Hospital. Four protesters were admitted to the ICU at RML. Until 5.30 pm, emergency teams at RML had attended to around 100 people injured in the protests, hospital sources said.

Among those treated at RML were at least 10 police personnel as well. Police said more than 100 of its personnel had suffered injuries in the clashes with the protesters. North Delhi Deputy Commissioner of Police Raja Banthia sustained injuries to his hand and leg while supervising law and order arrangements, police sources said.

The protest spread organically and horizontally, largely without visible leaders or direction, and at one point reached close to the perimeter wall of Parliament. The gates of the building were shut, and no one, including Members of Parliament, staff, and the media were allowed to enter or exit.

Sources in the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) told *The Indian Express* that they had failed to correctly estimate the size of the crowd. They had expected about 5,000 protesters, but the actual number turned out to be almost 10 times bigger.

For Delhi Police, the inaccurate assessment of the numbers and determination of the protesters recalled a similar misjudgment from more than five years ago, when hundreds of farmers had stormed the Red Fort complex on Republic Day in 2021.

While the Jantar Mantar area can hold at most 3,000 people, almost 5,000 had gathered at the protest site on Sunday evening itself, and their numbers had continued to swell through the night and on Monday morning.

Late in the afternoon, as the street violence continued in Connaught Place and the area around Gurdwara Bangla Sahib, police moved into the Jantar Mantar protest site and dismantled the stage that had been occupied by the CJP for the past three weeks.

By evening, however, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and his associates, as well as Gitanjali J Angmo, the wife of Sonam Wangchuk, had returned to Jantar Mantar. Pictures posted on X by the CJP late on Monday night appeared to show a sizable crowd building up at the new protest site near Kerala House. However, the streets around the New Delhi district had largely emptied out.

Wangchuk, who was taken away by police from the protest site on Saturday morning, issued a statement from Safdarjung hospital, saying he would continue his fast until the youth leaders were allowed to meet MPs in Parliament, or MPs met him in hospital.

During the day, CJP leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka met Union Health Minister J P Nadda at his residence and conveyed their demands, including the removal of Education Minister Pradhan over the NEET-UG paper leak.

The CJP leaders posted on X that Nadda had assured them that their demands would be discussed at the "appropriate level". In the evening, Nadda posted on X that "for the first time, a proposal [had come] from the protesters to hold talks with the government", and the meeting had been held "in a cordial atmosphere".

Opposition leaders criticised the handling of the protest by the government. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi was the "most anti-youth" PM in the country's history. Samajwadi Party MP Dimple Yadav condemned the police action against protesting students at Jantar Mantar, calling it a "black day for democracy".

Meanwhile, the Delhi High Court asked Safdarjung hospital to file an affidavit with laboratory reports on Sonam Wangchuk's health on an appeal by his wife Gitanjali Angmo against a single judge's order refusing to allow him to be moved to a private hospital.

The court said it would pronounce its decision on Angmo's plea on Tuesday.

'Attack on country's children'

Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

"We wanted to protect ourselves from the lathi-charge," a protester said.

The roads outside had turned into a heavily barricaded security zone, with rows of Delhi Police personnel and paramilitary forces waiting for the crowds to disperse. Inside Gurdwara Bangla Sahib, devotees continued offering prayers while volunteers distributed water and refreshments to the injured.

Near the small refreshment counter close to Gate No. 1, clusters of protesters gathered around the stairs, washing their faces, drinking water and checking on one another's injuries. Several sat silently, staring at their phones as they tried to contact friends and family members.

N K Sharma, a government employee who also performs seva at the gurdwara, watched the scene unfold with dismay. "I suddenly saw a huge crowd entering the gurdwara. Many of them looked frightened. Some were injured," he said.

Sharma said volunteers immediately stepped in to restore order. "We don't allow any kind of violence inside. The police did not enter the gurdwara, and even the protesters were respectfully escorted out once they had calmed down," he said.

Near the main shrine, a small circle of young protesters sat cross-legged on the white marble stairs. As volunteers moved through the complex, they asked the injured to head towards the langar hall for a meal before leaving.

At the corner of the group sat 21-year-old Devan Rathi, a B.Com student at Shivaji College, a broad white bandage wrapped around his forehead. His jeans were streaked with dust, and he held a white handkerchief covered with blood. "This is what happens to the students of this country when we raise our voice for something as basic as fair examinations," Devan said.

His mother, Santosh Rathi, sat beside him, unable to stop crying. "I brought my boys here because I wanted them to fight for their rights," she said, her voice breaking. "But it looks like I only brought them here to get hurt. I failed as a parent."

Before anyone in the group could respond, another woman sitting nearby reached over and said to Santosh: "You did nothing wrong. You should be proud that your children know how to stand up for what they believe in. Not every parent gives their children that courage."

Devan recounted how quickly the day had spiralled into chaos. "We reached near the Parliament Street police station around 3 pm. We parked our vehicle and were walking when suddenly the police started the lathi-charge. Before we could understand what was happening, I was hit," he said.

"I was injured all over. After that, a few Cockroach Janta Party volunteers found us, took us back towards the stage at Jantar Mantar and gave us first aid. From there, we came here," he said.

His older brother, 22-year-old Gaurav Rathi, a graduate of Delhi Technological University, had injuries on his arms and shoulders. The brothers had travelled from Janakpuri with their mother to join the protest. "We didn't come here looking for a fight," Gaurav said. "We came because we believed students deserved to be heard."

For nearly an hour, the shrine became an unexpected refuge for several such students and protesters fleeing batons and teargas. "We are waiting here for things to get better outside," Santosh said before leaving. "There is teargas on the streets."

Then, looking back at her sons, she said: "What kind of government is this? They are attacking their own country's children."

Outside the gurdwara, for nearly an hour, The Indian Express followed a police contingent as it moved from one flashpoint to another around central Delhi. In front of the West Bengal Information and Cultural Centre, a teargas shell landed with a dull thud before erupting into a cloud of white smoke that drifted slowly across the road. Protesters who had been regrouping moments earlier covered their faces with scarves and sprinted towards the narrower lanes leading away from the site.

A few hundred metres away, opposite St Columba's School, the confrontation intensified. Stones flew through the air from behind hastily assembled groups of protesters. The police responded almost immediately, firing more teargas shells while advancing with lathis raised. "Move back! Move back!" officers shouted as they chased protesters down Bhai Veer Singh Marg while ordering vehicles to turn back.

By the time the forces reached Kalibari Marg, another round of teargas had turned the junction hazy. Smoke drifted over traffic lights and into the tree-lined avenues leading towards Gole Market. Residents watched cautiously from the sides of the street and shopkeepers hurriedly pulled down their shutters.

Opp

deputed for floor management to reach out to Opposition parties such as the Samajwadi Party (SP) and the DMK.

Following the police action against the protesters, several Opposition leaders said this was an opportunity to corner the government and expressed their resolve to disrupt parliamentary proceedings in the coming days to press for Pradhan's resignation, one of the primary demands of the demonstrators.

Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi criticised Prime Minister Narendra Modi, labelling him "anti-youth" because of the crackdown on the protesters. "Prime Minister Modi is the most anti-youth Prime Minister in India's history — so anti-youth that he can't even demand the resignation of a failed Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan," he said in a video message.

The LoP said despite 152 paper leaks and "7.5 crore students victimized", no one had been punished. "Who got the punishment? The hardworking youth. And when these children raised legitimate questions about education — they were met with batons and detention in response ... The criminals who leaked the papers roam free — and the students raising valid issues are dragged around, beaten. This government isn't just failing the youth — it's pouncing on them."

Gandhi said in another social media post, "Every police officer and govt official blindly following orders to attack India's innocent students should keep in mind: The Constitution is your master. Power is not permanent. Accountability will follow."

Earlier in the day, as Opposition leaders gathered to chalk out their Parliament floor strategy, the Congress pointed out how it had also launched a movement on matters related to the education system and said the focus should be on the alleged theft at the Ayodhya Ram Temple. After its allies pushed it to reconsider, the party agreed to keep the focus on the protests led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and the police action.

In the Rajya Sabha, House LoP and Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge informed the Chair he wanted to speak on the issue of paper leak and the NEET examination "ghotala (scam)". "This is an issue of students and the issue of the future of lakhs of students. Thousands of students have gathered together at Jantar Mantar against this, and the government is carrying out a lathi-charge against them, and the government is trying to crush and beat them," he said.

Lok Sabha proceedings were adjourned five times as Opposition MPs raised slogans and displayed placards over the NEET paper 'leak' and the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple.

In the Parliament House complex, Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra criticised the use of force on the protesters. "It's ridiculous ... They are our own children ... they are the future of the country. This Parliament belongs to them. It's no one's personal fiefdom," she said.

"We have been saying there should be a discussion as there are problems in the education policy. You are not ready to discuss and fire tear gas at children and beat them up. For what? They are our children," said the Wayanad MP.

Later in a post on X, Priyanka asked the BJP-led government to review its policies and shortcomings and called for a detailed discussion on this issue in the Lower House. The Prime Minister should listen to the concerns of the country's millions of youth and respond to them, Gandhi said.

AAP leaders Atishi and Manish Sisodia, CPI(M)'s M A Baby and Brinda Karat, and Samajwadi Party (SP) MP Dimple Yadav were among those who joined the protest at Parliament Street close to Parliament House.

Several Opposition leaders *The Indian Express* spoke to deemed it a rare moment when "organic anger" against the Modi government is seen on the streets and emphasised the need to capitalise on it. The leaders said they would continue to disrupt Parliament and submit adjournment motions demanding a discussion on paper leaks.

A Congress leader said the party had slowly realised that it could not avoid such a mass movement while being the main Opposition party. "While we were unsure initially, we are slowly getting to the point where we know we can't stay away from the movement or this moment," said a senior party MP.

The Congress's focus, insiders said, was on ensuring that the Ram Temple issue doesn't fade away. "We feel that the temple issue is something that can't be washed away in this CJP and NEET issue," said another MP.

SP leaders said paper leaks were a more urgent issue than Ram Temple, saying they could focus on it a few days later. An SP MP told *The Indian Express* it was time for the Opposition to bring parliamentary proceedings to a halt in protest. "We are preparing adjournment motions and a strategy to demand a discussion on this paper leak issue in the House. It is now our responsibility to make the government feel the heat after what happened today," said the MP.

SP MP Iqra Choudhary told *The Indian Express*, "We have been active participants in the protests and will continue to be."

A CPI MP said the Congress cannot avoid this protest. "This is a moment that the Congress or the Opposition can't avoid. We will convey this to the Congress too, and we are sure they will be on board. They are also realising they can't sit back while young people are bleeding on the streets," said the MP.

A CPI(M) MP said the "united Opposition" needs to understand and cooperate with this youth movement. "So many young people have sustained serious injuries. How can this government be so insensitive?" he said.

TMC MP Sagarika Ghose said the party had supported the CJP from the first day and would continue to do so. Another TMC MP said that the non-Congress parties were sure of their support for the CJP and that it was non-negotiable at this point.

"The Congress also wants to keep the focus on the Ram Temple issue because of Uttar Pradesh polls and that is also fine. But this issue can't be ignored now. We see this as a moment that can be used to corner the government. All their claims of everyone being happy under this government have fallen flat, and we can't let that be. No one in the Opposition or the government expected this kind of turnout on Monday. And since it has become so big, we have to rally behind the young people," said the MP.

Nadda

asserted after a huddle by a group of ministers that included Pradhan and BJP president Nitin Nabin in Parliament House. "The meeting of Naddaji was to listen to the students... But we have not given them any assurance that the Government would consider their demands," the Minister said.

Sources in the BJP said the Government decided to meet the protesting students as the situation had escalated on the first day of the Monsoon session and "created very bad optics". "Naturally, the Government cannot be seen as insensitive to the protesting students," a party leader said.

Reflecting the thinking within the Government, meanwhile, the Minister asserted that the "real students" have ended the protests and "gone back to their classes" and "the results of the exams also have come out", referring to the NEET-UG results released last week. "Those who remain at the protest site are the ones who want to politicise the issue. Those who are still protesting are people who want power," the Minister asserted.

Earlier, Nadda met CJP spokespersons Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka even as security forces wielded batons and fired tear gas at the protesters, some of whom had reached just a few metres away from Parliament.

Parliament security personnel locked almost all the gates to the building premises even as senior ministers were huddled inside Home Minister Amit Shah's office in Parliament House. While Pradhan remained inside Shah's room for hours, other ministers such as Nadda, Kiren Rijiju and Piyush Goyal joined later. Nabin, too, was seen going inside Shah's office.

Nadda said the meeting with CJP representatives took place after the protesters sought one. "This morning, for the first time, a proposal came from the protesters to hold talks with the government, and our discussions have been ongoing since 11.50," he posted on X at 4.37 pm.

"The meeting took place in a cordial atmosphere. An initial verbal discussion was held in detail with their delegation, and they submitted a written petition to me around 4 pm. I have requested all the protesters to end their sit-in and assist the administration in restoring normalcy," Nadda posted.

CJP's Das tweeted that he, along with Ranka, had been at Nadda's residence since noon. "The demands have been conveyed, including immediate resignation/ sacking of Dharmendra Pradhan. The Minister assured us he will discuss this at the appropriate level. However, no commitments have been made so far. The peaceful protesters will not rest until the demand is met," Das wrote on X.

The CJP's key demands include the release of Wangchuk from Safdarjung hospital; dismissal of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over NEET-UG lapses; and compensation of Rs 1 crore each for families of students who died by suicide due to NEET-UG leak.

Sources in the Government said there will be no "immediate action" on these demands. "The Minister (Pradhan) is unlikely to put in his papers soon. Everything has a procedure to follow. But the Government may take up the issue of providing compensation to the families of NEET students who committed suicide," said a party leader.

However, another Minister said: "There will be discussions within the party and between the Government and officials to see to what extent we can go in meeting their demands."

Treaty

permanently halting its support for terrorism directed against India, sources said.

The Indian Express has learnt that Delhi's key priority is the speedy completion of hydropower projects on the Chenab -- 1,856 MW Sawalkote Hydroelectric Project, 1,000 MW Pakal Dul Project, 850 MW Ratle Project, 624 MW Kiru Project, and 540 MW Kwar Project.

While the Kiru and Pakal projects are expected to be completed by the end of this year, the remaining are expected to be completed in the next two-three years, sources said.

These projects are critical for India's clean energy transition, grid stability and regional development, and will substantially enhance India's hydropower capacity while enabling the fuller utilisation of its legitimate rights under the Indus basin, said sources. "Together with accelerated hydropower development and modern basin management, these initiatives will ensure that India's legitimate share of the Indus waters is utilised efficiently, sustainably and in accordance with its long-term developmental, water security and clean energy objectives," sources said.

Putting the Indian approach in context, since Pakistan has been trying to mobilise global opinion in its favour, sources said the IWT was negotiated and implemented in a spirit of goodwill, friendship and peaceful coexistence. "Like any enduring international arrangement, it depended not merely on legal obligations but on mutual trust, reciprocity and good faith. For over six decades, India honoured both the letter and spirit of the treaty, maintaining uninterrupted implementation even during wars, military crises and prolonged periods of bilateral hostility," said sources.

Pakistan, however, simultaneously pursued a sustained policy of cross-border terrorism against India, added the sources. "Such conduct has fundamentally destroyed the atmosphere of trust necessary for cooperative implementation of the treaty. Agreements of this nature cannot remain insulated from persistent acts of hostility, terrorism," the sources said.

Over 118 cops injured

in a statement.

"The protesters displayed unruly, aggressive and violent behaviour. Despite repeated warnings and lawful directions issued by the police, they refused to disperse and deliberately violated the prohibitory orders in force. The protesters attacked police personnel with stones and other objects, attempted to breach police barricades, vandalised police and other government vehicles, damaged public property, and resorted to large-scale violence, posing a serious threat to public order, the security arrangements in place, and the safety of police personnel performing their lawful duties," it said.

According to the statement, "senior officers of the ranks of Special Commissioner of Police, Joint Commissioner of Police, Additional Commissioner of Police, Deputy Commissioner of Police, Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police and Assistant Commissioner of Police, besides several women police personnel" were among those injured.

The police statement said "15 to 20 government vehicles, along with other government property, were vandalised during the incident".

"Around 70 protesters have been detained. Appropriate legal action is being initiated, and an FIR is being registered under the relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and other applicable laws for rioting, assault on public servants, damage to public property and other offences committed during the protest," it said.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (North Delhi district) Raja Banthia and Additional DCP (New Delhi district) Anand Mishra were learnt to be among those injured. Banthia told *The Indian Express* that he suffered injuries on his knees, elbows and hand.

Russia-Ukraine war

said in a statement.

"As per information available, four Indian nationals have tragically lost their lives, while one is hospitalised in a critical condition. Our Mission in Ukraine is closely monitoring the situation and is making every effort to extend all possible assistance to those affected. We extend our deepest condolences to the families of the deceased Indian nationals and wish the injured Indian national a speedy and full recovery," it said.

"India condemns such attacks and reiterates that targeting commercial shipping and endangering innocent civilian crew members, or otherwise impeding freedom of navigation and commerce, is deplorable and should be avoided," the MEA said.

While the Centre is yet to release the names of the dead, one of the sailors has been identified as Akhil Joyan, 26, a resident of Kasaragod district in Kerala. Family sources said they were contacted by the shipping firm. An official communication from the Chief Minister's Office said the NORKA (Non-resident Keralites Affairs Department) has been entrusted to get in touch with the MEA and Russian consulate for further details.

According to family sources, Akhil was the only son of Joyan, a merchant, and Saly, a collection agent at the postal department. He joined the shipping industry as a mariner after completing a course in nautical science from Chennai, and had been working on the ship for the last six years.

"Last month, he visited his parents and his wedding was fixed. Akhil was planning to sign off from this ship by the end of this month. He wanted to move to another firm," said a family source.

The Ukrainian Sea Ports Authority (USPA) said the bulk carrier had aboard 17 crew members from Syria and India, as well as a Ukrainian port pilot, when it was hit shortly after departing Odesa with a cargo of corn. The strike killed 10 people, including the 66-year-old Ukrainian pilot and nine foreign crew members.

While there have been deaths of Indian seafarers in the US-Iran war in West Asia in the last four-and-a-half months, this is the first time that Indian sailors have been victims in the now four-and-a-half-year-old war between Russia and Ukraine.

Ukraine's Acting Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said the attack came just hours after Russia's overnight missile and drone assault on Kyiv. "While the world is still responding to Russia's brutal overnight attack on Kyiv, Moscow continues its campaign of terror throughout the day," Sybiha wrote on social media.

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(M): 9212665841, 9212008155

World Cup

He rose from the heap, exhausted with emotion, eyes shining with tears of inexpressible joy, hair dishevelled, the sleeves of his shirt torn, and gasped for breath.

Torres tried to evade the broadcasters' eyes but he could not. "In the end, the goal belongs to 47 million people, not me, nor we 26 players here. Destiny was written today, we were going to win," he said. He called the goal "liberation". "It's a huge feeling of liberation. I've been criticised a lot during this World Cup but destiny was written, and I thank God, who always gives me strength to continue. Things come to those who deserve them," he said. It was his first goal of the tournament, and the only that perhaps would matter to him for the rest of his life.

After the final whistle, he was momentarily distracted by the melee near Spain's dugout. Argentina's Nahuel Molina and Spain's Rodri sparked a war of words before Rodri's teammate Eric Garcia intervened and pushed Molina away. From nowhere butted in Argentina's Leandro Paredes and tried to clutch Garcia's throat. Spain's Gavi entered the scuffle and nudged Paredes, which provoked Thiago Almada who pinned Gavi to the floor. The referee rifled in and brandished the brawler-in-chief Paredes a red card, before members from both teams dragged their players away. The match had been simmering on boiling point ever since Enzo Fernandez's second-half red card. Paredes might not care, because the pain he was suffering was more bitter.

From Torres and the ecstatic Spanish players, with Lamine Yamal sprawled on the ground, wiping the tears with his palms, the eyes of the arena wandered to Lionel Messi, on the verge of tears, hands on his chin. Spain did not forget Messi in his moment of despair. Rodri hugged him; Pedri shook his hands. It would be the last that the grandest stage had seen of its grandest player, but when an era ends, another begins. Torres's strike was the siren of Spain's domination in the years to come. It would remain a metaphor for the Spanish dynasty. It was inevitable and deserving, for Spain was the tournament's in-surpassable team.

The moment of Torres's goal would seem blurry yet clear. It came without being accompanied by theatre or drama. The electronic clock blinked 105, the red digits blinking. The scorching sun mellowed; the second half of the extra time had begun with the brimming possibility of a penalty shootout, which the turgid final deserved, but perhaps not Spain, with the utter domination of the game.

Rejuvenated after the break, Spain instantly dashed forward. From the right flank, Yamal skipped with the ball and passed to Pedro Porro, who pinged a speculative shot towards Nico Williams to the far post. The ball seemed over-hit, perhaps it was, but Williams beat an on-rushing Emi Martinez to the ball and headed it backwards to the unmanned Ferran Torres. The Spanish forward had time and space to gather, compose and leather the ball past Martinez, sending Spain to raptures, and Argentina to the gorge of misery and saving the match from the cruelty of a penalty shoot out.

Martinez's injudiciousness to march out of his lines would be recriminated. But Argentina would feel the wheels of misfortune crushing them in the form of Gio Simeone, who was tracking Torres, pulling a muscle on the edge of the area.

The next 15 minutes with 10 men was arduous for Argentina. But they threw everything they could, men, ideas, and emotions. In the stoppage time of the extra time, they came close twice, but were brutally denied by Spain's defenders. Spain were not to be bullied or badgered, as they hoofed and hacked every advance of Argentina. Even Messi stood helpless, curl and whip eluding his deliveries, his movements restrained by a silken midfielder operating at the peak of his prowess. If even Messi could not alter the destiny of the afternoon, perhaps nothing could.

The goal was in tune with the game's tempo. The more the watch wore on, the more it seemed like it would be defined by a singular piece of action, one burst of ingenuity or fortune, one act of indiscretion or genius, one mad or inspired moment. But the game couldn't shake off its afflictions with dullness. In normal time, Spain had nine shots on goal, none from the sweet spot. At the other end, Argentina did not even have an attempt on goal in normal time.

A penalty shootout seemed inevitable, but for Torres's whipper-snapper strike. The goal of his life; the siren of the second Spanish dynasty; and perhaps the last act of the greatest footballer that had walked on the earth.

Uttarakhand activist headed to Jantar Mantar detained, HC asks state: 'Under which law?'

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, July 20

QUESTIONING THE detention of an activist, allegedly by the Uttarakhand police, who was leaving for Delhi to join the Cockroach Janta Party protest at Jantar Mantar, the Uttarakhand High Court on Monday asked the state under what circumstances and provisions of law he was detained.

The president of Uttarakhand Parivartan Party, Prabhat Dhyani, had announced his intention to join the protests at Jantar Mantar to extend solidarity to Sonam Wangchuk and CJP through a Facebook post. Dhyani, along with his two colleagues, had boarded a train from Rishikesh to New Delhi.

However, his colleagues later informed his family that Dhyani was detained by police personnel at Rishikesh Railway Station at 5.15 pm on Sunday. As the family members could not contact him or determine his whereabouts, the outfit's secretary filed a habeas corpus petition on Monday.

"Despite repeated efforts, no information whatsoever has been provided to the petitioner regarding the authority under which he has been detained, the place where he is being kept, the grounds of his detention, or his present physical condition. Such complete denial of information is arbitrary, contrary to the rule of law, and violative of his constitutional and legal rights," the petition said.

Hearing the matter, the division bench of Justices Ravindra Maithani and Siddhartha Sah was informed by the petitioner's counsel that they received a telephone call that the police were going to release Dhyani, and the document process was underway. The counsel for the state submitted that he had been released and was in the custody of his mother.

The court asked the state to place on record the entire document on the apprehension and release of the corpus. "The court would also like to know as to why an adult is given into the custody of his mother and why he was not set free? The first and foremost question would be, under what circumstances and under what provisions of law was Prabhat Dhyani detained?" the court said.

The matter is listed for Tuesday.

The petition stated that Dhyani was being held in custody by the Ramnagar police on the basis of a warrant. Dhyani's wife, Uma Rani, through her legal representative, sent an email to the police requesting that they show where the detainee was. The petitioner also attempted to visit the Ramnagar police station, requesting that they disclose his whereabouts and the authority under which he had been detained.

"However, the officials present at the police station neither accepted the representation by issuing any acknowledgement, nor received it, nor furnished any information whatsoever regarding the detainee. The conduct of the respondent authorities in refusing to acknowledge the representation and in withholding information concerning the custody of the detainee further demonstrates the arbitrary and opaque manner in which the detention has been carried out," the petition said.

'Sansad Chalo' eclipses Omar's statehood protest

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, July 20

FOR ITS first protest to amplify its demand for the restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir, the National Conference chose New Delhi and the first day of the Parliament's Monsoon Session.

But not only was it eclipsed by the 'Sansad Chalo' march by the Cockroach Janta Party, it also faced a cold shoulder from the National Conference's INDI alliance (INDIA) partners.

The National Conference had chosen the national capital in the hope of drawing wider public attention, greater media coverage and support from leaders cutting across party lines. By limiting its demand to the restoration of statehood — a slogan that enjoys broader political acceptance and for which several political parties had already expressed support — Omar Abdullah's party appeared to be seeking the widest possible consensus.

But on Monday, the party appeared politically isolated, with only its own leaders, including NC chief Farooq Abdullah, and a handful of Congress leaders from Jammu and Kashmir joining the protest.

"We were stopped from getting to Jantar Mantar and stopped from protesting peacefully for what is rightfully ours but we were not silenced. This is only the beginning of our struggle for statehood, our rights, our dignity and everything that was taken away from us," Omar posted on X.

In another post, he shared a video of himself in an auto-rickshaw and wrote, "My walk from Jantar Mantar was about to turn into another procession so we grabbed the first available means of transport."

Terming as "wrong" the decision to choose Delhi for the protests, Peoples Democratic Party legislator Waheed Para said, "The most powerful protest would have been here (in Kashmir), amid your own people."

"There was mismanagement. It was a selfie show and nowhere close to seriousness," Para said. "Just compare the protest by the youth. The protest visuals were a contrast."

Although their protest also featured placards demanding "rights and dignity" for the people of Jammu and Kashmir alone, the party was unable to rally its local political rivals behind the event. The NC's decision to confine its formal demand for statehood, leaving out special status and other constitutional guarantees, did little to broaden support.

CM Omar Abdullah takes an auto along with son Zahir Abdullah to reach the venue of the NC protest for restoration of statehood for Jammu and Kashmir, in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

Its decision not to permit opposition resolutions on special status and statehood in the J-K assembly further fuelled opposition claims that the party was selective in its commitment to these core issues.

The People's Conference's Sajad Lone also questioned the National Conference's strategy, saying that the resolutions should first come from the J-K Assembly and should include the core demands of Article 370 and 35A.

"Taking the issue directly to Delhi without exhausting constitutional avenues within the Assembly would reduce the role of the people of Jammu and Kashmir in the process," Lone said earlier.

Leaders within the National Conference, too, rued the lack of planning and strategy before "such an important event". "It is true that the CJP protest plan was announced after ours, but we failed to re-adjust and re-strategise," a former legislator said. "We could have easily managed a crowd of a few thousand people in Delhi. We didn't plan for that."

Former Srinagar Mayor Junaid Azim Mattu posted on X, "A half-hearted, ill-planned, half-baked protest is a disservice to the cause of restoring Kashmir's dignity and rights. A party with a Government, 40+ legislators and 5 MPs couldn't invest the effort to gather 5,000 people in Delhi?"

"That the CJP protest over NEET has overshadowed the protest by an elected CM, MPs and MLAs is anguishing even for those who stand opposed to the JKNC politically. What was the need to protest when there was no preparation and no seriousness of intent?" he wrote.

NEET-UG 2026

NTA says viral OMR sheets fabricated, warns of penal action

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 20

THE NATIONAL Testing Agency (NTA) Monday said that several allegations of discrepancies in NEET-UG 2026 results were based on "fabricated, digitally-altered or otherwise forged" OMR answer sheets, some allegedly created using artificial intelligence, as it sought to counter allegations on social media questioning the integrity of the examination.

In a statement issued a day after warning candidates of legal consequences for circulating forged examination documents, NTA said it had verified every complaint received so far and found "without exception" that the official records matched the declared results.

"It has come to the notice of the National Testing Agency that images of OMR answer sheets, said to be the 'correct' record of certain candidates who appeared in NEET (UG) 2026, are being circulated on social media in support of claims that the results declared against those candidates are wrong," the statement said.

Rejecting those claims, the NTA said, "The score declared against every such candidate is fully consistent with that OMR answer sheet, the official answer key notified for NEET (UG) 2026, and the calculation sheet on file. There is no evaluation error."

It further said the images circulating online "are not documents issued by NTA", but "digitally manipulated versions of the candidates' own genuine OMR answer sheets.

> ***The NTA responded to five candidates whose allegations had gained traction online. In each case, it said the OMR sheet had been correctly evaluated***

"According to the agency, the alterations ranged "from the introduction of additional response markings to the alteration of names and of the authenticated signature time of an invigilator, amongst others."

The statement follows days of allegations that the OMR sheets uploaded against their roll numbers either did not belong to them, reflected far fewer attempted questions than they had marked, or had been interchanged. Several candidates sought re-evaluation based on images they described as their "correct" OMR sheets.

The controversy concerns the June 21 NEET-UG retest, held after the May examination was cancelled due to paper leak. Since the results were declared, candidates and parents have shared screenshots and alleged discrepancies across social media, with opposition leaders also questioning the conduct of the examination.

On Sunday, the NTA warned that candidates submitting digitally-altered OMR sheets or scorecards could face cancellation of their results, debarment from future NTA examinations and criminal proceedings.

The warning comes as the Medical Counselling Committee under the Directorate General of Health Services and state counselling authorities prepare to begin admissions based on the NTA merit list.

"The creation, submission or circulation of a fabricated, digitally-altered or otherwise forged OMR answer sheet is a cognisable offence under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, and separately attracts liability under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, and the Information Technology Act, 2000," Monday's statement said.

In an accompanying clarification, the NTA responded individually to five candidates whose allegations had gained traction on social media: Avaneesh Srivastava, Pratibha Trivedi, Abhay Yadav, Lakshya Singh and Arya Singh.

In each case, the agency maintained that the OMR sheet had been correctly evaluated and that the declared score was accurate.

The agency on Monday said every genuine OMR sheet and scorecard contains unique identifiers, including the roll number, booklet number, barcode, serial number, QR code, candidate details, signatures and thumb impressions, which are verified against secure records maintained by the NTA and the National Informatics Centre (NIC).

While fabricated images may appear convincing, they cannot alter the official records stored on the agency's servers, it said.

Allow parents to opt out of APAAR ID data sharing, SC tells CBSE

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 20

THE SUPREME Court said Monday it will direct the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) to follow the Orissa High Court order directing authorities to provide parents the option to refuse to share their children's Aadhaar details for the creation of the Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry (APAAR) ID or to opt out of the scheme.

Hearing pleas by some parents challenging the constitutional validity of the scheme, a three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said it will also issue a direction to the Board regarding the concerns about the protection, storage, and processing of students' personal data.

"We will direct CBSE to implement this judgment on a pan-India basis...as the HC order has been accepted. We are directing CBSE to examine (other) issues as well," the court said.

The Orissa High Court, in its December 12, 2025, judgement in the case *Rohit Anand Das and Another vs Union of India and Others*, asked authorities "to consider amendment of the model consent form to include an opt out/refusal of consent option therein."

Every student is assigned a unique, lifelong 12-digit identification number under APAAR, a scheme launched by the Ministry of Education under the National Education Policy (NEP). The APAAR ID serves as a digital academic passport, securely storing educational records, including mark-sheets, degrees, and co-curricular achievements, on a single platform.

Appearing for the petitioners, Senior Advocate Indira Jaising told the bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, that under APAAR, children are being mandatorily enrolled in a non-statutory scheme.

Jaising added, "We are concerned with the micro-level data. It is my right to be forgotten, to withdraw consent."

DR. RAMMANOHAR LOHIA AVADH UNIVERSITY, AYODHYA (U.P.)

Ref. No.: RMLAU/ADMIN/299/2026 DATE: 20th July, 2026

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1. Applications on prescribed format are invited from eligible candidates as per University Statutes/Government Orders of UP/UGC norms for the vacant Posts of, **PROFESSOR (Advt. No.01/2026), ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR (Advt. No.02/2026) and ASSISTANT PROFESSOR (Advt. No.03/2026),** of various teaching departments of the University Campus. This advertisement is issued as per UP State G.O. 977/Sattar-1-2019-16(19) /2019 dated 02, September, 2019 and related government notification/orders of department of Higher Education, U.P. regarding reservation policy.
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नियुक्तियां

निवेश संवर्धन ब्यूरो (बीआईपी) जो कि राजस्थान सरकार का उपक्रम है, में निम्नांकित पदों पर सीधी भर्ती हेतु ऑनलाईन आवेदन पत्र दिनांक 20.07.2026 रात्रि 11.59 बजे तक आमंत्रित किए गए थे। भर्ती हेतु ऑनलाईन आवेदन पत्र की तिथि दिनांक 03.08.2026 रात्रि 11.59 बजे तक बढाई जाती है (इसके उपरान्त लिंक स्वतः ही निष्क्रिय हो जाएगा)।

क्र. सं.	पद का नाम	वेतनमान	पदों की संख्या
1.	प्रबंधक	पे मैट्रिक्स लेवल-14	09
2.	सचिव ग्रेड-III	पे मैट्रिक्स लेवल-11	05
3.	केयर टेकर	पे मैट्रिक्स लेवल-8	01
4.	कनिष्ठ सहायक (टाईपिस्ट)	पे मैट्रिक्स लेवल-5	03
		कुल	18

ऑनलाईन आवेदन की प्रक्रिया :- इस संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी बीआईपी की वेबसाइट **https://industries.rajasthan.gov.in/bip** पर उपलब्ध है।

अति० आयुक्त
(निवेश एवं अप्रवासी भारतीय)

राज.संवाद/सी/26/7231

IN THE COURT OF NARENDER SURA, SPECIAL JUDGE
(Under the Prevention Money Laudering Act 2002)-cum-SESSIONS JUDGE, GURUGRAM

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr.P.C(Section 84 of the BNSS 2023 read with section 65 of the PML Act 2002)

Directorate of Enforcement Versus Shivam Saurav

Date of hearing :- 25.08.2026
Time :- 10:00 a.m.

C.I.S. No: CRM-573-2026
The PML Act, 2002
ECIR/GNZO/20/2024 dt 30.08.2024
CNR No: HRGR01-011164-2026

To,
The Assistant Director,
Directorate of Enforcement
Gurugram Zonal Office, Saraswati Vihar,
M.G. Road, Gurugram, Haryana - 122002

Whereas respondent namely **Shivam Saurav aged about 29 years son of Dhirender Kumar Pathak, resident of 1159, Near Shant Kiran School, Co-operative Colony, Hazaribagh, Jharkhand** is required before this court in **Case No. CRM-573-2026,** pertaining to **ECIR No:- ECIR/GNZO/20/2024 dated 30.08.2024** and it has been reported on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued against said **Shivam Saurav aged about 29 years son of Dhirender Kumar Pathak** that the above named respondent cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the above named respondent **Shivam Saurav aged about 29 years son of Dhirender Kumar Pathak** has absconded or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant.

Proclamation is hereby made that the said respondent **Shivam Saurav aged about 29 years son of Dhirender Kumar Pathak, resident of 1159, Near Shant Kiran School, Co-operative Colony, Hazaribagh, Jharkhand** is required to appear before this court to answer the said ECIR on the **25.08.2026.**

Issued under my hand and seal of this Court on this **18th day of July, 2026.**

Seal

Sd/-
(Narender Sura)
Sessions Judge-cum- Special Judge
(PMLA, 2002), Gurugram

Note:- The Proclamation be issued in national and local newspaper and also on the website of the Complainant- Directorate of Enforcement. The Complainant is further directed to affix the Proclamation at some conspicuous place on the available addresses of accused as well as a conspicuous place in the town or village where said accused resides and outside the court-room. Executing constable is directed to appear in the court for making statement regarding above mentioned compliance on **25.07.2026**

(Narender Sura)
Sessions Judge -cum- Special Judge
(PMLA, 2002), Gurugram

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EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 JUNE 2026

Rs. Crores, except per equity share data

Particulars	Quarter ended			Year ended
	30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
	Unaudited	Audited (refer note 2)	Unaudited	Audited
Total income	958.73	900.23	847.95	2,846.24
Net profit / (loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	85.28	72.60	89.55	213.95
Net profit / (loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	85.28	72.60	89.55	213.95
Net profit / (loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	63.62	54.20	66.96	159.75
Total comprehensive income for the period [comprising Profit / (loss)for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	63.24	56.94	66.56	162.73
Equity Share Capital	14.48	14.48	14.48	14.48
Other equity (excluding revaluation reserves)				504.86
Earnings Per Share (of Rs.10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) -				
1. Basic (Rs.) :	43.96	37.46	46.27	110.39
2. Diluted (Rs.) :	43.96	37.46	46.27	110.39

Notes:
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly financial results are available on the websites of Stock Exchange(s) (www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com) and on Company's website (https://smlmahindra.com/). The same can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below.
2. The figures for the quarter ended 31 March 2026, as reported in these financial results, are the balancing figures between audited figures in respect of the full financial year and the published year to date figures upto the end of third quarter of the relevant financial year. Also, the figures upto the end of the third quarter had only been reviewed and not subjected to audit.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of SML Mahindra Limited (Formerly SML Isuzu Limited)

Place: Mohali
Date : 20 July 2026

(Vinod Kumar Sahay)
Executive Chairman
DIN: 07884268

EXPRESS Careers

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(नवरत्न सीपीएसई)
CENTRAL WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
(A NAVRATNA CPSE)

Start Date: 09.07.2026 at 00:00 Hrs
End Date: 05.08.2026 at 23:59 Hrs

Advertisement No CWC/I-Engagement/Young Professional/2026/01 (ADDENDUM)

Central Warehousing Corporation, a Navratna, Central Public Sector Undertaking under the administrative control of Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, providing scientific storage facilities for agricultural inputs, produce and other notified commodities besides providing logistics infrastructure like CFSs/ICDs, Land Custom Stations, Air Cargo Complexes etc. for import-export cargo, invites online application from eligible candidates for **twelve (12) positions of Young Professionals** in various specializations as detailed below:

S.N.	Specialization	No. of Positions
1.	Learning & Development	01
2.	PCS Marketing	01
3.	Marketing & Business Development	10

Please visit CWC's Website **(www.cewacor.nic.in)** for detailed information regarding eligibility criteria including qualification and experience, selection process, general conditions etc. Eligible candidates have to apply online through CWC's Website **www.cewacor.nic.in**. The last date to apply online is **05.08.2026 at 23:59 Hrs**. No other mode of application shall be accepted.

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VACANCY FOR REGULAR POST OF PRINCIPAL

1. Refer advertisement dated 21 Jun 2026 for the Post of Principal at Army Law College, Pune.
2. Last date for receipt of applications is now extended to **30 July 2026.**
3. **Eligibility Criteria/ Essential Qualification** remain same as per advertisement dated 21 June 2026 which is available on our website www.alcpune.com, Instagram id : https://www.instagram.com/armylawcollegepune, LinkedIn id: https://www.linkedin.com/army-law-college-pune/ and Twitter (X) id : @ArmylawcollegeP
4. Rest no change.

Principal In-charge
Army Law College Pune

From Jantar Mantar to near Parliament: CJP protest march that took on a life of its own

Pragynesh & Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, July 20

AROUND 3 pm on Monday, as MPs gathered inside the Parliament for the first day of the Monsoon Session, an eerie silence filled Sansad Marg. The road was strewn with abandoned shoes and slippers — the only traces of the tens of thousands of students and young professionals who had, minutes earlier, marched towards the Parliament demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Lathicharged and subjected to tear gas shells by Delhi Police and Rapid Action Force personnel, the protesters had been pushed back.

For the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), it marked a turning point — the protest, which had caught the attention of the country, appeared to have slipped out of its control.

It all unraveled after the CJP announced that they had been invited by the government for talks — a win, though marginal and eventually inconsequential.

The day had begun much earlier, with students and young professionals filtering through police checkpoints to reach Jantar Mantar, where the CJP had been camping for nearly a month over the alleged mismanagement of the NEET examination.

The police had welded together two layers of barricades to confine the protesters to Jantar Mantar and adjoining Tolstoy Road. However, by 9.30 am, the number of protesters had grown so much that they started climbing on top of the police barricades, with slogans of 'Vande Mataram' and 'Jai Bhim' being raised in the background.

At 11.30 am, two-and-a-half hours later than the scheduled time to start the march, Gitanjali Angmo, Sonam Wangchuk's wife, announced from the stage: "Sonam has requested Dipke, who has been on a hunger strike, to break his fast, as he needs energy to lead the protest and the march."

A few minutes later, Dipke drank a glass of juice, breaking his two-day-old fast.

"We will start the march in 10 minutes... it will be led by Gitanjali ma'am and Riya's father," Dipke announced. He was referring to Riya Kumari (24), who allegedly died by suicide in Dehradun while preparing for the NEET re-exam last month. Soon after, Dipke and Anngmo's delegation moved towards the Kerala Bhavan in a mini truck.

As the convoy approached the barricades near Kerala Bhavan around 12.10 pm, it was met by a line of paramilitary personnel in riot gear. Realising they won't be allowed to move further, Dipke asked the protesters to sit down on the road.

He told the gathering, "I want to tell you that the government has called us for a meeting. And Ashutosh (Raka) is right now meeting (Union Minister) J P Nadda."

As the crowd cheered, he added, "Till the meeting ends, let's all sit down here."

At this point, the crowd belonged to Dipke: listening to him, responding to his directions. However, with the Parliament within sight, the crowd repeatedly pressed against the barricades. By 12.30 pm, the convoy had reached about 100 m from the police barricading – manned by over 30 to 40 paramilitary personnel. Feeling that it's about to cross the last hurdle before they could march to the Parliament, the crowd started to urge security personnel to let them go.

"*Modi jab jab darta hai, Police ko aage karta hai* (When PM Narendra Modi is scared, the sends the police)," they screamed, with a group of about hundred protestors — most of them women — staging a sit-in near the barricades, Dipke's truck just behind them.

Around 1 pm, the protesters again pushed towards the barricade. A group of men overturned one of them, with bottles and slippers being thrown from among the crowd toward security forces. The security personnel charged towards them with lathis, hitting some of them.

This made the protesters turn around, with hundreds running towards Dipke's truck.

Again, Dipke appealed for restraint. "Please keep it peaceful. I urge you all to sit down," he said. But his sway over his supporters had started to fade by then. Around 1.30 pm, the protesters again started pushing the barricades.

On the other end of Jantar Mantar, towards the Leo Tolstoy Marg, the crowd pushed through barricades and poured onto Sansad Marg despite the police repeatedly announcing that prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS were in force.

"I don't mind getting beaten up... I can do this much for the country's future," said Abhishek Kumar (19), a BCom student at Allahabad University, as he and hundreds of others pushed through the barricades.

As the barricading gave way, the crowd slowly filled most of the Sansad Marg until the Parliament Street police station.

For the next couple of hours, protesters were hard pressed to find a spot to stand as every inch of space was occupied.

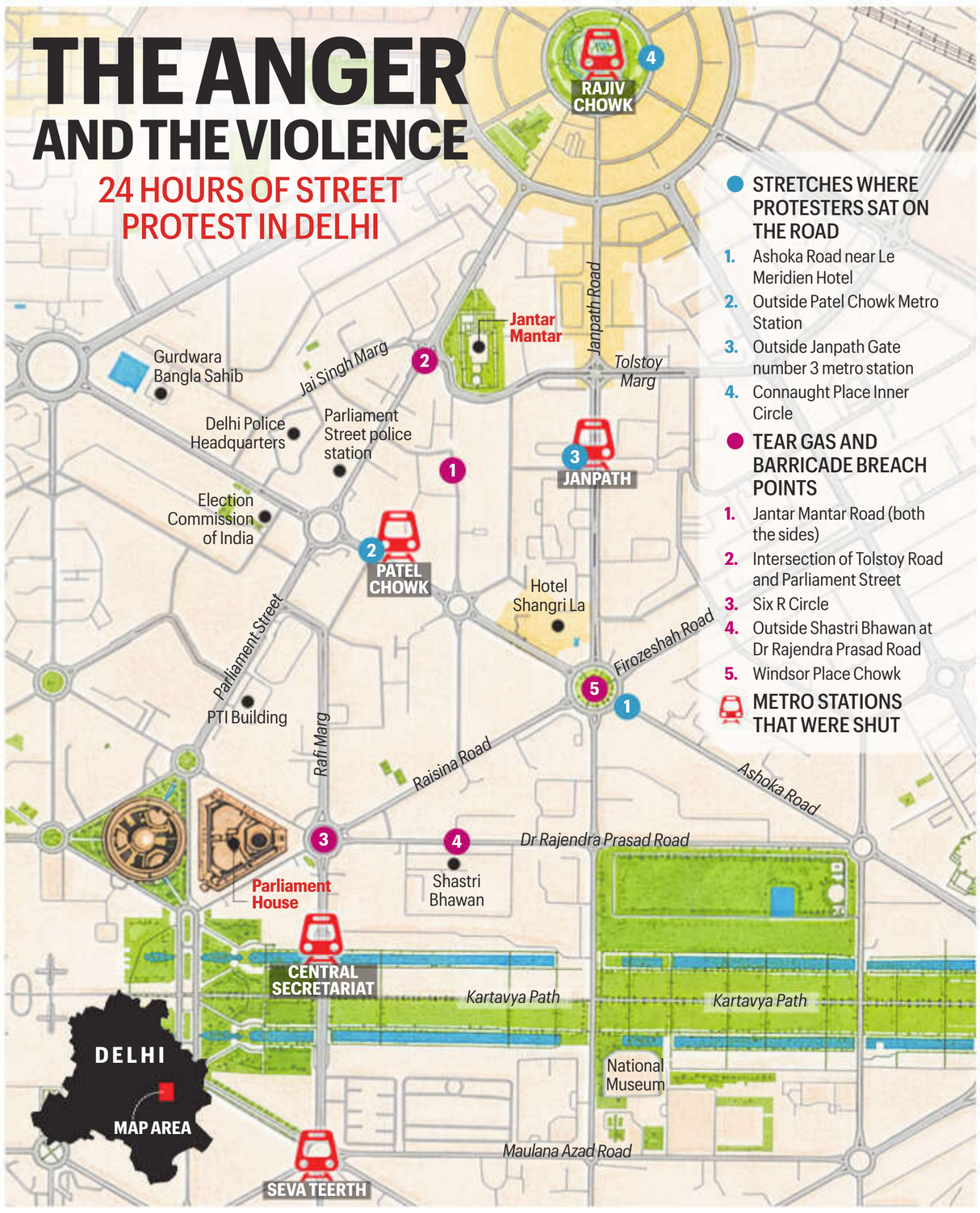
The crowd was persistent: every half an hour, they pulled back as the police resorted to lathicharge but again pushed back after regrouping.

Slowly, the protesters reached the intersection of Ashoka Road and Sansad Marg – within striking distance of the Parliament. The protest by then was only 700 m away from the Parliament. This was when the police decided that they have had enough. A spate of tear gas shells were fired for the next hour in between lathicharges, as the police pushed back the crowd towards Jantar Mantar.

As protesters scattered through Central Delhi, the march fragmented into smaller groups clashing with police on different roads.

Back at Jantar Mantar, Dipke stood with other CJP members, the stage already demolished by the police, and the arena deserted.

Protesters gather outside Parliament on Monday, demanding the resignation of the Union Education Minister. ABHINAV SAHA



THE COCKROACH JANTA PARTY AND SONAM WANGCHUK HAD ANNOUNCED A MARCH TO PARLIAMENT FROM JANTAR MANTAR. WHAT UNFOLDED IN THE STREETS WAS A MASS PROTEST BY 50,000 OR MORE PEOPLE — OF A SCALE, MAGNITUDE, AND ENERGY NOT SEEN IN THE CAPITAL IN YEARS.

JULY 19
8 PM: Around 4,000 present at Jantar Mantar protest site
12 AM: Crowd starts swelling

JULY 20
4 AM: Police erect barricades at Jantar Mantar
6 AM: Senior Delhi Police officers reach site; negotiation begins
7 AM: Delhi Police meet CJP protest organisers
8 AM: Around 8,000 at protest site
9.30 AM: Protesters topple barricade at Parliament Street
10 AM: Around 15,000 gather; 2 CJP members called for meeting with Union Minister J P Nadda
10.30 AM: Police begin lathicharge at Jantar Mantar
11 AM: Around 50,000 protesters gather across Lutyens Delhi
11.30 AM: Protest march starts from Jantar Mantar
12 NOON: Scuffle near Tolstoy Marg and Ashoka Road intersection
1 PM: Second round of lathicharge at Jantar Mantar
1.40 PM: Third round of lathicharge at Jantar Mantar
2 PM: Lathicharge near Press Club of India and Shastri Bhawan
3 PM: Heavy teargas-shelling and lathicharge at Parliament Street
4 PM: Vandalism near Janpath Metro station
5 PM: Vandalism at Connaught Place
6 PM: Stage at Jantar Mantar dismantled
7 PM: Crowd disperses, many detained
8 PM: Around 300 protesters return to Jantar Mantar

ALOK SINGH

HC seeks Sonam's reports, to consider wife's plea to move him to pvt hospital

Abhijeet Dipke and Gitanjali Angmo on Monday. ABHINAV SAHA

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 20

THE DELHI High Court has asked the Safdarjung Hospital authorities to file an affidavit with laboratory reports of activist Sonam Wangchuk after his wife, Gitanjali J Angmo, sought the court's permission to shift him to a private hospital. The court has kept Angmo's petition pending for now.

Sonam Wangchuk, who has been fasting since June 28 to demand Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, is currently at the state-run Safdarjung Hospital. He was hospitalised after Delhi Police personnel swooped in at the protest site in Jantar Mantar and moved him to the hospital, citing his health condition. Angmo wants him moved to a private facility.

The bench of Chief Justice DK Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia asked the in-charge director of AIIMS and a doctor from the team treating and monitoring Wangchuk to be present in the court on Tuesday. The court said it will consider Angmo's request on Tuesday once all medical reports and opinions are put on record.

Addressing Angmo's counsel, senior advocate Akhil Sibal, Chief Justice Upadhyaya remarked, "Values of parameters may vary from lab to lab. The pathological reports are always to be corroborated with the clinical condition. There might be a situation where blood picture may suggest an infection but may not have fever. So whether or not your body is affected or not cannot be solely decided on lab reports."

The court added, "We want to know his health condition as of today. Please bring it on record and we will take a call."

Appearing for Angmo, Sibal referred to the HC order on July 16, which asked the Centre to monitor Wangchuk's condition and intervene when needed.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta opposed Angmo's emphasis on Wangchuk's bodily autonomy to choose and make his medical decisions.

Mehta countered during the hearing, "The right to bodily autonomy cannot be absolute. Normally, under any circumstances, it is their bodily autonomy to take treatment or not, but when the potential loss of life has an impact on law and order situation, that is where the state's interests come in... then the interest of the state, that is public interest, comes. It will be the duty of the state then to ensure that health does not deteriorate further."

Protesters try to breach police barricades. ANIL SHARMA

● A FEW POLICE PERSONNEL WERE ALSO ADMITTED TO THE WARD

'Hit on head multiple times...now in ICU': Over 100 protesters at RML emergency

Tabshir Shams & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 20

RAVI, 24, an e-rickshaw driver from Muzaffarnagar, is in ICU at RML Hospital with severe head injuries and brain bleed after the police rained blows during a lathicharge at Sansad Marg, where protesters had gathered for the "Sansad chalo" march against the NEET exam cancellations. He is among the over 100 protesters, who were brought to Ram Manohar Lohia (RML) Hospital through the afternoon on Monday with a range of major and minor injuries, most of them in the head and limbs.

His brother, Shyam, told The Indian Express, "The police started firing tear gas. We moved back a little. Then they started a lathicharge. One policeman started hitting Ravi on the head multiple times, then he went down. We somehow managed to get him here," says Shyam, adding how Ravi had decided to join the protest a week ago because he was fed up with the education system and chose to stand by students. "Ravi received multiple blows on his head, which caused intracranial bleeding. He was unresponsive when he was brought here and his vitals were dropping," said the on-duty head superintendent of nursing at RML Hospital.

Till 5.30 pm, hospital sources said, emergency teams had attended to around 100 people injured in the protest, 90 protesters and 10 policemen. Four protesters were admitted to ICU till then. As teargas and lathicharge were seen across protest sites — stretching from Gole Dak Khana near Connaught Place in the northwest, through Jantar Mantar, to India Gate in the southeast — many tripped and fell over during a crowd surge. As its emergency was overwhelmed, RML stopped taking in patients. Many of the injured were then taken to Lady Hardinge Hospital. RML Hospital officials said most of the patients required stitches on their head, tetanus injections and wound-dressing.

"They have been hit in the head or in their limbs. Those who needed further investigation were moved from the Emergency for CT Scan, X-Ray and other tests. A lot of patients had to be moved to the red zone, where we have additional medical facilities and equipment. A few patients have been transferred to the ICU as well. Most of the patients are young," said sources. Some of the patients, according to them, would need immediate orthopaedic surgeries.

Emergency teams attend to injured protesters at RML Hospital on Monday. TABSHIR SHAMS

Rishi Raj Singh, 21, from Rajasthan was sitting with his friends outside the emergency ward. With stitches on his head, he said, "These things are expected when you fight with power." Twenty-two-year old Vishal from Haryana lay on a stretcher in the emergency ward, writhing in pain with a severely bruised leg and waiting for an X-Ray. "I was in Jantar Mantar near the stage area when the police started their lathicharge without warning," he says.

Azam Khan from Delhi's Shadipur, whose friend Akhlaq was in the ICU, said, "We were standing near Ashoka Road and the police started lathi charge without warning. Akhlaq fell on the road and a mob ran amok. He was trampled upon and lay there, face down for half-an-hour before I could find him. He was unresponsive," he says.

Chanchal Bora, 35, who came all the way from Uttarakhand to ensure his two-and-half-year-old daughter did not become a victim of the educational system when she grew up, nursed a badly bruised back.

"I've been in Delhi for days. I came to ask for Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation. In return what did I get from the government? I got lathi charged. They think they can stop the youth by using tear gas and lathis. They're wrong," he said.

A few police personnel were also admitted to the emergency ward. "I was hit in the head by a stone when I was standing near Sansad Marg," said a policeman without disclosing his name.

Many lives were also saved thanks to volunteers like Anshul, 22, who helped ferry several injured people to hospital. Waiting at the main gate of RML Hospital with his friends and his mother, who had accompanied him to the protest, he said, "I helped carry more than 30 people off the ground, and with my friend's help, we got them into whatever vehicle we could find, be it private cars, ambulances and sent them to hospital. It was terrifying, seeing people crumble to the ground," he said.

At Tolstoy Marg, bystanders left plastic water bottles on the pavement for the protesters, so that they could splash it across their faces to get some relief from teargas.

Unrest at Connaught Place in New Delhi in on Monday. GAJENDRA YADAV

A GRIM REMINDER OF RED FORT SECURITY BREACH IN 2021

How cops misjudged scale of protest and struggled to contain it

Alok Singh & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 20

MONDAY'S STREET violence in the capital was a grim reminder of the crisis of January 26, 2021, when hundreds of protesters on tractors reached central Delhi and managed to breach security at the Red Fort.

Like the Red Fort incident more than five years ago, intelligence units of the security agencies, including the Delhi Police, failed to accurately estimate the number of protesters who would gather at Jantar Mantar over Sunday and Monday.

The Jantar Mantar area designated for the protest has the capacity to accommodate around 3,000 people. However, by Sunday evening, nearly 5,000 people from Delhi and across the country had gathered at the site.

According to sources, the Delhi Police Intelligence Department had estimated that the turnout could reach 7,000-8,000 people on Monday morning. The actual number, including those gathered elsewhere in the city, turned out to be 50,000 or more.

The crowd reached close to Parliament, where the Monsoon Session was underway. Sources in the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) told The Indian Express that the force had not expected more than 5,000 people to join the CJP's protest.

Indeed, the protest had failed to gather momentum for more than three weeks. Until June 28, when Sonam Wangchuk began his hunger strike, the number of protesters at Jantar Mantar had remained between 100 and 500. The protest gathered significant momentum after police moved Wangchuk to Safdarjung hospital on July 18.

Officers try to stop protesters near Jantar Mantar. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Prepared for a crowd of 7,000-8,000, the police had deployed nearly 2,000 of its personnel and 32 companies of paramilitary forces, and extensively barricaded the area around Jantar Mantar. Late on Sunday night, multilayered barricades were erected at all four entry points to Jantar Mantar, as well as on Parliament Street, Raisina Road, and Dr Rajendra Prasad Road leading towards Parliament.

On Monday morning, however, nearly 15,000 people gathered at Jantar Mantar. Police sent an urgent message to all 14 districts, asking each district to immediately depute one Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP)-rank officer along with 100 police personnel to Jantar Mantar.

The Delhi Police Headquarters immediately deployed two Joint Commissioners of Police to oversee the situation. Deputy Commissioner of Police (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma attempted to establish contact with the protest organisers, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, to work out a compromise that would allow the march to proceed in a limited manner.

After three rounds of negotiations at the protest site failed to produce a breakthrough, senior police officers informed the organisers that the situation could spiral out of control.

The organisers also issued repeated appeals and made multiple public announcements urging protesters to remain peaceful and refrain from any acts of vandalism or provocation. However, by then, the situation had already slipped out of control.

The police's primary objective was to prevent the march from reaching Parliament. But the use of mild force and tear gas shells proved insufficient to deter the crowd. As the day progressed, the situation descended into repeated confrontations.

Police personnel carried out lathi charges to disperse protesters, who regrouped and charged back at the police. At several points, both sides appeared to advance towards each other simultaneously. Protesters hurled whatever they could find — including shoes, bottles, stones and even bushes — at the police, while security personnel responded with tear gas shells and baton charges.

Students, parents, delivery agents, architects — the faces behind march to Parliament

(From left) Ranjan, Amit, Nitin, Ujay, Dushyant, Abhay, and Deepa's family from Delhi's Shahdara. EXPRESS

Drishti Jain & Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 20

LONG BEFORE the first police barricade was pushed by a protester or the first tear gas shell was fired by a security personnel, Jantar Mantar saw people from various walks of life – students, parents, teachers and young professionals — gathering to take part in the march towards the Parliament.

By 9 am, many from across the country had arrived for the Cockroach Janta Party's march, seeking Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation. Around them, Delhi Police personnel stood guard, with barricades sealing off the roads leading out of Jantar Mantar.

The core team of CJP was still in talks with the police near the stage to be allowed to hold the march.

The permission never came.

On Sunday only, the Delhi Police had said that CJP had neither received permission to continue their protest at Jantar Mantar nor sought approval to hold a march to the Parliament.

However, this did not deter the protesters who came from all over the country.

Among the first to arrive was Deepa (42) from Delhi's Shahdara. She reached Jantar Mantar with her husband and three children around 6.30 am.

"I have two children studying in classes 10 and 12 in government schools. Their future is also at stake. We want a change in the education system so that both rich and poor children get equal opportunity to study, with the same resources... Only then there can be a change," she said.

Her husband Prahlad (46) added, "We are ready to even wait until evening for the police permission... If we were afraid, why would we have come here."

Their son, who is preparing for the IIT-JEE examination, said his elder sister is volunteering at the Jantar Mantar protest site. "She tells us how the crowd has been increasing every night."

Nearby, three strangers – an actor from Mumbai and architects from Jaipur and Delhi – who had met only that morning waited for the march to begin.

Ujay, an actor and teacher from Mumbai, said he had first come across the protest on Instagram. "I wasn't fully aware of the issue initially but then I spoke to my friends... They were not in favour of asking a minister to resign. But I think it is actually a good idea to take responsibility if something has happened under your nose. Otherwise, such things will keep happening," he said.

The heavy police deployment, however, made him uneasy. "It is really nice that so many people have turned up, but also it is scary to see such heavy security. Their primary duty is to ensure the security of the people..."

Standing next to him, the architect from Delhi, Abhay, wondered why police permission was needed in the first place to march to the Parliament. "Why do we need permission to protest and that too from the ones we are protesting against. It is our basic right to protest."

Dushyant, a 40-year-old architect who had travelled from Jaipur, said he admired the young protesters.

"They are asking questions my generation didn't. They are questioning why we need permission to protest, which is our constitutional right. Even if permission isn't granted, at least we should show up and be counted," he said.

Apprehending a police crackdown, Dushyant added, "Many of us have come here knowing that things might go wrong, but for how long we can sit quietly knowing that the system is rotten."

Nineteen-year-old Blinkit delivery agents Nitin and Anil, along with their colleague Ranjan, had travelled from Bareilly in Uttar Pradesh. They had to leave school to earn a livelihood.

"We are here because 20 students have died because of the NEET paper leak. We are demanding the resignation of the education minister so that this is not repeated in the future... Our lives are very uncertain because we drive the whole day, delivering goods to people... we know how important a person's life is," Ranjan said.

(From top) Protesters atop a police vehicle shout slogans; people take part in the march; police use teargas to control the swelling crowd on Monday. ABHINAV SAHA, AMIT MEHRA & PRAVEEN KHANNA

(Above) Protesters clash with security personnel; (left) police detain some; (below) officers resort to lathicharge to manage the crowd. ABHINAV SAHA & PRAVEEN KHANNA

● PROTEST LOST PACE BRIEFLY DUE TO POLICE ACTION — BEFORE GATHERING MOMENTUM AGAIN

Crowds disperse, stage dismantled at Jantar Mantar protest site after a day of clash

Devansh Mittal & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 20

BEFORE 3 pm on Monday, the police and protesters — who gathered at Jantar Mantar to take part in a march led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) to Parliament — had locked horns. While protesters tried, and at a few places, managed to cross the barricades erected to stop them from reaching Parliament, officers went all out to manage the crowd and control the chaos.

The protesters at the intersection of Ashoka Road and Sansad Marg were those who almost made it. They were merely 700 metres away from Parliament when they were met with resistance from the police and paramilitary forces.

The hours that followed witnessed security personnel resorting to lathicharge and firing teargas shells — actions that seemed enough to at least slow down the pace the protest had picked up since morning. Officers even chased the protesters down Sansad Marg, with some of them entering Jantar Mantar from Tolstoy Marg and others fleeing towards the Outer Circle of Connaught Place. The crackdown led to the dispersal of crowds throughout Connaught Place and in some areas of the Lutyens' Delhi. Police officers also reached the protest site at Jantar Mantar and asked protesters to vacate the area. Officers also climbed on the stage and asked organisers to get down. In a matter of around 10 minutes, the entire protest site was emptied, the stage dismantled. The protest, however, gathered pace soon again. Lutyen's Delhi subsequently witnessed a complete shutdown. Vehicles struggled to make their way and the people started getting stranded as protesters filled the roads surrounding Parliament. By evening, as police tried to disperse protesters, many started charging at the officers. While protesters were seen hurling shoes, bottles and stones at the police, the latter retaliated with teargas and force. Shutting down Lutyens' Delhi, police said, was not what they were ready for, with the Monsoon Session of Parliament in progress.

The late evening hours saw the protest enter the heart of the city. At Connaught Place, there was vandalism, stone pelting and violence. Over a dozen vehicles were damaged.

Shoes, belongings lie on the road; (left) the dismantled stage at the protest site in Jantar Mantar. PRAVEEN KHANNA & GAJENDRA YADAV

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

DRM/TRD, North Western Railway, Jodhpur for & on behalf of the president of India, invites E-tender for the following work. **1. Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website Address: http://www.ireps.gov.in 2. Date & time of closing of e-tender: 10.08.2026** up to 15.00 hrs. **3. Date & time of opening of e-tender:** After 15.00 hrs. on **10.08.2026. Tender Notice No.:** GSU-ELECT-JU-01-2026-27. **Name of work :** TRD work in c/w proposed New Block station along with development of Goods shed at MANKALAV station of JU division and augmentation of DEMU maintenance facilities at DEMU shed Merta Road. **Approx. Cost of the work (Rs.) :** ₹43645457.00 For detailed information, visit https://www.ireps.gov.in

1046-MG/26

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TENDER NOTICE (E-Tendering Mode Only)

Bid Reference	**Tender No. CON/AII/TANK CONT/DEV/2026**
Tendered Quantity & Description	Design, manufacturing, testing & Supply of 900 numbers 20 feet High Cube (20'x8'x 9'6") Pneumatic Type steel Tank containers, 36000 kgs Gross weight & Minimum Pay load capacity 31000 kgs with effective loading volume 25000 litres (Minimum)
Estimated Cost	₹ 84,84,31,800/-(Inclusive all) Rs. Eighty four crores eighty four Lakhs thirty one thousand eight hundred only
Bid Security (Earnest Money) Deposit	**Rs 10,00,000/-** Rs Ten Lakh only
Cost of Document	₹ 1,120 through online payment gateway to CONCOR
Tender processing fee (Non-refundable)	**Rs. 3540/-** (inclusive of 18% GST)through online payment gateway to CONCOR
Period of Tender Sale (online)	21/07/2026 from 12:00 Hrs to 20/08/2026 upto 16:00 hrs
Last Date and time Submission of Bid	20/08/2026 upto 17:30 Hrs
Date and time of opening of Bid	**21/08/2026 at 14:30 Hrs**
Pre-bid Meeting	Through Hybrid mode Physical & Video Conference on 03/08/2026 at 03:00 hrs.For sharing the link please send mail on EMAIL ID :- a2container@concorindia.com upto 11:00 hrs of 03/08/2026 Hrs
Place Opening/ Communication Address	MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Industrial Estate, NSIC Okhla Metro Station, New Delhi – 110020

For financial eligibility criteria, experience with respect to similar nature of work and other details, please refer to detailed tender notice available on website www.concorindia.co.in, but the complete tender document can be downloaded from website www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL only. Further, Corrigendum/ Addendum to this tender, if any, will be published on website www.concorindia.co.in; www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL and Central Procurement Portal only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same. **Group General Manager/P&S/A-II, Phone No.: 011-41222500 Ext: 925, 698**

office of Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad

Short Term E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tender

No.- 4229/Nivida-Moradabad/25-26 Dated:-14-07-2026

On behalf of the Governor of UP, tender for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** from registered contractors In column No-8 from 23-07-2026 at 10.00 am to 28-07-2026 at 12:00 pm. Amount mentioned in column no. 5 & 7 shall be mandatory deposited by Net Banking Only through E-tender portal. Technical bid/Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 28-07-2026 at 12.30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/ bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.

SI No.	DISTERICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in lacs)	Bid Secutiry (Rs. in lacs)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST (Rs.)	Category of road contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Urgency of the work short term tender for the following work is invited in anticipation of acceptance.							
1.	MBD	Rain water harvesting work in Officeres Colony, DM Compound, Sonakpur Rangoli Colony and Sonakpur Transit Hostel in Moradabad District.	79.61	5.99	02 Month	300+2000 + 54=2354	A,B (Bulding category)

Rules/conditions & details of the tender are available at website **http://etender.up.nic.in.** Bidder have to login Prahari URL **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari/** and upload their documents As per G.O No.-879 (1)/23-7-2020 dated 25-08-2020 and E-IN-C (Vikas) and Head of Department letter-4650/4NL-0C /2020 dated 27.08.2020.

UPID-253910 Date 20/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Kuldeep Sant)
Executive Engineer
Provincial Division, PWD
Moradabad

(S.P. Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, PWD
Moradabad
For and on behalf of Governor of UP

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
RAMPUR CIRCLE, P.W.D. RAMPUR

E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

Ref.No. 3878 /E-Nivida-RampurCir./26-27 **Dated :- 04-07-2026**

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work on Percentage rates invited by the Superintending Engineer, Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur online on website http://etender.up.nic.in from registered contractors (Category as per below table) from date 27.07.2026 at 10.00 am to 04.08.2026 at 12.00 pm. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 04.08.2026 at 12.30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.

2. Details of the works are following:

S. No	DIST RICT	Name of Work	Estimated Cost Excl. GST (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh (only by Net bankin)	Cost of Bid Document (only by Net banking accepted)	Time of Completion (including rainy season)	Category of road contractor eligible	Address of Executive Engineer of the Executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	Rampur	GSB, WMM, Interlocking & Divider works as part of the remaining works for the one-time improvement and maintenance of Old NH-24 (Rampur city Portion).	461.00	25.05	2354.00	3 Months	Road Category A	Construction Division, W.D. Rampur	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Mradabad
2	Rampur	Road signage work on one-time improvement and maintenance of the old NH-24(Rampur city Portion).	75.18	5.76	2354.00	6 Months	Road Category A&B			

➤ All work including 02 years maintenance period after completion of work.
➤ The Rates adopted in the BOQ are including all other taxes but excluding GST.
➤ The Bid Security and tender cost should be deposited online through Net Banking.
➤ Additional Security will be payable (as per rule at the time of Agreement) according to G.O. No 86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 23-05-2026

All terms & conditions can be seen on website http://etender.up.nic.in The bidder have to login on Prahari URL http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari to upload required documents as per Government order no. 14/2020/879/तेईस-7-2020-176(सा0)/06 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 28.08.2020, Government order879(1)/तेईस-7-2020-176(सा0)/06 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 25.08.2020&E.N.C./H.O.D.'s uppwd letter No.417/13रो0ए0मे0या0/20 दिनांक 28.08.2020

(Er. Gaurav Singh)
Executive Engineer
Cons.Div.PWD, Rampur
Email- cdrampur@gmail.com

UPID-253901 Date 20/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Er. Sanjay Jayant)
Superintending Engineer
Rampur Circle, PWD, Rampur
Email- pwdrampur@gmail.com

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender through E-Tendering

CWM/Carriage & Wagon workshop North western railway Bikaner acting for and on behalf of the president of India invites E-Tender No. **01-ENGG-BKNWS-2026**. **1. Name of work and its location:** Improvement and Up gradation of Existing Infrastructure Facilities at various sections of Bikaner Workshop including Pathway Extension for Traverser, Water Supply System, staffroom, Canteen and other Miscellaneous Works under ADEN/ Workshop/Bikaner. **2. Estimated Cost of work:** Rs. 2,24,50,979.50 (Inclusive of GST). **3. Earnest money:** Rs. 44,9000.00. **4. Last Date and time for submission and opening of E-tender:** 10.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. E-Tender will be opened at 15:30 Hrs. on same day. **5. Website particular where complete details of e-tender can be seen: www.ireps.gov.in** **1048-MG/26**

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE
No. ELS-SRE-26-27-T-2 Dtd. 18.07.2026

Open tender through E-tendering are invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRS, Electric Loco Shed, Khanalampura Yard, Northern Railway, Saharanpur (Ambala Division) for and on behalf of the President of India from the registered tenderer on website **www.ireps.gov.in** for the following work upto 11:00 hrs on the date of closing shown against the work and will be opened thereafter:-

Open Tender No.	**ELS-SRE-26-27-T-2**		
Name of Work	Installation of LED-Based Signal Exchange Control Units and Lamp Units, and repairing of hydraulic jacks at Electric Loco Shed Saharanpur.		
Date of Closing/Opening	12.08.2026	**Approx. Cost**	₹18,57,360/-
Earnest Money	₹37,200/-		
Completion period	Eighteen (18) Months	**Validity period**	60 days
Cost of tender form	'Free of Cost' for downloading from IREPS & ₹2000 for obtaining from Sr. DEE/TRS/SRE office.		

1. Tenderer(s) should have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate to participate in E-Tendering of Works Tenders.
2. Tenderer are required to upload self-attested scanned copies of all related eligibility documents as per conditions.
3. Taxes & Charges will be applicable as per extant rule.
4. For details, please log on IREPS website **www.ireps.gov.in** **2486/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

DRM / TRD, North Western Railway, Jodhpur for & on behalf of the president of India, invites E-tender for the following work. **Tender No.:** GSU-ELECT-JU-02-2026-27. **Name of work:** TRD work in c/w (a) proposed New Block station between SBLT-OCH (b) proposed New Block station between THM-JCH in RKB-JSM (c) 02 running lines cover shed & Catwalk on both pit line at Jaisalmer station (d) additional new platform new platform no. 4&5, extension of existing FOB & Second entry at Jaisalmer station. **Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 77215888.00. **Date & time of closing of e-tender: 12.08.2026** up to **15.00** hrs. **Date & time of opening of e-tender:** After **15.00** hrs. on **12.08.2026. Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website Address: https://www.ireps.gov.in** **1049-MG/26**

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NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER NOTICE
(Throughe e-Tender)

On the behalf of President of India e- Tenders are invited by the Sr. DMM/ DSD/NWR, Jodhpur. **1. Name of item: E-tender Notice No:- 33255546A** CPM 401 as per EMD PT NO.40104546 specn: BLW PT NO.18120878 as per attached DRG. **2. Approximate Cost of items:** RS. 6490000.00 (Rs. Sixty Four Lakh Ninety Thousand Rupees Only). **3. Earnest Money to be deposited:** Rs. 129800.00 (Rs. One Lakh Twenty Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees Only). **4. Last date and time for Submission of E-Tender Opening of E-Tender:** 17/08/2026, 14:25. **5. Web site from E-Tender forms can be obtained: www.ireps.gov.in** **1043**

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NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Divl. Rly. Manager, N.W.Rly. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works **up to 15.00 hours on 10.08.2026** as below:- **Tender No.:** 108. **Name of Work with its Location:** Upgradation of branches for staff working (6 branches) and Officer chambers, miscellaneous works in c/w Provision of Air Conditioner unit and provision of hall with attached toilet for retired railway employees in DRM office, Bikaner under ADEN/HQ/ Bikaner. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 46376549.91. **Earnest money Rs.:** Rs. 927500.00. **Note:-** Other term & condition will be shown on N.W.Rly. website www.ireps.gov.in. **1047-MG/26**

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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Kalu @ Kamal S/o Sh. Virender R/o Jhuggi No.20, Kalkatiya Gate, Jaat Fauzi, Dharamshala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 113/2014 U/s 324 IPC at PS: Kashmiri Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kalu @ Kamal** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kalu @ Kamal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kalu @ Kamal of FIR No. 113/2014 U/s 324 IPC of PS: Kashmiri Gate, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 30.09.2026.**

By order
Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
(Central), Room No.138,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9729/N/2026

NPCL
Noida Power Company Limited

Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

TENDER NOTICE Date: 21-07-2026

E Tender (Commercial & Technical) are invited for following job from all interested bidders:

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs.)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NPCL/FY26-27/SS/016	Construction of Three (3) Nos. 33/11kV Electric Substation Building Greater Noida	6.5 Lac	21.07.2026 TO 14.08.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website
www.noidapower.com-->Procurement-->Tenders **DGM (CMM)**

बिहार सरकार
बिहार तकनीकी सेवा आयोग,

19, हार्डिंग रोड, पटना–800001

आवश्यक सूचना

PR.NO.-20708 (B & C) 2024-25

विज्ञापन सं०–03/2025 (शल्य कक्ष सहायक)

स्वास्थ्य विभाग, बिहार, पटना के अन्तर्गत **शल्य कक्ष सहायक** के पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु प्रकाशित विज्ञापन सं०–03/2025 का अंतिम परीक्षाफल का प्रकाशन कर दिया गया है, जिसे आयोग के **Website- www.btsc.bihar.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।

उक्त सूचना **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

अपर सचिव,
बिहार तकनीकी सेवा आयोग, पटना

PR. No. 008275 (B & C) 2026 - 27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

Employees' State Insurance Corporation

Medical College and Hospital, Naroda-Bapunagar
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India)
Nr. Hansdarpan Police Chowky, Rajivnagar, Bapunagar, Ahmedabad, Gujarat-380024
Phone: 91 9428266450 Email: dean-naroda.gj@esic.gov.in • Website: www.esic.gov.in

SHORT NOTICE NO. 03 (ADVERTISEMENT NO. 01/2026)

WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR RECRUITMENT OF SENIOR RESIDENTS (SRs) ON CONTRACT BASIS

A Walk-in-Interview will be held on 23.07.2026 (Thursday) in the Chamber of the Dean, ESIC Medical College and Hospital, Naroda-Bapunagar, Ahmedabad, for the recruitment of Senior Residents (SRs) on a contractual basis.

Department wise reserved vacancy of Senior Resident

Sr.	Department	Vacancy	Reserve for Category	Sr.	Department	Vacancy	Reserve for Category
1	Anesthesiology	3	SC, OBC, ST	7	Microbiology	1	ST
2	Forensic Medicine & Toxicology	1	SC	8	Nephrology	1	EWS
				9	NICU	1	OBC
3	General Medicine	2	ST, UR	10	Pharmacology	1	OBC
4	General Surgery	2	OBC, UR	11	PICU	3	EWS, UR, ST
5	ICU	3	SC, OBC, UR	12	Radiology (Radiodiagnosis)	1	OBC
6	Medical Oncology	1	OBC				
Total: 20 Vacancy				4-UR, 2-EWS, 7-OBC, 3-SC, 4-ST			
1-Vacancy is reserved for PwBD Candidate							

* For more details please visit the official ESIC websites for the detailed advertisement, vacancy positions, and eligibility criteria.
(1) **www.esic.gov.in/recruitments** (2) **www.bapunagarhospital.esic.gov.in/recruitments**
* Candidates are advised to visit the websites regularly to check the schedule, terms, and conditions.

Sd/-
Dean

Govt. of Bihar

Office of The Principal
Government Engineering College, Bhojpur, Ara
South East Ramna Road, Near Maharaja College
(Under Department of Science, Technology & Technical Education Patna, Govt. of Bihar)
Email-Id-gecbhojpur@gmail.com
Website-gecbhojpur.org

WALK-IN-ENTERVIEW FOR GUEST ASSISTANT PROFESSOR
Advt. No.- GEC/Bhojpur/Adv/2026-27/02

Sr. No.	Post	Subject/ Department	Academic qualification and Experience	Date and time of Interview	walk-in-interview Venue
1.	Guest Assistant Professor	Management	As per AICTE/DSTTE Norms	03.08.2026	Government Engineering College, South-East Ramna Road, Near Maharaja College, Bhojpur, Ara

Important Instruction: -

1. This engagement will be purely temporary, and remuneration based.
2. Remuneration for Guest Assistant Professor will be as per existing rules and directives of DSTTE, Government of Bihar.
3. The Institute reserves the right to withdraw the partial or full advertisement notification w.r.t walk-in-interview without assigning any reason.
4. The services of Guest Assistant Professor will be terminated without notice if found unsatisfactory. No claim will be entertained in this regard.
5. No TA/DA will be paid for attending the Interview.
6. Reservation as per existing state government rules.

For further details please visit website www.gecbhojpur.org
For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

Principal,
Government Engineering College,
Bhojpur (Ara)

PR. No. 008097 (Sci. & Tech.) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

C78/05/NFR/Leasing/2026 दिनांक: 15.07.2026

अजमेर मण्डल के विभिन्न स्टेशनों पर **PARKING, SLR LEASING, CATERING, PAY AND USE, OUT OF HOME, MOBILE ASSET, RDN (DIGITAL) ATM, CLOAK ROOM, DIGITAL DISPLAY SYSTEM** के ठेके के लिये ई–ऑक्शन/कोटेशन आमंत्रित सूचना:-

Sr. No.	Assets	Particular	e-Auction Notice Date
1.	Catering	General Miner Unit (GMU) at SOMESAR Station	23.07.2026
		Special Miner Unit (SMU) at SOMESAR Station	23.07.2026
2.	Multi-Purpose Stall	Multi-Purpose Stall (MPS) at SHAMLJI ROAD Station	24.07.2026
		Multi Purpose Stall (MPS) at SOMESAR Station	24.07.2026
3.	Parking	Parking Lot for Two Wheelers at location FOB Ajmer	27.07.2026
		Parking Lot for Two Wheelers, Three Wheelers and Four Wheelers at location MJ 2nd Entry.	27.07.2026
		Parking Lot for Two Wheelers, Three Wheelers and Four Wheelers at location Rani Main Entry Gate	27.07.2026
		Ground floor and First floor area LC 48 AT AJMER STATION NEAR KATCHARI ROAD AJMER	27.07.2026
4.	Parcel Space in SLR Coach	Parcel Space in SLR Coach (Single Compartment) 12978 (MARU SAGAR EXP) FSLR, 19625 (AII-BDTS) FSLR, 20991(AII-DD) FSLR, 20994(UDZ-JP) FSLR, 19615(UDZ-KYQ) FSLR, 19601(UDZ-NJP) FSLR, 12396(AII-RJPB) FSLR, 12396(AII-RJPB) RSLR, 19623(MDJN-DBG) FSLR, 12996(AII-BDTS) FSLR	27.07.2026
5.	Parcel Space in Parcel Van	Parcel Space in Parcel Van VPU of train No. 19601/19602 on round trip basis, ex. UDZ on Saturday and ex. NIP on Monday.	27.07.2026
		Parcel Space in Parcel Van 19603-19604 (DOZ-GODA) VPU	27.07.2026
6.	Food Truck	Contract for Setting Up, Operation and Maintenance of Food Truck (as per attached map) at Falna (FA) Railway Station	29.07.2026
7.	Parcel Space in SLR Coach	Parcel Space in SLR Coach (Single Compartment) 20824(AII-PURI) FSLR, 20987-20988/UDZ-ASV) VPU	29.07.2026
8.	Multi-Purpose Stall	Multi-Purpose Stall (MPS) at ABU ROAD station (ABR-13) on Platform No. 02/03	29.07.2026
		Multi-Purpose Stall (MPS) at ABU ROAD station (ABR-12) on Platform No.1	29.07.2026
9.	Cloak Room	Management and Operation of Cloak Room Service at Udaipur city Railway Station	29.07.2026
10.	REST ROOMS	Contract for Upgradation, Round the clock Operation and Maintenance of 05 REST ROOMS situated at 1st floor of Bhilwara station building towards PF-01	30.07.2026
11.	Dormitory	Contract for Upgradation, Operation and Maintenance of Dormitory Space at Beawar Railway Station (PF No. 01)	30.07.2026
12.	Kiosk	Contract for Setting Up, Operation, and Maintenance of Traveler Help & Information (Promotional) Kiosk at RANAPRATAP NAGAR Railway station	30.07.2026
		Contract for Setting Up & Operation of PHOTOCOPIER KIOSK (as per attached map) at RANAPRATAP NAGAR (RPZ) Railway Station	30.07.2026
13.	Food Truck	Contract for Setting Up, Operation and Maintenance of Food Truck (as per attached map) at RANAPRATAP NAGAR (RPZ) Railway Station	30.07.2026
14.	Parcel Space in SLR Coach	Parcel Space in SLR Coach (Single Compartment) 20971(UDZ-SHM) FSLR, 12990 (AII-DDR) FSLR, 19603 (DOZ-GODA) FSLR, 18208(AII-DURG) FSLR	30.07.2026
15.	Dormitory	Contract for Upgradation, Operation/ Manning and Maintenance of Dormitory Space at Marwar Junction	31.07.2026
16.	Parcel Space in SLR Coach	Parcel Space in SLR Coach (Single Compartment) 12316(UDZ-KOAA) FSLR	31.07.2026
17.	Salon services kiosk	Contract for Setting Up, Operation, and Maintenance of Salon services kiosk at Falna (FA) Railway station	31.07.2026
18.	Kiosks	Contract for Setting-up, Operation and Maintenance of a Cluster of Three (03) Mobile & Laptop Accessories Kiosks at Bhilwara Railway Station.	31.07.2026
		Contract for Setting Up, Operation, and Maintenance of Grocery and Traveler Help & Information Kiosk at Sumerpur-jawaibandh (SJWB) Railway station	31.07.2026

वेबसाइट जहां से लोट वाईज ई–ऑक्शन प्रारम्भ होने के समय एवं अन्य जानकारी प्राप्त की जा सकती है। www.ireps.gov.in

1044-MG/26 वरिष्ठ मंडल प्रबंधक अजमेर

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

(E-Auction Notice)

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS **(https://ireps.gov.in/)** for allotment of contracts of Water Vending Machines (WVMs) at following railway stations/locations:

Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Cluster No.	No. of WVMs at Railway Stations
CTG-WVM-05-2026	03.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs	D	Total 07 WVMs (03 WVMs at Panipat, 02 WVMs at Samalkha and 02 WVMs Bhodwal Majri Railway Station).
		F	Total 06 WVMs (03 WVMs at Kurukshetra, 02 WVMs at Karnal and 01 WVM at Shahbad Marknda Railway Station).
		E	Total 06 WVMs (02 WVMs at Badli, 02 WVMs at Ganaur and 02 WVMs at Sonipat Railway Station).
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen			**https://ireps.gov.in/ (E-Auction-Leasing)**

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

➤ Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module - Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module.
➤ Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details.
➤ A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.
➤ The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
➤ Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	**Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055, Email: catering.delhidivision@gmail.com, Tel: 011-23743084.**

No. 23 AC/Ctg./e-Auction/WVM/2026 Dated: 20.07.2026 **2493/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PUNE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Chief Engineer (Project) Department

Online Sale of Tenders- 21/07/2026 to 11/08/2026 up to 03:00 PM
Last date of submission of tenders: 11/08/2026 at 03:00 PM
Pre Bid- Meeting Date : 28/07/2026 at 11.00 AM
Date of opening of Tenders: 12/08/2026 at 03.00 PM

Sr No.	Tender No/	Name of Work	Total Project Cost incl. GST, Royalty and Testing charges (Rs.)	Tender Amount (Exluding GST, Tender Royalty, Testibg Charges)	(18%) GST Rs	Rs Royalty	Material Testing Charges Rs	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.) 0.50%	Security Deposit (5%)	Time Limit in Calendar months including monsoon	Defect Liability Period	Cost of Tender Document RS.	All the documents are attached to online tender	Tender Type	Contact Persons
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
1	Pmc/ Chief Eng. (Project)/ 29 2026	Construction of Flyover/ROB from Sugar Complex to Old Pune Mumbai Road	73,51,69,250/-	61,89,20,578/-	11,14,05,704/-	41,82,233/-	6,60,735/-	30,95,000/-	3,09,47,000/-	24 Months	As per Tender Conditions	59,179/-	YES	New Tender	Ms. Mayuri Shinde (Jr.Engineer) 7447472701

A. This tender will be implemented as per LUMP-SUM And B-1 type
B. Detailed terms/conditions for the tendered works are mentioned in the tender set and the tender set for this work is published on the website www.mahatenders.gov.in.
C. Complete information about online tendering process is available at The office of Chief Engineer (Projects), 3rd Floor, Main Building, Pune Municipal Corporation, Shivajinagar, Pune -05.
D. EMD amount will be accepted only through ECS/RTGS/NEFT facility.
E. It will be sole responsibility of the tenderer if the tender set is not downloaded or submitted at the last moment.
F. Pre-Bid meeting will be conducted on Friday dt. 28/07/2026 at 11.00 AM. in The Office of Municipal Commissioner, Pune Municipal Corporation, Shivajinagar, Pune 411005.

जाहिरात क्र. 3/406 दि. 20/07/26

Sd/- (Dinakar Gojare)
Chief Engineer (Projects)
Pune Municipal Corporation

जीविका JEEVIKA

बिहार सरकार

ग्रामीण विकास विभाग

विकसित भारत-समृद्ध बिहार

श्री सम्राट चौधरी

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

के कर-कमलों द्वारा

बिहार ग्रामीण जीविकोपार्जन प्रोत्साहन समिति (जीविका)

अंतर्गत

नव चयनित 2446 अभ्यर्थियों का

नियुक्ति-पत्र वितरण कार्यक्रम

विशिष्ट अतिथि

श्री विजय कुमार चौधरी
माननीय उप मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

श्री बिजेंद्र प्रसाद यादव
माननीय उप मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

अध्यक्षता

श्री श्रवण कुमार
माननीय मंत्री, ग्रामीण विकास विभाग

PR No.- 008257 (RDD)D. 2026-27

दिनांक : 21 जुलाई, 2026 | समय : 12.30 बजे अपराह्न | स्थान : ऊर्जा ऑडिटोरियम, पटना

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Lead by Example

SAMAJWADI PARTY MP Dimple Yadav won the hearts of students as well as her party MPs with her caring approach towards the injured protesters at Jantar Mantar. The SP MPs accompanying her to the protest site were in awe of the way Dimple cared for the injured, giving them water and offering a helping hand. Some SP MPs were of the opinion that the party delegation had done its job and should return to Parliament, but Dimple was adamant on marching with the protesters. Some of the MPs were heard praising how she had won the respect of all by showing great resolve and taking the situation "head on".

Purnea MP Pappu Yadav on Parliament premises. ANI

Clad in Cause

WHILE THE Opposition sought to raise multiple issues, ranging from the plight of farmers in southern India to the NEET paper leak, in the Lok Sabha on the first day of the Monsoon Session, Independent Lok Sabha MP Pappu Yadav alias Rajesh Ranjan managed to convey his concerns without raising his voice as his outfit did the talking for him. The Purnea MP wore an overall with questions on the alleged donation theft at the Ram Temple and the paper leak issue. With statements such as "*Chanda Chori Par Sarkar Kyun Maun?*" and "NTA *Ka Brashtachar Band Karo*", Yadav demanded accountability from the government.

Fresh Start

AS MPs made their way to their seats in Rajya Sabha for Monday morning's proceedings, ministers and BJP MPs were seen welcoming ex-AAP and TMC members who joined the ruling party since the last session. From Opposition rows, these MPs were moved to the Treasury Benches. Former AAP MP Raghav Chadha, now seated in the third row of the Treasury Benches, could be seen shaking hands with Petroleum Minister Hardeep Puri. Ex-TMC MP Sushmita Dev, re-elected to Rajya Sabha on BJP ticket three days ago, was also welcomed to her new seat by her colleagues.

NEET-UG, RAM TEMPLE DONATION 'THEFT' DISRUPT PROCEEDINGS

Protests find echo in both LS, RS as Monsoon Session begins

Jatin Anand, Damini Nath & Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 20

THE PROTESTS led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) dominated Parliament on the first day of the Monsoon Session on Monday — both inside and outside.

As the protesters, demanding the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET-UG paper leak, made their way to Parliament, the gates were closed for some time in the afternoon.

While security was stepped up, including personnel in riot gear, mobile phone jammers were deployed in the area through the day, extending the Internet shutdown for the protest to Parliament House as well.

Riot control vehicles were parked outside the premises, and the sound of teargas shells being fired a few hundred metres away could be heard inside — including when PM Narendra Modi was leaving the House. Sources said Modi, who was in the Lok Sabha when proceedings began, was present in the premises when there was "some ruckus" from the Rail Bhawan side, which leads to the South Utility Gate of Parliament.

Sources in the CISF, responsible for Parliament security, told *The Indian Express* that the crowd of protesters had swelled beyond their expectations. A senior officer said they had expected about 5,000 protesters, but at least 12,000 were estimated to have gathered for the march from Jantar Mantar.

Cockroach Janta Party supporters raise slogans near Parliament on Monday. PTI

Inside Parliament, the demand for Pradhan's resignation found an echo in both Houses, despite attempts by senior BJP leaders deputed for floor management to reach out to Opposition parties like SP and DMK.

Raising the issue in Rajya Sabha, Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge said the government was trying to suppress the protesters. The House saw multiple adjournments, as the Opposition members raised slogans in favour of protesting students and criticised the police action. They also raised slogans against the alleged donation theft at the Ram Mandir.

The two issues — NEET-UG paper leak and the alleged Ram temple donation theft — disrupted proceedings in the Lok Sabha too, forcing the House to wrap up for the day after multiple adjournments.

An RS member of the ruling alliance told *The Indian Express*: "There are issues, but it doesn't appear government will give in to specific demands being made by the protesters. As far as our agenda goes, the delimitation Bill remains our key priority."

A senior BJP leader said the demands raised were "devoid of merit". Questioning the seriousness of the movement, he said: "Where is their leadership, where is the structure of this movement? ... it is a matter of a few days. This will settle down."

Meanwhile, TMC's RS MP Sagarika Ghose said: "I was told there were protests outside but I could not leave the premises. I think jammers were on. I tried to leave and join the protest but the roads were blocked."

When LS reassembled at 2 pm, several Opposition members were heard complaining about the closing of the entry gate of the Parliament House. BJP's Jagdambika Pal, who was in the chair, said: "*Kisi bhi sansad ko kisi bhi gate par roka nahin jaa raha hai.* (No MP is being stopped at any gate)."

Pal also rejected the Opposition members' complaint that there was no quorum in the House. Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the Opposition members are not allowing the House to function. Pal urged the MPs not to show placards, before adjourning the House until 2.30 pm.

When the House resumed, Pal said the House could not take up Zero Hour, now at least the members should be allowed to raise their issues under Rule 377. When the din continued, Pal adjourned the House until 3 pm. Thereafter, the House was adjourned for the day.

In RS, Chairman C P Radhakrishnan adjourned the House soon after Opposition MPs started sloganeering over paper leak and temple donation "theft". Kharge raised the issue of students being lathi-charged. Opposition MPs continued sloganeering, leading to multiple adjournments. Both Houses could not transact any legislative business and were adjourned about half a dozen times before rising for the day at 3 pm.

PM Narendra Modi being greeted by Union Ministers Kiren Rijiju, Jitender Singh, Arjun Ram Meghwal and L Murugan. ANIL SHARMA

Hope arguments & facts get respect, constructive spirit necessary, says PM

'56-year-old young man': Modi takes veiled dig at Rahul

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, July 20

EMPHASISING THE country's GDP growth despite the pressures on oil and fertilisers arising out of the West Asia crisis, the first private orbital rocket launch and India's first hydrogen-powered train, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Monday that the Monsoon Session is starting at a time when the country has gathered speed and the spirit of Parliament can infuse it with new energy.

Addressing reporters in Parliament complex, PM Modi said, "There is no need for a storm where arguments and facts are there. I hope that facts and arguments, and every voice get an opportunity and respect."

"This Monsoon Session is beginning at a time when the country has gathered speed. The spirit of Parliament can infuse it with new energy. Constructive spirit is necessary to achieve the goals of the country," he said.

"Our country has many experienced MPs — whichever party they may belong to. Parliament and the country need their experience and knowledge," the PM said.

"For this, it's important that Parliament functions, there is constructive discussion... This is the need of the hour. The aspirational youth desire that we move forward. It's the need of the hour that voices of *Rashtrabhakti* (devotion to the nation) get a proper forum in Parliament."

Modi took a veiled dig at Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi while praising Hyderabad-based Skyroot Aerospace for developing and launching Vikram-1, making India the third country in the world to have private launch capability.

"The average age of the whole team of Skyroot start-up is 28," Modi said. However, he added, "I am not talking about a 56-year-old young man. I am talking about the youth who have planted India's flag in space."

Referring to the successful launch of Vikram-1 and satellites being put in precise orbits, he said, "This is a message that the ability and aspiration of our youth is limitless like space. The country has boarded the reform express — that is why Indian youth are able to do such things."

"We now have a train running on green hydrogen — very few countries can do this. Our scientists, engineers, entrepreneurs and labourers who are working have made it possible," Modi said.

The PM stressed on India's resilience in the face of the West Asia crisis, which has sent ripples across economies. "Petrol, diesel, fertilizers came under crisis — but we still continued to grow at 7.7%, the fastest among major economies. This shows India's ability."

EXPRESS special

With CJP protest raging, a new Lok Sabha configuration: Split TMC, faultlines in Opp

On Day 1 of Monsoon Session, the changed political equations were reflected in House seating rejig

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 20

AS PARLIAMENT witnessed the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)'s protests outside its gates and the Opposition's sloganeering inside on Monday, the first day of the Monsoon Session, the clearest sign of the shifting political landscape came from those who chose not to protest.

Soon after the Lok Sabha assembled in the morning, the Opposition members streamed into the Well, raising slogans over the NEET paper leak and the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

But a group of 26 MPs remained rooted to their seats — the 20 rebel TMC MPs, who have "merged" with a little-known outfit NCPI, and the six Shiv Sena (UBT) members who now sit with the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena's MPs after joining its fold.

The contrast was especially striking in the TMC's case. Barely three months ago, the party had stood shoulder to shoulder with the Congress in opposing the 131st Constitution Amendment Bill — brought by the Narendra Modi government to expedite the roll-out of the women quota law along with the Delimitation Bill — and helping the Opposition INDIA bloc to defeat the legislation in the Lok Sabha.

On Monday, however, while Mahua Moitra and a handful of other TMC MPs loyal to party founder Mamata Banerjee joined the Congress members in the Well, holding placards saying "Paper Leak, Stop NEET", veteran TMC leader Sudip Bandyopadhyay, now leader of the party's breakaway group, sat quietly through the proceedings with other rebels.

The changed political scenario was reflected by the House's seating plan. Over the weekend, Speaker Om Birla had rejigged the LS seating plan after acceding to the demand of rebel TMC MPs for a separate seating away from their parent party's members.

Bandyopadhyay now occupied the front-row seat in the third Opposition block, which had earlier been allotted to TMC floor leader Abhishek Banerjee. He sat alongside SP chief Akhilesh Yadav and Faizabad MP Awadhesh Prasad. Other rebel TMC MPs were accommodated in adjoining block, with Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, who led the rebellion, seated in second row. The rest were dispersed behind her, interspersed with MPs of NDA allies JD(U) and LJP (RV).

Veteran TMC MP Saugata Roy also found himself in the same block, separated from the party rebels by only a few seats. Yet, despite repeated adjournments, there was no interaction between the two factions. Roy was seen during one such break in conversation with Union Minister Bhupender Yadav, at whose residence the rebel TMC MPs had gathered last month.

Rebel TMC MPs Saayoni Ghosh and June Maliah (above) arrive at Parliament on Monday. ANI

The new seating arrangement also produced one of the day's quieter ironies. Mahua had left her protest placards on the bench occupied by Dastidar. Every time the House reconvened, she would return to the seat, pick up the placards and march into the Well, with Dastidar remaining seated just a few feet away.

Bandyopadhyay, meanwhile, was seen interacting with several BJP leaders during the adjournments, underlining the altered political equations.

If the TMC split was the day's most visible political faultline on display in the Lower House, the Opposition's floor coordination also revealed subtle differences.

While Congress and DMK were among the first parties to enter the Well, they protested on different issues. Congress MPs sought to corner the government over NEET leak and the Ram temple donation "theft". DMK MPs raised slogans against Congress-led Karnataka government's decision to proceed with a dam on the Cauvery river.

This divergence came amid strained ties between Congress and DMK after the former joined hands with Vijay to help him form a government in Tamil Nadu. Yet, old political equations appeared not to have entirely frayed, with DMK leader Kanimozhi and Congress deputy leader Gaurav Gogoi engaged in animated conversations during the adjournments.

SP MPs raised issues like the NEET leak and the temple donation row, but did not join the Congress members in the Well.

NCP (SP) leader Supriya Sule, who has said her party would consider supporting the delimitation Bill if the government ensures a 50% increase in LS seats in all states, spent much of the day walking through the House, meeting the MPs across party lines while showing them something on a notepad.

Outside Parliament, as news spread that CJP protesters had "gheraoed" Parliament, security personnel temporarily shut all gates. The MPs were asked to stay inside until the protesters were dispersed.

At the centre of the Opposition's attacks was Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan whose resignation over the NEET leak has been a central demand of CJP. Pradhan entered the House shortly before noon and was immediately greeted with cries of "Istifa do". After another adjournment, Pradhan walked to Home Minister Amit Shah's office in Parliament, leaving from there only at the end of the day.

• IN THE HOUSE

I-T dept short of 26,997 officers, support staff

The Income Tax Department is running short of 26,997 officers and support staff as of January 1, 2026, MoS Finance, Pankaj Chaudhary, said in a written response to LS Monday. "The vacancies in Group A, B & C in Income Tax Department as on January 1, 2026, are 26,997. Occurrence and filling up of vacancies is a continuous process," Chaudhary said. Replying to another question, Chaudhary said 11 individuals have been declared as Fugitive Economic Offenders under the provisions of the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act, 2018 since 2024. Of them, extradition requests have been sent for four individuals, he said. PTI

Over 1.88 lakh ha of forest land diverted in 10 yrs

Between April 1, 2016 and March 31, 2026, an area of more than 1.88 lakh hectares of forest land had been diverted under the Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980, including industrial projects, Union MoS for Environment Kirti Vardhan Singh said in a written reply to a question Monday. He said that total forest & tree cover has increased to 8,27,357.95 sq km, according to the India State of Forest Report 2023. In a different written reply, Singh also told LS that for FY 2025-26, average time for environmental clearance was 57 days against statutory timelines of 105 days prescribed in EIA Notification, 2006. PTI

'We want to know why PM is so unwilling to change his Education Minister'

EXPRESS interview

GAURAV GOGOI
CONG DEPUTY LEADER IN LS

THE CJP protest march in the Capital had an impact on Parliament proceedings on Monday, with Opposition parties condemning the police crackdown and also demanding a discussion on the NEET paper leak and education sector reforms. Mobile phone network jammers were used on Parliament premises, drawing criticism from members who said they were not told about it.

Congress's Deputy Leader in Lok Sabha **Gaurav Gogoi** speaks to **Asad Rehman** on the day's events as well as the party's stance on CJP's protest.

The Congress has had a mixed response to the movement under the CJP banner. With everything that happened today, how does your party look at it now?

If you remember, since its (CJP) inception, (LoP) Rahul Gandhi has offered words of solidarity and has also championed the cause that has been raised (by the protesters), which is the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan and reform of the Indian education system.

What has happened today in terms of the brutal assault on young people on the streets of Delhi is condemnable and shocking. It could have been avoided had the Prime Minister shown leadership and sacked (Union Education Minister) Dharmendra Pradhan in the beginning, instead of making it an issue of ego or pride and being stubborn.

We saw the march to Parliament by youths today... Why has this kind of mobilisation not happened through any political platform, say the Congress or the INDIA bloc?

See, it is not a question of comparison. Many young people come to programmes of political parties. The turnout for the 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme of the Congress as well as the turnout for the protest that our youth and student wings have organised has been extremely impressive. Also, students or young people who feel comfortable in a platform that is not directly affiliated to a political party have grown in size, and today we saw a vast number. Therefore, it is more important that on the issue of reform in the Indian education system, society, young people and Opposition political parties are on the same page.

If anybody is being tone-deaf in this entire matter, it is the BJP government.

Some MPs complained that they were restricted within Parliament and the mobile network was jammed. What happened?

It was unfortunate that the parliamentarians were completely kept in the dark about the jamming of mobile networks. All of us noticed that we could not access news on social media, but we were not told about this decision to shut down the mobile networks. It was only when our fellow MPs were returning that we got to know the level of assault (on protesters) that was taking place. And suddenly we see that security guards are running from one part of the Parliament complex to the other. We were not at all briefed about what was going on.

And yet when we go inside Parliament and when we demand a discussion on this matter, the response that comes from the government is most nonchalant. It is most non-serious. The ministers of the Modi government seem to be smiling and laughing.

Were there any differences among the Opposition parties which had gathered for a meeting in Mallikarjun Kharge's chamber today?

What we discussed in the morning meeting was simply what had taken place over the last few days – in the Business Advisory Committee meeting and the all-party meeting. The Opposition parties were all united on key political issues.... Today we were very much aware that young people were gathering outside Parliament... We wanted to press the issue of students as well as ensure that the Ram Mandir (donation row), which is another important issue, is also raised.

What can we expect inside Parliament from Tuesday after what we've seen today?

Well, we can expect to see the Opposition continuing to press upon the government to take up the discussion on NEET. We want to know why the Prime Minister is so unwilling to change his Education Minister. We want to understand why PM Modi has such faith and confidence in Mr Pradhan, when the BJP is known to change their chief ministers three, four times in a state heading to elections.

And the longer they (government) continue to remain aloof and arrogant, the more damage they will have to suffer in the future.

In hot pursuit of smugglers, Gujarat forest officer killed in vehicle pile-up

Express News Service
Surat, July 20

Vikas Desai had joined the forest department 3 years ago

A RANGE Forest Officer (RFO) from Gujarat's Tapi district was killed in a crash involving multiple vehicles near a check post on Monday while chasing a suspected khair wood smuggler.

One of the two persons in the vehicle carrying the prohibited timber was also killed in the crash. The driver of the vehicle, Hitesh Vasava, was booked for rash and negligent driving and arrested late in the evening.

The catechu was allegedly being smuggled from a forest in Tapi to Navapur in Maharashtra, said a forest officer. Khair wood is used for making catechu (kattha) and used in traditional medicine.

The RFO, Vikas Desai, 32, and his staff had placed barricades on the main Ukai road at Songadh check post based on a tip off that a vehicle carrying khair wood smuggled from the forest would pass by, early Monday between 5 am and 6 am.

After spotting the vehicle loaded with khair wood, the forest department officials tried to flag it down, but the driver sped and broke the barricades and escaped. Police sources said Tapti Range RFO Vikas Desai immediately got into his car and chased the speeding vehicle while the other forest officials followed in the government jeeps behind. The alleged timber smuggler's speeding vehicle hit a parked trailer near Songadh check post, into which RFO Desai's car crashed.

Tapi Deputy Superintendent of Police Ishwar Parmar said: "The vehicle of the smugglers hit a parked container on the service road near the Songadh check post. The RFO's car hit the smuggler's vehicle from behind, leading to a triple accident. The driver of the vehicle carrying the smuggled logs escaped from the spot, while his aide, Rehan Gamit (23), died on the spot. The forest officials following the RFO car reached the spot and found RFO's in a mangled state, and Desai was lying motionless inside the car."

Desai, originally from Patan district, was cremated in Ahmedabad where his family comprising his wife, a five-year-old son and parents live.

He had joined the Forest Department three years back.

Tripura DGP found dead in his office, suicide suspected

Found hanging in washroom, says CM; Opp demands judicial probe

Debraj Deb
Agartala, July 20

Heightened security outside the Tripura Police Headquarters following the death of DGP Anurag Dhankar (left) in Agartala on Monday. PTI

TRIPURA DIRECTOR General of Police (DGP) Anurag Dhankar was found dead inside his office at the state police headquarters in Agartala on Monday, in what officials suspected to be a case of suicide. He was 60 years old.

Taking to social media after the incident, Chief Minister Manik Saha said the 1994-batch IPS officer was "found hanging in the washroom of his official chamber".

"I am deeply shocked and saddened by the tragic demise of Anurag, IPS, Director General of Police, Tripura, who was found hanging in the washroom of his official chamber today. Upon receiving the information, I, along with the Chief Secretary and Home Secretary, immediately visited the police headquarters. He was promptly shifted to AGMC & GBP (Agartala Government Medical College & Govind Ballabh Pant) Hospital, where the attending doctors, after examination, declared him 'brought dead'," the Chief Minister said.

"I extend my deepest condolences to the bereaved family during this hour of profound grief. May the departed soul rest in peace, and may the family find strength and courage to bear this irreparable loss," he added.

The head of the department of General Medicine at AGMC & GBP Hospital, Dr Pradip Bhowmik, said that when the DGP was brought to the facility at noon, he had no pulse, blood pressure or respiratory response.

"We still tried to resuscitate him with CPR. When no sign of life was seen despite all our efforts, we declared him dead at 12.48 pm," the doctor said, adding that details about his cause of death would only become clear after a postmortem examination.

Tripura State Forensic Science Laboratory Director Dr H K Pratihari said Anurag Dhankar's death appeared to be a case of suicide, but added that no conclusions would be drawn until the postmortem report comes.

Dhankar had taken over as the state police chief in May last year. Before that, he served as DGP (Intelligence), Additional DGP, and IGP (Law and Order). He had also served in the CBI and the Border Security Force (BSF) on central deputation. Moreover, he had also been part of the United Nations peacekeeping mission in Kosovo in 2003-2004.

He had been part of several high-profile investigations, including the Punjab National Bank fraud case involving diamantaire Nirav Modi.

He was a recipient of the President's Police Medal for distinguished service.

At the time of his death, the 60-year-old was just over a month into an 11-month service extension after his original period of service ended in June.

On Monday evening, the CPI(M) staged a protest in front of the West Agartala Police Station, demanding a judicial inquiry into the DGP's death headed by the Chief Justice of Tripura High Court.

CPI(M) state secretary and Opposition leader Jitendra Choudhury, who was at the protest, also demanded that Dhankar's body be preserved until his son, who lives in Canada, is able to arrive home.

Earlier, Choudhury and former chief minister Manik Sarkar had visited the AGMC & GBP Hospital and interacted with Dhankar's family and officials.

"His death is a reflection of the unnatural condition and political pressure prevailing in Tripura for the last eight-and-a-half years (since the BJP came to power). DGP Anurag Dhankar was an exceptional officer, and he had handled a variety of high-pressure jobs in his career. There is no reason he would take his own life or commit suicide. We want to know what really happened," Choudhury said after the hospital visit.

Former CM Sarkar described Dhankar as a "capable, exceptional, honest" officer, who "had worked his way up from the position of a Sub Divisional Police Officer (SDPO) to DGP".

"We tried to talk with his family and doctors inside the hospital. It appeared that some officers there were unhappy to see us and were practically trying to shoo us away. We can't say what happened, but the truth needs to come out," Sarkar said.

• BRIEFLY

TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee reviews arrangements ahead of Martyrs' Day, in Kolkata on Monday. PARTHA PAUL

WEST BENGAL

Three parallel Martyrs' Day events put Kolkata under security blanket

KOLKATA POLICE have put in place elaborate security arrangements, including drone surveillance and deployment of around 1,000 personnel, across three venues ahead of multiple programmes to mark the July 21 Martyrs' Day anniversary on Tuesday. The Mamata Banerjee faction of the Trinamool Congress will hold its programme near Birla Planetarium, while the rebel faction led by Ritabrata Banerjee, which claims to be the "real TMC", will organise a parallel event near the Mahatma Gandhi statue nearly two km away. The Congress will hold a programme at Shahid Minar, located around one km from the Mahatma Gandhi statue. Martyrs' Day is observed to commemorate 13 Youth Congress workers who were killed in police firing in 1993. PTI

DMK legislator held for speech 'threatening' CM

DMK LEGISLATOR G V Markandeyan was arrested on Monday for allegedly making threatening and inflammatory remarks against Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay during a public meeting in Kovilpatti. Markandeyan, who represents the Vilathikulam Assembly constituency in Thoothukudi district, was taken into custody from his residence in Vilathikulam early Monday morning. The arrest followed the circulation of videos from the public meeting, in which the legislator was seen delivering a speech directed at the CM. ENS

Adhikari: Bengali must for all govt communications

THE WEST Bengal government will make all official communications in Bengali from September 1, CM Suvendu Adhikari said in the Assembly on Monday and read out Union Home Minister Amit Shah's letter, which suggested taking steps for the extensive use and development of Indian languages. "From September 1, the use of the Bengali language will be mandatory at every level of the state government. This decision has been taken to strengthen further the use of the Bengali language in the state's official system," Adhikari said. ENS

HC recalls gag order on *The Wire* for future articles against former chief secretary

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 20

THE DELHI High Court on Monday recalled a gag order on future publications by digital news platform *The Wire* and a journalist on former Delhi chief secretary Naresh Kumar.

"There is no conceivable way, whether in fact or in law, by which it can be presumed that what an author or publisher is proposing to publish would be defamatory, even going by any past publication that may have been made by the author/publisher," the High Court held.

In November 2023, Kumar had moved the HC with a defamation suit after *The Wire* published a news report alleging that his son was linked to a case of over-valuation of land, reported by journalist Meetu Jain. The article had also reportedly recorded Kumar's assertion that "there is no conflict of interest on his part" in the alleged land deal. Kumar, though, alleged that "certain disgruntled elements..." had circulated the allegedly false and fabricated complaints against him.

Justice Anup Jairam Bhambhani, while recalling the gag, observed that "to assume that what someone may publish would be defamatory, is egregiously hypothetical and presumptive; and therefore cannot be the basis of a court injunction..."

EXPRESS special

6 months, a plan to kill & an AI tool: What police found in Bengaluru triple murder

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, July 20

According to case records, the alleged motive was a row over money Shwetha (left) had taken from her parents to spend on Kenneth

HE PLANNED the murders for six months.

At every step, he turned to a trusted source for answers: how to kill three people; which chemicals could remove bloodstains; how to package the bodies; how to move them out of the apartment; how to fend off anyone who intruded into the house; and whether the furnace he had built for a planned cloud kitchen in Bengaluru could be repurposed to incinerate the bodies before disposal.

That trusted source, according to police and court records, was an AI tool linked to a popular search engine — a discovery, a police officer said, that left investigators so stunned they "almost considered naming the AI tool as an accomplice".

Case records show the sequence of events came to a head on June 25, when Bengaluru police arrested Kenneth (25) and his live-in partner Shwetha, both engineering graduates who had been planning to start a business, for allegedly killing her mother Muthulakshmi S (48), sister Supriya (20) and father Somasundar (54), in that order, at their flat in K R Puram three days earlier. The alleged motive, according to case records: a dispute over money Shwetha had taken from her parents to spend on her partner.

This is possibly the first time Bengaluru police have encountered such extensive use of an AI tool in the planning and execution of a murder, sources familiar with the probe said. The tool allegedly shaped Kenneth's thinking at every stage and had a significant bearing on how the crime was planned, they said.

So much so, as part of the investigation, police have written to the AI tool's makers seeking details of Kenneth's interactions with it, to corroborate the digital evidence in the case.

For investigators, the case also points to the social isolation of a tech-savvy generation immersed in the information and entertainment served up by their devices. "The girl did not have any friend, male or female, other than Kenneth from her college days. Kenneth had a girlfriend earlier who left him because she suspected him of lying and stealing," sources said.

Kenneth's alleged inability to reflect on the consequences of his actions, a lack of social responsibility, and a rapid build-up of frustration that led to an "eliminate them" mindset, "as though life were a video game", were among the other factors behind the crime, police sources said.

Last Saturday, a magistrate's court remanded Kenneth to judicial custody after nine days in police custody, during which police conducted polygraph and other scientific tests to establish his motive and verify his claims. The court had earlier remanded Shwetha to judicial custody on July 10 after the end of her police custody. She has, meanwhile, sought a pardon and offered to confess.

Kenneth has allegedly told investigators that the idea of killing the family first surfaced over a "trivial grievance". Over the following six months, guided in part by the AI tool, he grew consumed by it, sources said.

"He was planning on starting a cloud kitchen and built a furnace for this purpose. When the murder thought entered his head, he consulted the AI tool, which indicated the merits and demerits of incinerating the bodies before disposal. He had planned to repurpose the furnace he built for burning the bodies after the murder," police sources said.

Kenneth allegedly told police that he built the iron furnace himself. "He consulted the AI tool all along the course of planning the murder. If he had spoken to a human friend, they may have advised him against the wrong course he had taken," police said.

"The thought got into his head to 'eliminate' the family of his live-in partner, and he got obsessed with it. For six months, he was consumed by this," police sources said. The impulse is alleged to have been triggered by Shwetha's grievance against her mother for being "controlling"— and by fears that the mother would ask for Rs 50 lakh Swetha had allegedly borrowed and spent on Kenneth, sources said.

While Kenneth and Shwetha allegedly acted in tandem, the bulk of the planning and execution was Kenneth's, police sources said.

Kenneth and Shwetha hail from well-to-do middle-class Bengaluru families. Kenneth's father worked at a major PSU involved in aircraft manufacturing while Shwetha's father was employed with a global IT company.

Shwetha worked for a while in Bengaluru's IT sector after graduating but lost it after being allegedly influenced by Kenneth, sources said. Police sources described their relationship as a transactional friendship in which she funded his lifestyle.

On June 22, Shwetha's mother was allegedly lured to the K R Puram apartment first. Once inside, Kenneth allegedly stabbed her 26 times. When Shwetha's father and sister arrived a short while later, they were also allegedly stabbed.

After the murders, Kenneth and Shwetha went to Shwetha's parents' house to allegedly steal money and silver ornaments, and are alleged to have thrown her younger sister's mobile phone near the parents' home. They then fled to Puducherry. "They had gone to Puducherry around 15 days prior to the murder for a holiday as well," sources said.

Key evidence includes the dying declaration of Somasundar, who was found around 9 pm on June 22 in a pool of blood with multiple stab wounds on a staircase at the Sai Green apartment complex where Shwetha lived. He told police he had been stabbed by his daughter and Kenneth. "My younger daughter Supriya and my wife Muthulakshmi are still in the apartment. Please rescue them," Somasundar said, according to the FIR, before he was taken to hospital, where he died.

Gujarat: Man accused in rape-murder of four-year-old girl shot dead in encounter

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, July 20

A MAN arrested for the alleged abduction, rape and murder of a four-year-old girl was shot dead in an encounter shortly after he was taken into police custody in Anand district, police said on Monday.

They claimed that the suspect, a 25-year-old, was shot as he attempted to escape after assaulting two constables with a knife while being taken from Borsad, where he was apprehended, to Anand.

The child disappeared from Valsad railway station on Saturday, and her body was found on the railway tracks nearby the following morning. The police suspect that the child was sexually assaulted and murdered.

Her clothes were recovered separately from the scene, prompting the police to register a preliminary case of rape and murder while awaiting the findings of the post-mortem examination and forensic analysis.

A senior police officer told *The Indian Express* that the firing was "necessitated by the accused's attack on the policemen escorting him and was an act of self-defence."

The officer said the accused was rushed to a hospital in Karamsad, where he succumbed to his injuries during treatment. His body has been sent for a post-mortem, while legal formalities are underway.

The accused was arrested on Sunday, hours after the police traced him through CCTV footage at the station, which allegedly showed him taking the girl away. In a press conference, Anand Superintendent of Police GG Jasani said: "Around 11.15 pm on July 19, the accused, under the influence of intoxicants, complained of vomiting. Near Asodar Chokdi, the police vehicle was stopped, and he was brought out. He then attacked two LCB personnel with a sharp-edged weapon and attempted to assault a police sub-inspector. The officer subsequently fired five rounds from his service pistol in self-defence."

NHAI launches digital 'local pass' for residents in 20-km radius of toll plazas

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, July 20

IN A push for a barrier-less tolling system, the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI) has launched a digital "local pass" for residents in the 20-km radius of toll plazas on the Rajmargyatra app.

On June 17, *The India Express* had reported that the government was planning to introduce this pass by July. The move came after implementation of the Multi-lane free flow (MLFF) tolling or barrier-less tolling system in different toll plazas. In this system, commuters do not have to stop to pay the toll.

The eligibility for the local pass will be established based on the VAHAN details, which will retrieve a commuter's address, vehicle number and linked FASTag.

The first facility of digital local toll pass has been introduced at the Mundka-Bakkarwala toll plaza on Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II) in Delhi and will be rolled out at other toll plazas across the country in the coming months, said NHAI. The MLFF system at the Mundka-Bakkarwala toll plaza was made operational on May 11.

"Residents living within a 20 km radius of an eligible toll plaza will be able to purchase a 'local pass' digitally through Rajmargyatra mobile app, allowing unlimited travel through the respective toll plaza during the month," said the NHAI.

Earlier, commuters were required to visit the toll plaza and submit supporting documents to establish their eligibility. This process can now be done digitally in a few minutes, said NHAI.

Officials said the "local pass" was introduced since among the violators who don't pay the toll fees, residents in the 20-km radius constitute a significant share.

India, Moldova discuss UNSC reforms, fight against terror

Divya A
New Delhi, July 20

President Droupadi Murmu receives a ceremonial welcome from Moldovan counterpart Maia Sandu in Chisinau on Monday. PTI

INDIA AND Moldova discussed reforms of multilateral organisations, including the UN Security Council, and cooperation in the fight against terrorism, as President Droupadi Murmu landed in Chisinau on her state visit to the country. Murmu is the first Indian head of state to visit the landlocked Eastern European country since the establishment of diplomatic relations in 1992.

The President held bilateral discussions with her Moldovan counterpart Maia Sandu, where the two leaders explored new avenues of cooperation in trade and investment, digital transformation, information technology, healthcare, pharmaceuticals, agriculture, education, culture and capacity building, according to the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA).

Briefing the media, MEA's Secretary (West) Sibi George said, "They also discussed cooperation in (the) fight against terrorism. Both sides discussed (the) importance of reforms of multilateral organisations, including the UNSC."

As a special gesture of friendship, Murmu presented a bust of Mahatma Gandhi to President Sandu. The President laid a wreath at the Monument of Stefan cel Mare si Sfant (Stephen the Great), paying tribute to one of Moldova's most revered national figures.

As part of her day-long visit, Murmu met Igor Grosu, speaker of the Moldovan parliament, and interacted with members of the India-Moldova Parliamentary Friendship Group.

Later, both Presidents jointly addressed the India-Moldova Business Forum, which brought together leading business representatives from both countries to explore fresh opportunities in trade, investment, innovation and technology.

E. EXPLAINED

The Outreach

India's outreach to Eastern Europe seeks to diversify its European engagement beyond major Western powers such as France and Germany. Over the next few days, President Murmu will also be visiting North Macedonia and Romania.

● **WEB EXCLUSIVE**
'In CJP protest, a reckoning with politics for the apolitical Indian.'
— By Siya Dulari Choudhary
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A republic, if you can keep it.
— Benjamin Franklin

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Can't have sabka vishwas with tear gas and lathi

THE ABUNDANT images on Monday — of thousands of mostly young and mostly peaceful protestors facing barricades and lathi charge and tear gas shells in the heart of the national capital — were stark and dispiriting. They indict the government. The protestors were reportedly responding to the call of the satirical online platform, the Cockroach Janta Party, to march to Parliament. The CJP has been conducting a sit-in protest since June 20 at Jantar Mantar, from where education and environment activist Sonam Wangchuk, fasting since June 28, was taken to a hospital, Saturday, forcibly. But the protestors were arguably responding to more than one fast or one platform. They were rallying behind the issue that is being highlighted — the urgent need to reform a broken education system, beset with exam leaks, delays and irregularities, which leads, in turn, to swelling the ranks of the unemployed. In a country of the young, the recent episode of the NEET cancellation and retest has touched a raw nerve, sparking larger anxieties about the shape of an uncertain future, and lack of readiness to meet its challenges. The Centre looks harsh and unyielding towards the young protestors, and insensitive on an issue that ripples widely. It kept its back turned, eyes wide shut. It took three weeks to break its silence with a meeting on Monday between Minister J P Nadda and spokespersons of the CJP. It is, of course, far from clear whether the meeting translates into reform and accountability.

On the interlinked matters of *shiksha* and *berozgari*, education and unemployment, the government needs to recognise that it cannot keep kicking the can down the road. It must acknowledge, also, that citizens have the right to place demands on it, to disagree with it and to protest peacefully. In letter and spirit, the Constitution guarantees citizens both the freedom to speak and the space to be heard. Over the last 12 years or so, however, the government's instinct has been to distrust and demonise those who express dissent, to reflexively label them "anti-national". It favours a top-down, one-way communication that does not involve listening and responding.

On Monday, the march of the protestors was to Parliament, the highest forum of deliberative democracy, where elected representatives take up the people's issues. The concerns highlighted at Jantar Mantar must find their way into the House eventually — that is the legitimate trajectory. A government that has, through its serial electoral successes, underlined its connect with the people can ill afford to stand in their way when they demand a hearing in between elections. It is still not too late, a beginning has been made towards a dialogue with the protestors. In days to come, the government must make amends by building on it.

Spain won because it had a winning idea

BY SUNDAY night, Spain had beaten the two teams best equipped to stop them: France's Mbappé-led attack in the semi-final, and then, in the final, Messi's Argentina. And still, Spain did not merely hold the men's World Cup. Its women's team sits at the top of the FIFA rankings, reigning champions, with a European title and a Nations League crown in the cabinet.

Look around the world's biggest leagues, and the pattern repeats. Nearly 20 per cent of coaches in Europe's Big Five leagues are Spanish, 11 of them working abroad, more than double any other nation's tally. At this World Cup, three teams besides Spain were led by Spanish managers. Even the losing coach, Lionel Scaloni, earned his UEFA Pro Licence under Spanish instruction, taught by a man who would become his opponent: On Sunday night, teacher and student stood in opposite dugouts, separated by a scoreline. Arteta's Arsenal finished above Guardiola's Manchester City this season. Xabi Alonso now runs Chelsea.

None of it is new. Johan Cruyff planted the seed at Barcelona in the late 1980s: Teach a player not where to stand, but why. Spain won the 2010 World Cup playing exactly that way, long before their young stars Lamine Yamal or Pau Cubarsi were old enough to watch it. A teenager entering the system today arrives already fluent in the idea. Sunday proved the inheritance still works on the men's side. It has long worked on the women's: Barcelona have won four Champions League titles in six years. Messi had just 29 touches when Rodri was substituted in the 99th minute, and finished with 54 across 120 minutes, most of them harmless. Rodri himself, rebuilt from a serious knee injury, won the Golden Ball. Cubarsi, 19, won the best young player award; Yamal started every match; Pedri ran the midfield; Unai Simon won the Golden Glove. Spain did not export a formation on Sunday. It exported the only thing that travels cleanly: A way of teaching someone to think. The trophies, it turns out, follow.

Up in the sky, it's a bird, it's AI

A BIRD is merely a bird until it is spotted outside its natural range. Then it becomes a sign to be decoded. A photograph taken in Brazil of a red-winged blackbird, which is native to North and Central America, was recently posted on an online forum, leading to much speculation among scientists about what its unusual presence could possibly mean. Was it a vagrant, blown off course by some miscalculation of its internal GPS? Or an indicator of how greater forces — climate change, habitat destruction, etc. — were impacting the behaviour of different species? A little detective work helped uncover the truth: The photographer who had submitted the image had captured an epaulet oriole, common in Brazil, and asked an AI platform to make the picture "look better", resulting in a single modified detail — and a false sighting.

A recent article in *Nature* argues that this is precisely the kind of "AI slop" that is making life difficult for scientists who rely on public tracking platforms to study wildlife: Not the obviously fake images of tigers in the savannah or parakeets in the Arctic, but the subtly manipulated ones that just might — and often do — pass for documentary evidence. The study of nature is not merely about pretty pictures or awe-inspiring vistas. It is about understanding ecological shifts that often portend changes in the world humans inhabit, from warming temperatures and disappearing habitats to the spread of disease and invasive species.

While many wildlife photographers use technology to tweak certain parts of a photograph in order to get the "perfect" image, AI tools, with their tendency to add or "hallucinate" details, can, literally and figuratively, lead researchers on a wild-goose chase. Because in science, even the smallest fabrication can end up obscuring a larger truth.

Anna Hazare to Sonam Wangchuk, a tale of two fasts — and a democracy

GIRISH KUBER

ON MONDAY, protestors marching to Parliament with demands for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan were met with teargas shells. Then, for the first time in 23 days, the government opened a line of communication with the protestors and talks have reportedly been held with former BJP president and Union health minister J P Nadda. The government's reluctance to engage meaningfully with a movement demanding reform of the country's education system is telling in more ways than one.

A contrasting story unfolded 15 years ago. Anna Hazare, a serial agitator since the '90s in Maharashtra, caught everyone's attention when he started a hunger strike on April 5, 2011, in Delhi. The strike ended in just 96 hours when the government agreed to form a joint committee to draft the Jan Lokpal Bill. Hazare's second and longer hunger strike began on August 16 at Delhi's famous Ramlila Maidan. It ended on August 28, after 12 days, when Parliament passed a resolution that met his core demands.

Hazare's demand was relatively straightforward: The government should put in place strong anti-corruption measures by creating an independent ombudsman, the Lokpal. In India, corruption is something that many people think everyone else is up to. That's why anti-corruption campaigns often succeed, even though these agitations do not solve the problem completely. With the Manmohan Singh government besieged by a series of scams, or rather allegations about scams, Hazare's agitation struck the right chord. The impact of his fast was significantly amplified when television channels began broadcasting demonstrations live and former police officer Kiran Bedi and yoga guru Baba Ramdev joined the movement.

The real power behind the Anna movement, though, stayed away from the spotlight. The RSS, with its well-organised network, was believed to be gathering support for the movement. Some socialists and those on the left — Medha Patkar, Yogendra Yadav and Prashant Bhushan, for instance — did support Hazare. However, the 2014 general elections showed that the biggest winner of the Anna movement was the BJP.

The Manmohan Singh government also played a role, as it couldn't quite grasp the intricacies of the Anna movement to begin with. Once it got its act together, the UPA government enlisted the help of two important individuals, in addition to Pranab Mukherjee and A K Antony, to "negotiate" an end to Hazare's fast. These individuals — former Maharashtra chief minister Vilasrao Deshmukh and Umeshchandra Sarangi, a former NABARD chief and IAS official from the state — were better equipped to deal with the situation than Mukherjee and Antony. Deshmukh and Sarangi were able to achieve their goal. But by then, it was too late. The genie was out of the bottle.

Sonam Wangchuk's ongoing fast is distinct from Hazare's agitation on two counts. While what Hazare wanted was theoretical and abstract, Wangchuk's demand is grounded in a more concrete reality. He seeks the removal of Dharmendra Pradhan, a key figure in the Narendra Modi government. The contrast between their demands highlights the stark difference in political acumen between the two. Compared to the easily pliable, politically well-connected Hazare, the agitator who is demanding the reform of the education system is a person of stronger convictions. Fulfilling Hazare's harmless — and eventually useless — demand was much easier than what Wangchuk is seeking.

Two, Wangchuk has, at best, had sporadic backing from the Opposition. During Hazare's movement, the then main opposition party, the BJP, saw an opportunity to expose the chaotic Manmohan Singh government. The Opposition today, in contrast, is showing signs of inertia. One reason could be that it is divided and lacks a cohesive strategy to challenge the Modi government. No party sees an incentive in Wangchuk's success. Hazare's victory had a direct beneficiary: The BJP was better placed to capitalise on the anti-government sentiments ignited by him since it was the sole occupant of the opposition space and the only challenger to the Congress-led coalition at the Centre.

> Governments have an uncanny capacity to sense the significance of scale, whether during protests or a natural disaster. The magnitude of the situation often determines the government's response

The political vacuum in Wangchuk's fast was filled by the youth who travelled to Delhi from across India to extend support to the cause. Governments and political leaders have an uncanny capacity to sense the significance of scale, whether during protests or a natural disaster. The magnitude of the situation often determines the government's response. The groundswell at Jantar Mantar ultimately compelled the government to break its silence. It decided to engage with protestors. This is more of a success of the country's impatient youth than the majority, who preferred to remain indifferent.

This political reality raises an important question: Does society today judge success and failure in politics based on election results? Almost the entire country seemed to be united in supporting the Anna movement. Fifteen years ago, several representatives from the entertainment industry could stand up and express their disagreement with the government. Where are these voices now? The media, too, wasn't as vocal as it was during the Anna movement, which also had the backing of sections of industry. India Inc under the current government, in contrast, is much subdued. It's quite striking how, in just about 15 years, the country's lively, boisterous and vibrant democracy has become so quiet.

The resolution to the questions posed by Wangchuk will determine whether our democracy reclaims its voice or we remain trapped in deafening silence. The country's youth has shown an alternative democratic path. Wangchuk's fast and developments that followed are a signal to the government as well — it may have enormous power to bend and break the Opposition but it cannot govern indefinitely by ignoring public sentiment, and there are certain things beyond the power and reach of central agencies.

The writer is editor, 'Loksatta'

Anti-defection law needs drastic changes

DESH DEEPAK VERMA

AS PARLIAMENT'S Monsoon Session commences, the red carpets of the Rajya Sabha will have some different shadows cast upon them by MPs who originally belonged to one shade of political party but now belong to another. The arithmetic of the House will also change because of these large-scale defections and realignments.

The Opposition predictably attributes these defections to horse-trading, political inducements and the fear of investigative agencies. The ruling party, on the other hand, argues that many legislators have merely chosen to free themselves from autocratic or family-centric political organisations. There may be elements of truth in both narratives.

Amid this exchange of accusations and counter-accusations, a more fundamental issue gets overlooked — the continuing failure of India's anti-defection law to contain the very political opportunism it was enacted to curb.

The anti-defection law was introduced through the Fifty-second Constitutional Amendment in 1985 by incorporating the Tenth Schedule into the Constitution. Its principal objective was to curb the political instability caused by frequent defections.

The Ninety-first Constitutional Amendment of 2003 further tightened the law by abolishing the exemption from disqualification for a bloc comprising at least one-third of the members of a legislature party. Thereafter, only a merger supported by at least two-thirds of the members of a legislature party remained eligible for this exemption.

The experience of implementing the anti-defection law, even after these amendments, has been far from satisfactory. Under the Tenth Schedule, the authority to decide disqualification petitions rests with the presiding officers of the respective Houses — the Speaker in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies, and the Chairmen in the Rajya Sabha and Legislative Councils. While the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha is mandated to resign from his or her parent party, this is not obligatory for the Speakers. This arrangement, rightly or wrongly, inevitably gives rise to questions about institutional impartiality. Presiding officers have delayed decisions on disqualification petitions for months and years, and at times, for the entire tenure of the House. The Supreme Court has repeatedly observed that such petitions should ordinarily be decided within three months, and some Chairmen of the Rajya Sabha have echoed the same expectation. Yet deliberate procedural delays have often rendered the law ineffective.

Paradoxically, the stricter provisions have also not eliminated defections. Instead, political efforts now focus on engineering defections on a larger scale, enough to satisfy the two-thirds requirement for a merger. The phenomenon has now become more organised, accompanied by greater political bargaining and inducements. Thus, the anti-defection law has, in practice, become an instrument for escalating defections rather than preventing them.

What is the solution? It needs some drastic and fundamental constitutional changes. We would need a law to automatically end, on the date of resignation, the tenure of any elected representative who resigns from the political party on whose ticket he or she was elected. The individual could seek a fresh mandate, and if he or she enjoys public support independent of party affiliation, there should be no difficulty in securing re-election — either as an Independent candidate or as another party's nominee, in the vacated seat or any other. This would shift the ultimate authority to decide a defecting legislator's right to continue in the House from party managers and presiding officers to the electorate.

> We would need a law to automatically end, on the date of resignation, the tenure of any elected representative who resigns from the political party on whose ticket he or she was elected

Critics may argue that such a provision would discourage genuine dissent within political parties and inhibit independent thinking. That concern, however, appears overstated. Legislators would remain entirely free to disagree with their party, resign from it and seek a fresh mandate. What the amendment would discourage is not dissent but the retention of an elected office after abandoning the political platform on which that office was secured.

The writer is former secretary general, Rajya Sabha, Parliament of India

Managing the temple, a case for guardrails

PALLAV SHISHODIA

THE VALLABH Sampraday worships Lord Krishna as a joyous and playful deity, with Tilkayat *ji* as its supreme head. In the 1950s, there were controversies due to large-scale bungling in the properties of the sect's main temple, one of the richest, in Nathdwara. Its takeover by the state was challenged without success before the Supreme Court, which negated the religious right claimed by Tilkayat *ji* to manage this temple and its assets, holding it to be a secular matter. The temple board, created by statute to manage its temporal affairs, except matters of faith, is a unique blend of the spiritual lineage, state supervision and efforts of prominent devotees like the Ambanis. The Ram Janmabhoomi temple in Ayodhya was built with state support but without any state oversight. The latter is an imperative, not a panacea, to ensure transparency, accountability and institutional integrity.

The movement for the temple at Ayodhya and its construction were a balm to hurt Hindu sentiments. What has now emerged is alleged loot from land deals, construction contracts and *chadavas*, which include large amounts of gold, silver and cash. Denials apart, there are several structural impediments to the full magnitude of the irregularities coming out in the public domain.

There is a fairly evolved legal framework to manage the spiritual, temporal and secular affairs of the thousands of religious places, small and large, in India. Our Constitution guarantees the "right to freely profess, practice and propagate religion" subject to public order, morality, and health. The state can make laws only to regulate secular activities and reform religion. The guaranteed rights of denominations to establish and maintain religious institutions, manage their own affairs, own and administer properties are enunciated in several cases. A slew of temple boards, charity commissioners or Devasthan departments oversee the management of secular activities, while religious aspects are governed by the religious denominations. Be it a dargah, gurdwara or any other religious institution, this is the broad pattern. This module, with local variations, also serves the economies of towns, charitable and educational institutions, hospitals, and several other activities around religious institutions. For instance, the annual sale in public auction of the hair tonsured at the Tirupati temple comes to about 500 mt, valued at around Rs 200 crore. It has over 600 laddoo-makers protected by labour laws. The Guruvayur temple has regulations to shelter elephants gifted by devotees. About 1,00,000 people on weekdays and an even greater number on weekends partake in the langar at the Golden Temple. All of this is managed by their respective statutory bodies.

> A slew of temple boards, charity commissioners or Devasthan departments oversee the management of secular activities, while religious aspects are governed by the religious denominations

Imagine all these activities with trustees, priests and managers having complete freedom with no state-mandated guardrails. The Ram Mandir at Ayodhya suffers from a structural deficit, with or without a CEO. There are no reasons in the public domain why the formation of a private trust was directed, without a temple board. Does the state have no role in a temple with such an inflow of devotees and donations? In a quest to save the larger faith in Ram, the alleged loot is being underplayed as a small con job. The state cannot wish it away as an internal matter of a private trust. It must stem this rot to restore the hurt faith of millions.

The writer is a senior advocate

40 YEARS AGO

July 21, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS

3 MLCs not to support Cong-I in Karnataka

Gundu to form new party today

Games boycott announced

Arjun rules out party split over Gundu Rao

Cong-I split over party chief issue

BJP for package deal on Punjab

Games boycott announced

INDIA PULLED out of the 13th Commonwealth Games, to begin in Edinburgh on July 24, becoming the 24th country to boycott the Games because of Britain's stand on economic sanctions against South Africa. The Minister of State for Sports, Margaret Alva, said, "We tried to save the Games." Alva said India had deferred its decision regarding participation in the hope of some change in the British attitude on the economic sanctions against the Pretoria regime.

Jagmohan on Governor's rule

THE JAMMU and Kashmir Governor, Jagmohan, hinted here that he had sent "reports" to the Centre, but refused to divulge if these pertained to the extension of Governor's rule in Jammu and Kashmir. Jagmohan, addressing a press conference said he was under oath not to divulge anything and so could not comment on the issue of the extension of Governor's rule.

BJP for package deal on Punjab

THE BJP said that it favoured a "package deal" to resolve the territorial issue between Punjab and Haryana by referring all territorial disputes arising out of the Rajiv-Longowal accord to a single commission for final settlement. The national executive of the BJP, which concluded its three-day meeting in Gwalior, said in a resolution that a new commission should be appointed for the purpose or the terms of reference of the Desai Commission should be suitably broadened.

'Doves' may put Zia to flight

A NATIONWIDE movement to oust President Zia-ul-Haq through a series of strikes, blocking of streets and closing of shops is being planned by the Pakistani opposition leader, Benazir Bhutto. Some 150,000 "doves for Democracy" have been recruited to lead this protest by the Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP) of which Bhutto is acting chairperson, *The New York Times* reported from Lahore, quoting party officials.

● WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

In Mr Burnham the nation will have an experienced politician with a gift for language.

— The Guardian

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Football wasn't the main character in this World Cup, but Spain's victory was poetic

MIHIR VASAVDA

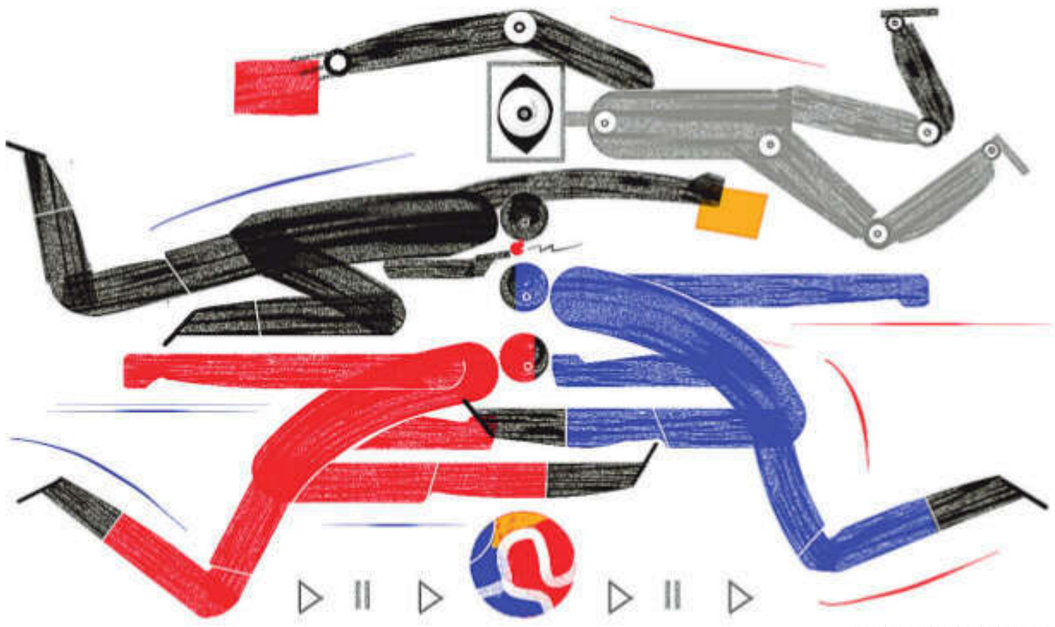

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

THE BEST thing about Spain winning the World Cup was that it finally put an end to the conspiracy theories. For a month, social media had convinced itself that FIFA was determined to deliver Lionel Messi one last fairytale – something even Donald Trump joked about on the eve of the final. Spain's victory, by completely outlasting the previous holders, settled that argument.

Then came the final whistle. A mass confrontation. Tempers spilling over. Players being kicked and pushed, Argentina churlishly turning their backs on the trophy presentation. More headlines about what happened after the game than what happened during it.

It was, in many ways, the perfect ending to a World Cup that rarely allowed football to be the main character.

Every tournament has its defining image. Maradona lifting the trophy in 1986. Ronaldo's redemption in 2002. Zinedine Zidane's headbutt in 2006. Iniesta in Johannesburg. Germany's demolition of Brazil. Messi in Doha.

What will 2026 be remembered for?

Spain's triumph will feature somewhere in the conversation. But so will refereeing controversies, mass confrontations, cynical football, bloated expansion, a four-quarter, made-for-television experiment and an uncomfortable feeling that, for the first time, football's soul was fighting for space inside its own World Cup.

The referees became bigger stars than many players. Almost every knockout round ended with fresh outrage. VAR decisions were dissected frame by frame before the football itself. Germany's penalty shootout defeat to Paraguay generated as much debate over officiating as over Paraguay's remarkable escape. Argentina's route to the final fuelled endless accusations of preferential treatment. Even Norway's clash with England descended into a debate over perception versus reality, in which everybody was left asking a strangely modern football question — should they believe their own eyes or the machine? Whether those theories had merit almost became irrelevant. The perception itself overshadowed the football.

Then there was the football itself.

Intensity has always been part of the World Cup's appeal. But too often, this tournament confused aggression with competitiveness. The France-Paraguay round of 16 was the clearest example. So were Argentina's semifinals and finals. That pattern repeated itself throughout the tournament. Teams increasingly realised they didn't have to outplay better opponents. They simply had to drag them into trench warfare.

The World Cup has always celebrated emotion. This one often celebrated attrition.

> While everyone else argued with referees, surrounded officials, fought opponents and embraced spectacle, Spain simply played football. No theatrics. No chaos. No reliance on one superstar

Then came FIFA's great experiment. The 48-team tournament was sold as football's democratisation. More countries. More representation. More dreams. Instead, it often delivered more predictability.

Yes, there were fresh faces. Cape Verde became one of the stories of the group stage. But even that came with an important caveat. They weren't a romantic underdog who had stumbled into the World Cup. They had topped their African qualifying group and earned their place on merit. But apart from their run to the Round of 32, the tournament provided few eye-catching results and largely stuck to the script.

The expanded format promised more Moroccos. Instead, it produced more mismatches. And by the quarterfinals, the tournament had largely reset itself to football's established order. Expansion was supposed to create chaos. Instead, it insulated the elite. Bigger nations now had more room for error than ever before.

Which raises an uncomfortable question: If 48 teams reduced jeopardy, what exactly will 64, being mulled for 2030, achieve? Football's greatest tournament has always been ruthless. One bad evening could send giants home. That sense of danger has slowly been diluted.

Hovering over all of it was another question. What exactly was America adding to football that football didn't already possess?

Football has spent decades teaching the United States how to love the game. This World Cup often looked like America trying to teach football how to entertain when the sport has never needed help creating drama. Its greatest moments are built on anticipation. A silent stadium before a penalty. Forty-five uninterrupted minutes where the game belongs entirely to the players.

This tournament occasionally looked as though it didn't trust football enough to stand on its own. And once commercial logic begins reshaping tradition, where does it stop? Today, it is extended ceremonies and endless entertainment. Tomorrow, will cooling breaks become permanent television inventory? Will football's sacred two halves one day give way to quarters because broadcasters discover another advertising opportunity?

Which is why Spain's triumph felt almost poetic. While everyone else argued with referees, surrounded officials, fought opponents, debated formats and embraced spectacle, Spain simply played football. No theatrics. No chaos. No reliance on one superstar. Just intelligent movement, technical excellence and collective brilliance.

Their victory was a reminder that football's greatest attraction has never been controversy or commerce. It is the game itself. Fittingly, Spain will be waiting when the World Cup returns in 2030 as one of its co-hosts. After a tournament where the sport often seemed buried beneath the noise, perhaps there is no better nation to help bring it back to centre stage.

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'Satluj' may not tell the whole story but its truth cannot be buried

AJITPAL SINGH

JASWANT SINGH Khalra was born in 1952 in Khalra village — then in Amritsar district, now Tarn Taran — a few kilometres from the border. His grandfather, Harnam Singh, was a Ghadar-era revolutionary. By the family's account, he was tried in the Lahore Conspiracy Case, before a Special Tribunal created under the newly passed Defence of India Act, with no jury and no appeal, and spent close to a decade in British prisons.

Now here is the irony. The Empire, whatever else it was, acknowledged its prisoner. There was an arrest on the record, a charge, a tribunal — however rigged — a sentence. Eighty-one years later, in independent India, policemen took his grandson from outside his house in Amritsar, and the state then denied, including before the Supreme Court of India, that it was holding him at all. It disappeared the grandson for asking questions.

What questions? Investigating colleagues who had vanished, Khalra found in Amritsar's municipal records the names, ages, and addresses of people the Punjab Police had cremated as *lavaris* — unclaimed, unidentified. His charge was specific: Young men were being detained, killed in staged encounters or in custody, and burned as nobody. He documented more than 6,000 such cremations in Amritsar district alone, and extrapolated a statewide figure of 25,000, an estimate never officially verified. But the verified numbers of 2,097 by the CBI are damning enough.

The police response was immediate. In January 1995, DGP K P S Gill told a press conference in Amritsar that the missing had gone abroad under false names. Khalra challenged him to an open public debate. It never took place. In April 1995, Khalra carried his registers to Canada. Friends begged him to claim asylum. He answered with a parable: When darkness first fell upon Earth, one small lamp raised its head and said, "I challenge the darkness; around myself, at least, I will not let it settle." Then he went home to be the lamp.

On the morning of September 6, he was taken while washing his car outside his house. He was held illegally, tortured, and shot dead on October 27. His body was thrown into the canal at Harike, where the Sutlej receives the Beas.

ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

None of this is speculation, and that is the point everyone arguing about *Satluj* keeps missing. The case went all the way to the Supreme Court, and in November 2011, the Court recorded that Khalra's press note on the cremations had been "found to be correct", and observed that the force had closed ranks to protect its own.

I have seen the film, and I will be honest about it in a way its defenders and detractors will both dislike. Is it factually complete? No. It does not show the Khalra whose own writings were sympathetic to Bhindranwale and the Khalistan cause; it flattens a complicated political man into a secular saint. But that is not an inaccuracy about the crime. The crime rests on an adjudicated record.

Of all the films this country fights about, *Satluj* is the rare one whose spine is a verdict. If deviation from fact were grounds for keeping a film from audiences, how did *The Kashmir Files*, *The Kerala Story*, *Dhurandhar*, and *Chhaava* release? Each dramatises, valorises, invents — that is what films do — and each was extended the licence without a second thought. I am asking why the standard applies to just one. And to those who complain that *Satluj* does not show the other side, did *Dhurandhar*? Where was the other side in *Chhaava*?

So why did this film disappear? Punjab votes next year. Had the film been allowed to run, the ruling party at the Centre could even have claimed credit — the worst of these atrocities took place under Congress governments. The takedown makes no party-political sense, and I have stopped trying to read it as such. Congress ran the counterinsurgency. A certification board under the present government buried the film for four years. It vanished from screens while a third party governed Punjab. The only logic consistent across three decades and three parties is the oldest one: The state protects the state.

What I want to say as a Sikh filmmaker from Punjab who grew up in Gujarat is what it does to a person when government after government buries the truth of his land and his people. It is suffocating. We begin to feel like second-class citizens — expected to compromise, to bow, to survive quietly. The Constitution calls us equal. Do the governments of this country treat us as equal? I keep returning to Khalra's lamp. It is burning bright in village squares, schools, and gurdwaras. A lamp taken down is not a lamp put out.

The writer is the director of Tabbar and Fire in the Mountains

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Parliament session

THE COMING session of Parliament is a test of democratic vitality ('Opposition must find its voice in Monsoon Session', *IE*, July 20). With the INDIA bloc weakened, the need for constructive debate has never been greater. Parliament must not become a stage for silence or spectacle, but a forum for accountability. Issues like the NEET paper leak and questions of citizenship demand rigorous scrutiny.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

English in India

I WHOLEHEARTEDLY agree that English is no longer a foreign or colonial language; it has become an integral part of everyday life in India ('Indian English is not a colonial relic', IE, July 20). In a multilingual nation, it connects people across regions and opens doors to higher education, employment, science, technology, and global opportunities. Far from being diminished by Indian usage, English has been enriched by the incorporation of countless Indian words and expressions.

Nawal Thorat

Punjab's history

PRAMOD KUMAR rightly notes that Punjab has never seen a comprehensive institutional effort at closure, and this deserves serious attention. But its framing needs scrutiny ('Punjab needs a truth and reconciliation commission', *IE*, July 20). Partition and the Punjabi Suba movement are placed alongside Operation Blue Star, 1984, and two decades of militancy as part of one shared lineage of grievance. These were different events with different causes, and grouping them together risks obscuring what happened and why. The deeper gap is economic. Punjab's militancy is described purely as democratic politics "degenerating into extraordinary violence", with no mention of the agrarian distress that shaped that period. A Truth and Reconciliation Commission, documentation, and a Peace Memorial are worthwhile steps, but they address memory, not the material conditions that produced the crisis

Manu Kant, Chandigarh

Garry Sobers showed what cricket after empire could be

UDAY CHANDRA

WHAT DID Sir Garfield St Aubrun Sobers represent? His passing, which has plunged the entire cricketing world into mourning, is more than the loss of the sport's greatest all-rounder. We have lost arguably the last living embodiment of cricket as a source of freedom: A man who made an old, stodgy colonial sport more joyous and more human than the empire that created it.

If Don Bradman perfected a colonial sport organised around Britain and its dominions, then Sobers must be remembered for bringing together the Commonwealth of Cricket. Wherever he played, he changed the way cricketing excellence was understood.

The numbers describe several great cricketers compressed into a single body: 8,032 Test runs at 57.78, 235 wickets delivered through pace, swing, orthodox spin and wrist-spin, and 109 catches. Yet those numbers understate. Abundance was Sobers' gift. His peers knew that he could alter the course of any match without making cricket appear laborious.

Before him, Learie Constantine had shown that a Black West Indian could be an extraordinary athlete with intelligence and charisma. George Headley, the "Black Bradman," freed batsmanship from old racial prejudices. Frank Worrell added statesmanship, turning a fractured archipelago into a world-class team. Sobers was the culmination of their efforts. He showed that a Black man could not only bat, bowl and field as well as anyone else, but better.

Sobers played his first Test as a left-arm spinner at 17 against England in Kingston in 1954. His first overseas tour to New Zealand two years later yielded only 81 runs in four Tests on unfamiliar green pitches. Yet a boy from Barbados had begun mastering cricket's dispersed world. At 21, Sobers turned his maiden Test century into 365 not out at Kingston, breaking Len Hutton's world record.

> If Don Bradman perfected a colonial sport, Sobers must be remembered for bringing together the Commonwealth of Cricket

India was woven into Sobers' career from the beginning. At 16, he took seven wickets on his first-class debut for Barbados against the touring Indians, prompting captain Vijay Hazare to speak of future greatness. Six years later, Sobers arrived in India as the finest young batsman in the world. He scored 557 runs at 92.83, with three centuries, as the West Indies won 3–0. Across two home series and two away against India, Sobers made an astounding 1,920 Test runs at 83.47. Indian spectators responded by elevating him to the pantheon of cricketing greats.

In England, the old imperial game encountered Sobers first as a colonial prodigy, then as its master. In 1966 as captain, he produced perhaps the most complete series any cricketer has played: 722 runs at 103.14, 20 wickets, and 10 catches as West Indies won 3–1. He was, at once, his team's premier batsman, opening bowler, spinner, close fielder, and towering leader. His years at Nottinghamshire deepened the bond. English spectators embraced him as one of their own cricketing heroes. Not only did Sobers conquer the old imperial centre, he showed what cricket after empire could be.

Australia, however, was where Sobers made his deepest impression. His 132 in the tied Test at Brisbane in 1960 announced him to a cricketing public that prized audacity. The West Indies lost narrowly, but Australians embraced Worrell's team with an affection that unsettled the racial assumptions of the White Australia era. His 254 at Melbourne in 1972 led a World XI to victory and prompted Bradman to describe it as the greatest exhibition of batting ever witnessed in Australia.

Comparisons with Muhammad Ali illuminate as much as mislead. Sobers worked differently. He was no political saint. His appearance in Rhodesia in 1970 was a serious error, for which he later expressed regret. His revolution occurred principally on the field of play. He remade an imperial inheritance as a shared arena of excellence built on freedom and joy.

This is what Sobers leaves behind: A Commonwealth of Cricket held together by a certain joie de vivre. Yet it is also what cricket now risks taking for granted. Today, India supplies much of the game's money and muscle. But money did not make cricket global, and money alone will not preserve it. Sobers helped rescue the game from becoming curling or croquet: An obscure inheritance guarded by White men and sustained by nostalgia. By elevating those around him, he elevated the sport in ways that future generations should never forget.

The writer teaches Political Science at Ashoka University, Sonipat. Views expressed are personal

There was never one Odyssey

ANANYA BHARDWAJ

TELL ME, Muse, of the man of many ways," The Odyssey begins. It is a curious opening. Rather than claiming ownership over Odysseus' story, Homer invokes the Muse, presenting himself less as an author than as the medium through which an older story is retold.

Before its release, I kept hearing that Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey wasn't "true" to the myth. But how can a myth be true to itself?

I first encountered Homer nearly a decade ago as a first-year English major at Delhi University. We were assigned The Iliad in translation, and many of us wondered why a translated Greek epic belonged in an English classroom at all. That question stayed with me until Professor Sunil Dua, who taught the course, slowly dismantled the assumptions behind it. The point, he argued, was never to read an "original" Homer. It was to understand how stories travel — across languages, cultures, and centuries.

The Iliad and The Odyssey emerged from an oral tradition in which poets performed, improvised, and reshaped stories before audiences. The Homer we read today is the product of centuries of transmission, compilation, and translation. To ask if an adaptation is faithful to an "original" is to overlook the fact that the original itself is elusive.

Nolan's film quietly acknowledges this history. For instance, when Telemachus (Tom Holland) journeys to Sparta to meet Menelaus (Jon Bernthal), he admits to having heard of his father's triumphs not from written records but through the bards who sang the story of the Trojan War. Similarly, Penelope (Anne Hathaway) is sceptical throughout the film because she is unsure of which version to believe regarding Odysseus' fate. The film repeatedly reminds us that reputation, memory, and storytelling shape the hero as much as his actions do.

Nolan is the latest bard in a tradition that has lasted nearly three millennia, the same tradition that allowed Homeric stories to survive in the first place. Every performance reflects the concerns of its moment. If ancient bards could reshape episodes for new audiences, why should a 21st-century filmmaker be denied the same creative freedom?

> Nolan is the latest bard in a tradition that has lasted nearly three millennia, which allowed Homeric stories to survive in the first place. Every performance reflects the concerns of its moment

For Indian readers, this idea should not feel unfamiliar. Our own epics have never belonged to a single text. The Ramayana exists not only in Valmiki's telling but also in Kamban's Tamil version, Tulsidas's Ramcharitmanas, tribal performances, regional adaptations, and modern reinterpretations. The Mahabharata continues to find new life in novels, theatre, and television. We rarely ask which one is the "real" epic.

We have grown accustomed to treating literature — and, by extension, culture — as fixed objects, each with an authoritative version against which adaptations must be judged. Oral epics resist that logic. The question, therefore, is not whether the story is true to "history" but whether the story is being told creatively enough to live across time. The question is also whether we as audiences are willing to let our epics transform with us. Hearing Telemachus address Penelope as "mom" on the big screen reverberated in my eardrums too, but that is exactly how a 2026 Telemachus would call out to his mum! What's the harm in it?

There was never one Odyssey. There were only tellings — by ancient bards, medieval scribes, translators, teachers, readers and now Nolan. The myth of the original Odyssey is, perhaps, the greatest myth of all.

The writer is a PhD candidate, Department of English, The George Washington University

'Don't play politics': SC on Ram Temple donation 'theft' case

Top court asks UP govt if SIT can also probe the FIRs too

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 20

THE SUPREME Court on Monday cautioned against any "politics" in the matter of alleged donation theft at Ayodhya Ram Temple.

"We are only putting a word of caution. Don't play any politics. The courts are not meant for that. Don't politicise the issue. It is a simple, prima facie case of commission of an offence under the penal law. It must be investigated in a fair, impartial manner. Investigation must be taken to a logical conclusion," said a three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said it will go through the report filed by the Uttar Pradesh government and pass necessary directions on July 27 (Monday).

The court was hearing a clutch of petitions seeking its intervention in connection with the alleged theft.

Hearing the petitions on July 13, the SC had sought a report from the Special Investigation Team (SIT) set up by the UP government in the matter.

On Monday, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta informed the bench that the report had been filed. "State police is investigating... it has found that cognizable offence was made out. I can't divulge much as it is an ongoing investigation," the SG said.

The court sought to know if it's the same SIT that is investigating the FIRs too. Mehta said it's not and added that the investigation is being carried out by the police under the supervision of the Superintendent of Police.

Hinting at the need for an SIT probe in the matter, the bench asked the SG to take instructions on whether the team, which had examined the issue before the registration of the FIR, could be entrusted with the responsibility to probe the case instead of the local police.

"Let there be an SIT, which can be headed by this officer... he has prima facie knowledge of what happened. Meanwhile, we will go through this report and whatever additional directions need to be issued, we will do that," the CJI said.

Mehta said he will take instructions.

After the SC hearing, the UP government said it is considering to restructure the SIT probing the temple donation theft case. Sources in government said they have yet to go through the detailed order but the team may now be headed by Inspector General of Police, Lucknow Range, Kiran S, who is one of the three members of the current SIT. Two other IPS officers of DIG and SSP-rank may be the other members of the re-structured SIT. This team may supervise the ongoing police investigation in the donation theft case, as suggested by the apex court, the sources said.

Appearing for some petitioners in the SC, Senior Advocate Devadutt Kamat said: "When the temple was being built, trust (Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust) sought funds from every devotee and from every corner of India and receipts were taken... Ultimately, the money did not reach the temple."

He suggested that all the receipts be disclosed on a website. "Let people know whether their money reached (the temple)."

The court said there may be records where they can be accounted for. Mehta said whatever is needed for a fair, impartial and neutral investigation will be done.

Kamat said devotees have also given gold and silver among other gifts. "Account of that, the state and Trust must give... Today there are reports that these have completely vanished."

EXPRESS special

From 2021 poll violence to 2024 RG Kar rape, how BJP govt is reopening old cases in Bengal

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, July 20

FROM THE 2021 post-election violence in West Bengal to the 2024 R G Kar Medical College rape and murder, and the 2025 death of a schoolgirl in a bomb blast, the BJP government in West Bengal has reopened several old cases in the state. It has also hinted that it is just the start, with several high-profile cases on its radar, calling it dismantling of "years of cover-ups under the previous regime".

In a statement recently, Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said: "Under the previous regime, culprits were distinguished by their political affiliations and police action was heavily influenced by the political identity of the victims. Our government operates differently." It is a change from "law of the ruler" to "rule of the law", he said.

One of the first decisions of the Adhikari government was a comprehensive review of all cases of violence linked to the 2021 Assembly elections, which were swept by the Trinamool Congress.

The CM held a meeting with ADG, Law and Order, Ajay Ranade, after which the government directed all police superintendents and commissioners to meticulously re-examine past investigations, reopen 2021 cases where there were "investigative lapses", and to register fresh cases where preliminary inquiries revealed unaddressed cognizable offences.

The RG Kar Medical College rape and murder had triggered widespread protests across the state. FILE

Police officers said they have launched at least 458 new inquiries into the 2021 violence since, besides registering 181 fresh FIRs and reopening 59 cases. Around 170 fresh cases have been registered in Birbhum alone, a district known for its illegal sand-mining and stone-mining syndicates and political violence. These include cases of murder, attempt to murder, threats and assault.

In 2022, Bogtui in Birbhum district was the site of another episode of political violence when a mob set fire to several houses following the murder of a local TMC leader, burning several women and children alive. Last month, the CBI arrested Rohan Sheikh alias Kismot Sheikh, who had been absconding in the case, from Kolkata.

A senior police officer of Birbhum, who did not want to be identified, told *The Indian Express:* "In the 2021 post-poll violence, around 170 cases have been registered and 175 arrests made. Around a hundred cases have been registered and more than 70 arrests made in connection with illegal mining alone."

Asked about the opening of old cases by the BJP government, TMC spokesperson Pradipta Mukherjee said, "It is less about serving justice and more about targeting the Opposition. If the BJP is truly serious about this, why is (former sports minister) Aroop Biswas moving freely in the Messi (visit fiasco) case? Is it because he joined the refugee (rebel) camp?... Abhishek Banerjee is being called (for questioning) in the DJ (remarks) case, but no action has been taken against Sayoni Ghosh or Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, who spoke on the same lines during the poll campaign (both are in the rebel camp)."

Mukherjee also asked why the same interest is not being shown in other cases, listing the 2018 panchayat polls violence. It was because many leaders behind it who were then in the TMC "are on key posts in the BJP government now", he said.

In the 2025 case of the killing of a 13-year-old, Tamanna Khatun, in Nadia, when a bomb hurled during a TMC victory procession following a bypoll went off, 13 additional arrests have been made, across Haryana and Maharashtra. Adhikari announced on June 27 that almost all the accused named in the case had now been apprehended.

At the time of Tamanna's death, police had blamed it on a clash between two local rival groups, and arrested 11 people. However, the BJP called it a targeted political crime, with the victim's family being supporters of the CPI(M).

The 13 fresh arrests were made by the West Bengal Police from Gurgaon and Nagpur, in a three-day sweep, soon after Tamanna's mother Sabina Yasmin met Adhikari at the state Assembly. Yasmin told *The Indian Express:* "Many directly involved in the case had been roaming free... I had lost all hope."

Atul V, Superintendent of Police, Krishnanagar Police District, said that they have also changed the Special Public Prosecutor in the case.

The August 2024 R G Kar Medical College rape and murder case has also been reopened, with Adhikari citing widespread public concern over "evidence tampering" and "institutional suppression" during the initial probe as the reason for the decision. Three IPS officers who were in senior positions then – Kolkata Police Commissioner Vineet Kumar Goyal, Deputy Commissioner (North Division) Abhishek Gupta, and Deputy Commissioner (Central Division) Indira Mukherjee – were suspended and departmental inquiries ordered against them.

A BJP leader said: "The government is currently operating on two distinct fronts regarding the R G Kar aftermath. It is trying to withdraw harassment-driven police cases against citizens or doctors who participated in the protests. And it intends to prosecute those who vandalized the medical college on August 14, 2024, in a bid to destroy crime scene evidence."

The mother of the R G Kar victim, now a BJP MLA, said the administrative transition represents a crucial step towards accountability, and said she hoped full justice would be done. Said BJP leader Ratna Debnath: "The new government has come and its intention is very clear, that not only the R G Kar victim, every woman who has suffered such things will get justice."

Booked in sexual harassment case, IPS trainee consumes 'unknown substance', is hospitalised

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, July 20

A TRAINEE IPS officer at the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy in Hyderabad, who was accused of sexual harassment by another IPS trainee, is currently undergoing treatment at a private hospital after purportedly consuming an "unknown substance".

Police on Sunday booked M Uday Krishna Reddy under charges of stalking, assault, criminal intimidation and outraging the modesty of a woman. Reddy has denied the charges.

On Monday, he allegedly attempted suicide, police said. "The incident happened at his brother's house in Hyderabad," a senior police officer said.

Reddy was a constable with the Andhra Pradesh Police before he resigned from service in 2019 and cracked the UPSC examination. His journey from constable to IPS had made the news when he cracked the UPSC in 2024, and he had even been congratulated by Andhra Pradesh CM N Chandrababu Naidu.

Before he purportedly consumed the "unknown substance" on Monday, Reddy had written a note in which he claimed that the complainant had been "in a relationship with him". He accused two other trainees of having instigated the complainant to lodge a false complaint.

The complainant had alleged that Reddy harassed her by sending "sexually abusive messages" on WhatsApp. In the complaint dated July 18, she also alleged that he made derogatory comments about her in front of other trainees at the academy. The alleged harassment had been underway since June 23, the complainant had said.

The complainant further alleged that Reddy repeatedly accused her of being "in a relationship with another trainee" on what she claimed were "completely baseless" grounds. She also alleged that he forcibly accessed her personal mobile phone after making her unlock the device. "On July 9..., he restrained my movement and forced me to go to his room and grabbed me by my hair and tried to strangulate me...," the complaint said. Reddy allegedly held a knife against her neck and "did not allow me to leave his room". She accused that he physically assaulted her again on July 10.

"He recorded a private video without my consent or knowledge and sent it to my husband to blackmail me. He further tried to tarnish my image by false and degrading information," she alleged. An FIR was later filed.

Krishna Reddy wrote on his Instagram page, "The complaint and rumours against me are baseless and untrue. I fully trust the legal process and believe justice will prevail." In the note found on Monday, he wrote, "She manipulated everything and said that I assaulted her, which is not true."

Assam floods: 5 dead, thousands evacuated, over 3.6 lakh affected

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 20

FIVE PEOPLE died and over 3.6 lakh were affected after incessant rain led to flooding in Assam.

Eastern Assam was particularly affected as five rivers were flowing above the danger level on Monday.

Six teams of the National Disaster Response Force with 24 boats were deployed for rescue operations in Sivasagar and Charaideo districts, while another two teams with 10 boats were deployed in Jorhat district.

As of Monday evening, a total of 6,710 people were evacuated from affected areas by boats, of whom 5,526 are from Charaideo and 1,000 are from Jorhat.

Four people in Jorhat district died in the flooding on Monday, and another person died in Karbi Anglong.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma announced that the Assam government requested the Army and the Air Force to be on standby to support evacuation and rescue operations if necessary.

Prodip Kalita, a resident of the Nazira area in Sivasagar district, said his house was flooded and that the water was coming up to the chest level.

NDRF personnel conduct a rescue operation in a flood-affected area in Assam on Monday. ANI

"It has been raining since Sunday morning, and the paddy fields around our house started filling up with water. But we thought that it would drain away after some time once the rain stopped. However, it rained throughout till late afternoon, and then we heard that the Dikhow river had swelled up. Within no time, the water from the river swelled over and reached our house," he said.

According to the Assam Disaster Management Authority (ASDMA), the Dikhow river at Sivasagar was flowing at "extreme flood situation" as of 9 am on Monday, flowing at 2.10 metres above its "danger level" of 92.4 metres. At noon, it announced that another river, the Dhansiri in Golaghat district, was flowing at "severe flood situation". Three other rivers, the Burhidihing in Khowang, the Disang in Ngang-lamuraghat and the Brahmaputra in Neamatighat, were also flowing "above danger level".

Announcing efforts to address the overflowing rivers, the Assam government said in a statement, "Sand-filled bags are being laid along the Dikhow embankment, pipping at the Disang embankment in Baruahchuk is being addressed, Type-B geobags are being dumped at Santipur to restore the Disang riverbank and flood fighting works continue at the Jhanji embankment NArkonwar Bailung Gaon."

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Western Railway, Bikaner for & on behalf of the President of India, invites E- tenders for the following work. **Tender Notice No.:** 17-TRD-BKN-ETender-2026-27. **Name of work:** Outsourcing of OHE maintenance activities in Hanumangarh (excl.) Sadulpur (excl.) section of Bikaner Division for a period of 2 years. **Approx Cost of the work:** ₹2,52,62,315.73. **EMD/SD (Rupees):** ₹5,053,00.00. **Date & time of closing of e-tenders:** 12.08.2026 at 15.00 hours. **Date & time of opening of e-tenders:** After 15.00 Hrs on 12.08.2026. **Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website No.:** http://www.ireps.gov.in.
1050-MG/26
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International Institute for Population Sciences
(Deemed to be University)
An Autonomous Organization of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India
Govandi Station Road, Deonar, Mumbai - 400088.
Contact Details: Tel: 91-22- 42372428 & Mob.: 8356962900
Email: distanceeducation@iipsindia.ac.in, Website: www.iipsindia.ac.in

ADMISSION ANNOUNCEMENT FOR M.A DISTANCE PROGRAMME – for the academic session July-August, 2026-27

The International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), an autonomous organization established in 1956 under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, invites applications for admission to the M.A. in Population Studies programme (Distance Learning Mode) for the Academic Year **July-August 2026- 27.**
Last date to submit application offline and online: 19 August 2026.
For more details, please visit: **www.iipsindia.ac.in**
DIRECTOR & SR. PROFESSOR, IIPS

Information & Public Relations Department.
Government of Jharkhand, Suchana Bhawan, Ranchi.
Request For Proposal (RFP)
Reference No. – 1499 Date – 17/07/2026
Request for Proposal (RFP) are invited for selection of eligible reputed qualified firms / companies with sound Technical and Financial capabilities for Conceptualization, Production & On-ground execution of innovative light & sound projection mapping (water projection) for the pilgrims at Shrawani Mela and creatively showcasing the policies and programmes at Shrawani Mela at Deoghar & Dumka.
The Important Information, Terms & Conditions and detailed copy of the RFP document should be downloaded from our website **http://prdjharkhand.in/iprd/** and **https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in**
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Director
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Government of Jharkhand,
PR 385399 IPRD (26-27)D

India all set to get its first dengue vaccine

Anuradha Mascarenhas
Pune, July 20

E.

Key breakthrough in public health

The approval comes at a critical time for public health, with reported cases in India increasing 11-fold over the past two decades. India continues to account for nearly 1/3rd of the global burden of dengue – a mosquito-borne viral disease with prevalence in over 125 countries

INDIA IS all set to get its first dengue vaccine.

The Drug Controller General of India (DCGI) has approved Japanese company Takeda Biopharmaceuticals India's dengue vaccine, Qdenga — making it the first such vaccine to be greenlighted in the country. The vaccine is designed to protect against all four dengue virus strains (DENV-1, DENV-2, DENV-3 and DENV-4) and can be administered regardless of prior dengue exposure, the company said. It also does not require pre-vaccination testing, it added.

Administered subcutaneously, the vaccine comes as a two-dose regimen of 0.5 ml each given three months apart. Takeda has entered into a manufacturing partnership with Hyderabad-based Biological E to produce up to 50 million doses annually. In an official statement issued on Monday, Dr Mahender Nayak, head of intercontinental markets for Takeda, said, "Dengue is a growing public health challenge and India needs sustained, evidence-based prevention."

He said, "The latest seven-year data for Qdenga show continued protection against dengue infection and hospitalisation across all four serotypes -- an important milestone for communities and health systems."

In reply to an email query by *The Indian Express* on the vaccine's pricing, Dr Nayak said, "Takeda is pleased that QDENGA has received Marketing Authorization in India. We are committed to supporting broad, equitable, timely and sustainable access at a cost that reflects the vaccine's value and potential health, societal and economic benefits. Pricing and availability will be communicated once local processes are complete."

Since its launch in 2022, Qdenga has been approved in 43 countries, with more than 32 million doses distributed globally.

Dr Goh Choo Beng, Takeda's medical affairs head for Southeast Asia and India cluster, said, "India carries a substantial dengue burden, and all four dengue virus serotypes have been documented as co-circulating in several regions. The approval represents an important step in strengthening India's comprehensive approach to dengue prevention, alongside vector control, surveillance, community awareness and other public health measures."

J&K floods: Govt shuts schools in Valley, Amarnath Yatra halted

Bashaarat Masood & Arun Sharma
Srinagar, Jammu, July 20

IMAGES OF a flooded Ghanta Ghar in Srinagar circulated on social media as rain continued to lash several parts of Jammu and Kashmir on Monday. As the Met office forecast more rain over the next two days, the J&K government has placed its key departments on alert.

In advisories issued across districts in the Valley, people have been urged to remain vigilant and avoid venturing near hill slopes, rivers and streams due to the heightened risk of flash floods and landslides.

"In light of the forecast issued from July 20-23 by the Indian Meteorological department, the general public is hereby advised to exercise due caution," reads the advisory. "Residents, particularly those living in the vulnerable areas and in proximity of the higher reaches, are strongly advised to avoid unnecessary movement in and around slopes, high altitudes and hilly areas for the period until the weather conditions show improvement".

Waterlogging at Lal Chowk after rain in Srinagar on Monday. ANI

The government has also put its key departments on high alert. "All the concerned departments ... are requested to remain on alert and take all necessary precautions and response measures," the advisory further read.

This comes after 10 more people were killed following landslides in Poonch and Doda, taking the total death toll in J&K to 28 in the last 24 hours. Seven members of a family were killed in a landslide that buried their house in the upper reaches of Loran in Poonch district, while three people were killed and five injured at separate places in Doda.

The alert in the valley came after torrential rain wreaked havoc in Jammu's Rajouri and Poonch districts, where flash floods swept away homes and people. Several people are still missing. J&K CM Omar Abdullah has announced compensation of Rs 6 lakh each for the next of kin of those killed. "While no amount of financial assistance can ever compensate for the irreparable loss of life caused by yesterday's flash floods, landslides and other rain related incidents in Poonch and Rajouri, the Chief Minister has announced ex gratia relief of Rs 6 lakh for the next of kin if each deceased as an immediate measure of support for the bereaved families," the CM office said in a release.

As a precautionary measure, the government has extended the summer vacation by three days and shut all government and recognised private schools in the valley till July 22. The government has also suspended the Amarnath Yatra from both the Baltal and Chandanwari routes.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-Tender
DRM(S&T) NWR, Ajmer on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00 Hrs. on the mentioned date. **Tender No.: 1.** DRM-S&T-25-2026-27-Re-tender, **2.** DRM-S&T-28-2026-27-Re-tender, **3.** DRM-S&T-09-2026-27-Re-Re-tender. **Name of Work: 1.** Provision of Optical Fiber management system for monitoring and reliability improvement of OFC Jurisdiction of DSTE All in Ajmer Division, **2.** Provision of Optical Fibre management system for Monitoring and reliability improvement in Jurisdiction of ADSTE ABR in Ajmer Division, **3.** Ajmer Division: Comprehensive Repair Maintenance Contract of Window/ Split Air Conditioners (Capacity-1.5 & 2 Ton) at various stations/IBH over Ajmer Division for 03 years. **Approximate cost of work: 1.** Rs. 32994775.89, **2.** Rs. 28730896.75, **3.** Rs. 1499272.32. **Bid security: 1.** Rs. 659900.00, **2.** Rs. 574600.00, **3.** Rs. 30000.00. Date & Time of opening E-Tender - **11.08.2026** at **15.30** Hrs. The details of above E-Tender are available on website **www.ireps.gov.in** 1042
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क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम / वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
1.	Supply of 01 CNG Based Truck Mounted Mechanical Road Sweeping Machine and Comprehensive Operation and Maintenance for a Period of 01 year.	रु. 1.70 करोड़
2.	Supply of 04 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti - Smog Guns-	रु. 2.40 करोड़

क्रम सं. 01 से 02 तक जिन्हें दिनांक 22.07.2026 से 31.07.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है, एवं प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 03.08.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।
वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (वर्क सर्किल–7)
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Netanyahu will not be arrested while in US, asserts Trump

Reuters
July 20

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said on Monday that Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu will not be arrested when he visits the United States, after New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani said he was still considering the move.

"Benjamin Netanyahu will not be arrested, in any way, shape, or form, while in the United States of America," Trump wrote in a social media post that did not refer to the mayor's comments.

Trump did not mention Mamdani in his Truth Social post, but credited Israel with helping in the war against Iran.

The New York City mayor said in an interview broadcast on Saturday that the city's legal department is actively considering what the law allows it to do. "I believe that Prime Minister Netanyahu belongs in The Hague. He's a war criminal who has been charged by the International Criminal Court," Mamdani told a *New York Times* video podcast called 'The Interview.'

Netanyahu traditionally travels to New York every September for the annual gathering of world leaders at the United Nations General Assembly. The International Criminal Court has issued an arrest warrant for Netanyahu for alleged war crimes during the war in Gaza .

Israel rejects the court's jurisdiction and denies committing war crimes.

AMID SIGNS DIPLOMACY MIGHT MAKE A COMEBACK, TRUMP SAYS IRAN WILL PAY FOR KILLING U.S. SOLDIERS

Yemen's Houthis open a new war front with naval blockade on Saudi

Reuters
Dubai, Riyadh, July 20

YEMEN'S IRAN-aligned Houthis said Monday they were imposing a naval blockade on Saudi Arabia, a move that opens a new front against US in its war on Iran and widens the threat to global energy supplies.

The Houthis made their announcement despite signs that Tehran and Washington want to resume diplomacy to halt a worsening cycle of attacks that has all but wrecked a fragile interim agreement signed last month.

Iran's Foreign Ministry said mediators had presented "proposals" to Tehran, signalling that diplomatic contacts remain active, but gave no details.

Meanwhile, US President Donald Trump Monday said Iran would "pay" for killing US soldiers after multiple service members were killed over the weekend. "Every time Iran kills an American Soldier they will pay for killing many times over," Trump wrote on Truth Social. "This directive has been passed on to Secretary of War, Pete Hegseth, Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, Daniel Caine."

Iran had been pressing the Houthis to close the Bab el-Mandeb gateway to the Red Sea if the US continued to attack Iranian power infrastructure.

The full closure of the Bab el-Mandeb strait would reduce global oil supply by 7% as it would leave most of Saudi oil exports unable to leave the region.

In their statement, the Houthis' armed forces said they were declaring "a maritime embargo against the criminal Saudi enemy, based on the equation of 'an eye for an eye', effective immediately" in response to what they called "an unjust and oppressive siege" imposed on Yemen by the Saudis. There was no response from Saudi Arabia.

A senior Iranian official told *Reuters* on Monday that Tehran had received a proposal from mediators for a 10-day ceasefire in efforts to salvage the interim deal, intended to pave the way to a lasting agreement to end the war that began on February 28 with US-Israeli attacks on Iran.

Neither the ministry nor the official who spoke to *Reuters* gave any details on the putative ceasefire discussions. Two Pakistani government sources said separately Iranian Interior Minister Eskandar Momeni had asked Pakistan to resume its mediation role. The diplomatic push followed another night of US strikes on Iranian cities and attacks by the IRGC on US military assets across the region.

Vehicles drive past a monument depicting the clenched fist of late supreme leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran on Sunday. AP

Tehran and Washington face a 'wake up moment' over West Asia conflict

Erika Solomon
July 20

AFTER MORE than a week of strikes that unraveled an ill-fated ceasefire, the conflict between United States and Iran stands on a knife's edge. Now is the time, analysts say, to find a way to draw down an exponentially destructive confrontation — or risk provoking a war that cascades beyond what they may be able to contain.

And though the dangers of escalation are growing, analysts say, neither side can really afford it, either economically or politically at home. Over the past few days, Iran and the US have dealt blows that quickly went beyond battering military targets and have gradually raised the stakes of their renewed war.

Both sides have struck water and desalination plants that risk depriving tens of thousands of power and water supplies during the deadly Gulf summer heat.

Traffic through the vital Strait of Hormuz is once again blocked both by officials in Tehran, the Iranian capital, and those in Washington, while the US has reinstated a blockade of Iranian ports.

US strikes have heavily bombarded roads and infrastructure in southern Iran, killing and trapping civilians, while raising anxieties it is preparing the ground for a potential invasion in the area.

Iran's strikes on US forces in Jordan have now killed two US soldiers and wounded dozens, bringing the human cost of war much closer to home for Americans while puncturing the Trump administration's projection of complete military dominance. "This is the wake-up moment for both sides," said Ellie Geranmayeh, an Iran expert at the European Council on Foreign Relations. "They either take the diplomatic off ramp now or risk allowing the war to spiral beyond managed escalation."

As both sides' targets expand, so does the war's potential geographic reach.

The growing tit-for-tat of infrastructure strikes in Iran and Arab Gulf countries could quickly devastate civilian populations in the region. Iran has already warned that if it is hit badly enough, it will gun for Gulf installations critical to international energy supplies. NYT

Britain's King Charles III greets Labour Party leader Andy Burnham during an audience at Buckingham Palace in London on Monday. AP

New PM of Britain pledges to end years of political instability

Burnham assures Trump on defence, security, West Asia

Reuters
London, July 20

ANDY BURNHAM became Britain's seventh prime minister in a decade on Monday, pledging to reshape its politics to deliver a new economic model and revive a nation "fed up" with a revolving door of leaders.

In front of dozens of supporters outside his new office and residence at 10 Downing Street, Burnham said politicians had failed to bring the stability needed to raise living standards, something he said he would change.

Speaking without notes, Burnham said, "I know people at home are fed up with politics. I hear you, and I want to be honest with you, we have not been good enough and we need to be better." Burnham pledged to use his premiership as a "circuit-breaker for Britain."

Just over an hour after his predecessor Keir Starmer made his farewell speech to say "my work is done", the 56-year-old former Greater Manchester mayor entered Downing Street.

In one of his first calls with a foreign leader, Burnham assured US President Donald Trump that London would be committed to defence and security and would help support the safe reopening of the Strait of Hormuz.

"The PM... underlined his commitment to defence and security and said ensuring the security of the UK and its allies was at the top of his agenda," a spokesperson said.

Healey new UK Chancellor, Ed Miliband is Foreign Secy

London: Former Defence Secretary John Healey has been named as the Chancellor of the Exchequer and Ed Miliband as the new Foreign Secretary under new PM Andy Burnham, the UK government said on Monday. REUTERS

Veterans Hamas official Khalil al-Hayya named group's leader

Reuters
July 20

KHALIL AL-Hayya, a senior Hamas official who survived an Israeli raid on Qatar in September last year and who is seen as having good ties with Iran, was named on Monday as the leader of the Palestinian militant group.

Hayya, who lost a son in the Gaza conflict and two sons in previous wars, has been based with other Hamas leaders in Doha. He has become increasingly influential in the group as other top Hamas officials have been killed in Israeli strikes, among them Ismail Haniyeh on a visit to Iran and Yahya Sinwar in the Gaza Strip.

Hayya was at the heart of ceasefire talks throughout the Gaza war that erupted when Hamas launched a surprise attack on Israel on October 7, 2023, prompting a sweeping Israeli offensive that has flattened much of the enclave since then.

He took part in indirect talks with Israel that culminated in a US-brokered ceasefire in October 2025 that halted major fighting in Gaza, although Israel has continued attacks on Hamas and other militants who it says pose an imminent threat.

Khalil al-Hayya

An earlier ceasefire initiative had been on the agenda for discussion between the 64-year-old and other Hamas leaders when they were targeted in Israel's September 9 attack on Doha, in which six people were killed but no top Hamas officials.

Hayya, widely seen as the group's most influential figure abroad since Haniyeh was killed by Israel in Iran in July 2024, is part of a five-man leadership council based in Qatar that has led Hamas since Yahya Sinwar, the mastermind of the October 2023 attacks, was killed last year.

Hailing from the Gaza Strip, Hayya is a veteran member of the Islamist group. Regarded as having good ties with Iran, a vital source of arms and finance for Hamas, he has been closely involved in the group's efforts to broker several truces with Israel, playing a key role in ending a 2014 conflict and again in attempts to secure an end to the current Gaza war.

Hayya has been part of Hamas since it was set up in 1987.

In the early 1980s, he joined the Muslim Brotherhood, the Sunni Islamist movement from which Hamas emerged, along with Haniyeh and Sinwar, Hamas sources say. In Gaza, he was detained several times by Israel. In 2007, an Israeli airstrike hit his family home in Gaza City killing several relatives. In 2008, his son Hamza was killed by an Israeli airstrike.

Hayya left Gaza several years ago, serving as a Hamas point person for ties with the Arab and Islamic worlds and basing himself in Qatar. He accompanied Haniyeh to Tehran for the visit in July during which Haniyeh was assassinated.

Ukraine fires 400 drones at Moscow as Zelenskyy grapples with protests

Associated Press
Kyiv, July 20

UKRAINE FIRED more than 400 drones toward Moscow in its latest major attack on the Russian capital, the city's mayor said Monday.

The blitz came hours after Russia bombarded Kyiv and other cities with ballistic missiles in a relentless cycle of tit-for-tat strikes that make a settlement to end Moscow's more than 4-year-old all-out invasion appear a distant possibility.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, meanwhile, said he would hold "key talks" on Monday as he tries to defuse a domestic political crisis, after last week's government reshuffle exposed a deep split between the military's old guard and young innovators over how to fight the war.

Zelenskyy needs to reassure Ukrainians that sacrificing 35-year-old Mykhailo Fedorov as defence minister and keeping faith with 60-year-old Soviet-trained General Oleksandr Syrskyi as armed forces chief won't derail the fight against Russia.

Days of street protests in favour of Fedorov and against Syrskyi followed Zelenskyy's decision. Moscow Mayor Sergei Sobyanin said that over 400 Ukrainian drones were sent toward the Russian capital from late Sunday until early Monday. He said most were downed far from the capital and 85 were intercepted near Moscow.

Andrei Vorobyov, the head of the region around Moscow, said that 10 people were wounded by Ukrainian drones. He said that several residential buildings and civilian infrastructure facilities were damaged.

The attack started a fire at the Yuzhnye Vrata industrial park, about 30 kilometres south of Moscow, according to Yevgeniya Khrustaleva, the head of the Domodedovo area of the Moscow region.

The *Astra news* outlet reported that the assault also caused a fire at an oil depot in Podolsk, about 20 kilometres south of Moscow but there was no official confirmation of the strike.

Ukrainian forces struck logistics facilities and an oil depot in the Moscow region, more than 400 kilometres from Ukraine's border, Zelenskyy said. He also said Ukrainian forces hit two vessels belonging to Russia's so-called shadow fleet transporting sanctioned oil and four dry cargo ships in the Black Sea.

Half-Time, Full House

Ronaldinho and Ronaldo perform with Madonna during the halftime show of the 2026 FIFA World Cup final match between Spain and Argentina in the East Rutherford stadium in New York on Sunday. AP

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

JD, Usha Vance welcome baby boy, a first for sitting V-P in over 150 yrs

JD Vance with his wife Usha Vance at a rally in Middleton, Ohio. FILE

VICE PRESIDENT JD Vance and his wife, second lady Usha Vance, on Sunday announced the birth of their fourth child, the first born to a sitting vice president in more than 150 years. Born Sunday, Alec Neel Vance joins older siblings Ewan, 9; Vivek, 6; and Mirabel, 4. "We are excited to announce that our baby boy, Alec Neel Vance, was born this morning. Usha and the baby are happy and healthy, and our kids are overjoyed to meet their little brother," a statement by the family said. AP

SINGAPORE

Minister quits over 'interactions' with woman

SINGAPORE'S ACTING Minister-in-Charge of Muslim Affairs Faishal Ibrahim has resigned after questions regarding his conduct were raised over his interactions with a woman, according to an official statement."Most of their interactions took place through online messages. They also met on the sidelines of public events," PM Lawrence Wong said in a statement on Monday. AP

NICARAGUA

Ortega: Country will no longer hold elections

NICARAGUA'S LONG-serving president Daniel Ortega said the Central American country will no longer hold elections, eliminating the possibility of an electoral challenge when his term ends next year and further entrenching the rule he shares with his wife. Ortega said move will close off any path to opposition, without providing details of carrying out the measure. REUTERS

• AUTHOR & TRANSLATOR FAULTED THE DIRECTOR FOR GIVING US AN ODYSSEUS WITH 'NO CLEVERNESS, NO HUMOUR, NO WILY CHARM'

Not 'Greek' to them— some scholars question Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey*

Associated Press
New York, July 20

FOR GREEK translator Emily Wilson, the release of director Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey* has been gratifying in various ways. Her acclaimed 2017 edition of Homer's epic has reached the top 5 on Amazon.com, leading a wave of similar books boosted by the movie. Nolan has even cited her translation, notably the opening line "Tell me about a complicated man," as inspiration.

But the film itself, which brought in more than $260 million worldwide during its opening weekend and has received raves from many critics, left her unsatisfied. "I want to celebrate the fact that so many more people are aware of *The Odyssey* and were brought back to the poem," she told *The Associated Press*. "But at the same time, I had the sense that Christopher Nolan was trying to pack everything in while missing themes that were essential to the poem."

One of the year's most anticipated releases, *The Odyssey* stars Matt Damon as the returning warrior Odysseus, Anne Hathaway as his wife, Penelope, and Tom Holland as their son, Telemachus. Reviewers have praised acting and narrative drive, the grand scale of a movie shot entirely on IMAX film and how it weds the sensibilities of ancient Greece and the modern world, at least as Nolan perceives it.

The divide between scholars and critics seems in part a matter of whether the balance should tilt toward Nolan or Homer. Wilson and fellow translator Daniel Mendelsohn both expressed admiration for Nolan's cinematic flair and ambition, what Mendelsohn calls his "great visual panache." Both speculated that his desire to make a "Christopher Nolan" movie led to unfortunate decisions.

Mendelsohn is an author, critic and translator and his assessment appeared Friday in *The New York Review of Books*, where he is an editor-at-large.

Mendelsohn had previously defended Nolan's controversial decision to cast a Black actor, Lupita Nyong'o, as Helen of Troy, calling it a worthy way to "provoke, challenge and discomfit how we think about beauty and identity."

But he faulted the director for giving us an Odysseus with "no cleverness, no humor, no wily charm." One of the Western canon's formative tricksters has been transformed, he contended, into the kind of haunted protagonist featured in such previous Nolan movies as *Oppenheimer* and *Memento*.

"This tormented, guilt-ridden Odysseus, stripped of humor and wit, seductiveness and cleverness, is a sibling of Memento's anguished amnesiac, of Batman, of Oppenheimer, men tormented by pasts they wrestle with in different ways," wrote Mendelsohn, whose *Odyssey* translation came out in 2025. "Nolan has merely remade Homer's hero in his own image."

Author Gareth Hinds, whose graphic novel adaptation of *The Odyssey* has also received a sales bump from the movie, had a response similar to Mendelsohn's about Nolan's interpretation of Odysseus.

The "wily trickster and smooth talker" is now an "everyman who appears to be honorable, except in select situations which then continue to haunt him." For Hinds, Nolan's film raises the question of how much you can change a story's main character before the story itself is changed entirely.

"That's one of many interesting things Nolan has left us to ponder," says Hinds, who credits the director for creating a "powerful film."

Wilson, a professor of classical studies at the University of Pennsylvania, said she didn't want to come across as a "snobby," nitpicking expert at odds with any deviation from the original text. But she questioned a range of omissions and other choices, from the absence on screen of the Gods Zeus and Poseidon (Athena is played by Zendaya) to the "incoherent" messaging that condemns both war and physical cowardice.

Wilson also that thought parts of the movie, notably the scenes with Odysseus' dog, Argos, "catered towards modern sentimentality." AP

Matt Damon *(left)*, director Christopher Nolan, and Anne Hathaway at the premiere of *The Odyssey* at AMC Lincoln Square in New York. AP

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• ENERGY

Despite record solar adoption, why Kerala is facing power cuts

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, July 20

KERALA IS among India's leading states when it comes to household adoption of rooftop solar panels under the PM Surya Ghar Yojana. While the scheme's success has been uneven nationwide, Kerala ranks fourth in installed capacity, ahead of several big states.

Yet, this is at the heart of the challenge in meeting its power demand. This sounds counterintuitive — shouldn't more rooftop solar panels ease electricity supply?

The answer is not so straightforward.

Solar success story

Data shows Kerala's solar power installed capacity touched 2,508 megawatts (MW) by the end of May 2026. The vast majority of this — 2,036 MW — is from rooftop panels.

Under the scheme, Kerala has 2.96 lakh installations covering 3,03,531 households, with an installed capacity of 1,150 MW. Meanwhile, neighbouring Karnataka has only 22,383 installations covering 33,843 households, with an installed capacity of 91 MW.

The share of solar power as a whole is more than 50% of the state's total installed capacity from all sources. This proportion is even better than the all-India share of solar power in the overall power generation mix: 150 GW of the total installed capacity of 532 GW.

• DAILY DEMAND

- Although traditionally dependent on hydroelectricity, 83% of Kerala's daily power demand is now met by purchases from power exchanges.
- Daily average consumption is 88.45 million units, of which total domestic generation from hydel, wind and solar comes to 15 million units.

The issue

In many industrially developed states, the demand for power peaks during the day. In Kerala, however, the peak demand is from 6 to 11 pm as 75% of the consumers are domestic. Industrial and commercial connections account for only around 20% of the total consumers. This has created a mismatch between an abundance of solar energy during the day and the shortage of power supply at night.

This mismatch is not a Kerala problem alone. India's power grid has been facing its greatest strain at night time. This, however, is more a function of supply failing to even meet the relatively reduced night-time demand, rather than demand rising during those hours. In Kerala, the latter is the key problem — demand rises at night.

The power produced from solar plants during the day is exported to the low-tension power distribution grid. But excessive feeding of solar power to the grid during the day, when consumption is low, increases the voltage in the system. This increases the chances of electrical appliances and transformers getting damaged.

So, when power supply declines in the national market at night, Kerala's electricity utility is forced to buy it at higher prices to meet its rising demand.

As the share of renewable power sources increases, so does the mismatch between when electricity is generated and when it is needed. The answer is storage.

The state has lined up a battery energy storage system to "store" the solar power produced during the day — rather than pumping it back into the grid. This will ensure that the power can be used during the peak nighttime hours.

• LAW

Staging a protest: Rights, restrictions in the law

The right to protest is protected under Article 19(1)(a) and Article 19(1)(b) of the Constitution. This right, however, is not absolute and may be regulated

AMAAL SHEIKH

AFTER THOUSANDS of people gathered in New Delhi for the Cockroach Janta Party's planned protest march to Parliament, the police cracked down, stopping the protesters at multiple barricades before Parliament Street.

Eyewitnesses reported lathi charge and the use of tear gas to disperse the crowd.

The police action has once again brought into focus the legal framework governing protests in India, especially the use of Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), the provision that replaced Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC).

What does the law say?

The right to protest is protected under Article 19(1)(a) and Article 19(1)(b) of the Constitution, which guarantee citizens the freedom of speech and expression and the right to assemble peacefully and without arms.

These rights, however, are not absolute. Articles 19(2) and 19(3) permit the State to impose "reasonable restrictions" in the interests of the "sovereignty and integrity of India, the security of the State, friendly relations with Foreign States, public order, decency or morality," among other grounds.

This means that citizens are free to organise protests, but governments may regulate where and how they take place. Demonstrations often require police permission, are confined to designated protest sites such as Jantar Mantar in New Delhi and Azad Maidan in Mumbai, and may be restricted through prohibitory orders issued under Section 163 of the BNSS.

Section 163 empowers an Executive Magistrate to issue written directions where "immediate prevention or speedy remedy" is considered necessary to prevent obstruction, danger to human life or public tranquillity, or the possibility of a riot or affray. The provision is designed as an emergency measure, and the orders ordinarily remain in force for not more than two months unless extended according to law.

India has consistently defended this approach internationally. Addressing the UN Human Rights Council in Geneva in 2021, India's representative said that while peaceful assembly is a cherished constitutional right, the government must also balance it with its obligation to protect public order and the right to life.

Protesters near Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

How has Section 163 actually been used?

Although Section 163 is most commonly associated with prohibiting protests, empirical evidence suggests that protest-related restrictions form only a small fraction of its use in Delhi.

A study published in March 2023 by advocates Vrinda Bhandari, Abhinav Sekhri, Natasha Maheshwari and Madhav Aggarwal examined around 5,400 Section 144 orders issued across Delhi between January 2021 and 2022. It found that roughly only 1.5% of orders related to prohibited unlawful assemblies, while five of Delhi's 18 police districts did not issue a single assembly-related order during the period. The report said that an emergency power intended for exceptional situations had gradually become a tool of routine administration.

Emergency power

The Supreme Court upheld the validity of the erstwhile Section 144 of the CrPC as an emergency power.

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But the court stressed that it could not become a permanent mechanism to prohibit protests.

The study also found that almost every order had been reissued the moment the two-month statutory limit expired, characterising it as a "city-wide mechanical process of issuing cyclostyled orders", including during Covid-19 lockdowns when the conditions that justified the original order no longer held.

What has the Supreme Court said?

The SC has consistently held that while governments may regulate protests in the interests of public order, they cannot extinguish the constitutional right to peaceful assembly altogether.

In *Himat Lal K. Shah v. Commissioner of Police* (1973), the court held that while the state may regulate public meetings on streets, it cannot impose an arbitrary exclusion that effectively deprives citizens of their right to assemble. "Freedom of assembly is an essential element of any democratic system. At the root of this concept lies the citizens' right to meet face to face with others for the discussion of their ideas and problems — religious, political, economic or social." The court added, "It is doubtless true that the State or local authority can regulate its property in order to serve its public purposes... But there is a constitutional difference between reasonable regulation and arbitrary exclusion."

The Court elaborated on these principles in *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* (2018). The case challenged the repeated issuance of Section 144 orders prohibiting public meetings, demonstrations and dharnas around Parliament House, North and South Block, Central Vista and adjoining areas without written permission.

The Supreme Court upheld the validity of Section 144 as an emergency power but stressed that it could not become a permanent mechanism to prohibit protests. It noted that although the orders formally required prior permission, authorities had effectively converted the permission requirement into a blanket ban by routinely refusing permission.

The judgment also dealt with an NGT order that had prohibited all protests along Jantar Mantar Road. Setting aside the blanket prohibition, the Court observed that "the solution was not to ban the demonstrations altogether" but to regulate them in a manner that balanced protesters' rights with the rights of local residents.

The SC directed authorities to frame guidelines governing protests, including regulating the number of participants, maintaining minimum distances from Parliament, the SC and other sensitive locations, prescribing time limits and prohibiting weapons such as firearms, lathis and swords. The ruling effectively reaffirmed Jantar Mantar as Delhi's designated protest site, while making clear that regulation must not become prohibition.

Two years later, in *Amit Sahni v Commissioner of Police* (2020), which arose from the Shaheen Bagh protests, the Supreme Court held that protests must be held in "identified areas" and protesters cannot block public roads and cause inconvenience to others.

"You cannot block public roads. There cannot be indefinite period of protest in such an area. If you want to protest, it has to be in an area identified for protest. You cannot create inconvenience for the people," the court said.

• GLOBAL

'King of the North' to the UK's new PM: The rise of Andy Burnham

Arav Shah
New Delhi, July 20

ANDY BURNHAM was appointed the UK's new Prime Minister on Monday, following the resignation of his predecessor, Keir Starmer. He vacated the position last month in the wake of intense speculation over his continued ability to lead the Labour Party, following a dismal performance in the local elections earlier this year.

In parallel, another unlikely figure was on the rise. Andy Burnham, 56, who sat out the 2024 general elections that Labour won, swept the Makerfield by-election this year. He subsequently won the internal party contest, with his ascension coming at a time of intense scrutiny and disorganisation in the Labour Party.

Early Labour years

Andrew Murray Burnham was born in Lancashire and read English at the University of Cambridge. Until 2001, he served as a special advisor to the Secretary of State for Culture, Media and Sport, Chris Smith.

In 2001, Burnham entered the House of Commons and was elected as the MP for Leigh in 2001. He climbed the political ladder over the next few years by working in the governments of Tony Blair and Gordon Brown, and became the Health Secretary.

From 2010 to 2017, Burnham served in several positions in the shadow Cabinet, which comprises members of the Opposition in the UK. Burnham unsuccessfully contested Labour's internal elections in 2010 and 2015. In 2016, he announced his intention to contest the mayoral elections and take a step back from Westminster.

King of the North

Burnham was elected as Mayor of Manchester in 2017 and was re-elected twice, but his standout moment came during a Covid-era lockdown standoff in 2020 with the Central government.

He organised an unscripted press conference in response to the then Conservative government's attempts to force Greater Manchester into strict tiers without requisite financial support. His strongly worded statement branding the central government's approach as "brutal" and "disgraceful" earned him the moniker "King of the North" while cementing his position as a leader looking out for smaller, forgotten communities.

Burnham's philosophy

- Burnham's return to Westminster has been attributed to his emerging economic philosophy dubbed "Manchesterism".
- This concept champions aggressive state-level intervention to promote regional growth and devolution of power.

Britain's new PM Andy Burnham. AP

Burnham also went on to establish the Bee Network, which was a public transport overhaul that pioneered an affordable, unified and fully integrated system outside of London. His attempts were well-received — visible in his re-election in 2021 and 2024, where he won over 60% of the vote.

Return to Westminster

Today, Burnham's return has been attributed to his emerging economic philosophy dubbed "Manchesterism". This concept champions aggressive state-level intervention to promote regional growth and devolution of power.

Former Ambassador to Belgium and the EU, Manjeev Singh Puri, told *The Indian Express*: "Labour might think that he is the man to galvanise them to be a party that can win the upcoming 2029 general elections." This power to galvanise was seen within a day of Burnham's win in Makerfield, amid Starmer's weakened position. "Fundamentally, Burnham also enjoys being on the right side of perception since Starmer reached a point after his 2024 landslide victory where Labour MPs didn't perceive him as the next general election leader," Puri said.

Burnham was the favourite early on after Starmer's exit, securing the votes of 379 of the 403 Labour MPs. Ideologically, he walks a factional tightrope, representative of the challenges Labour faces. He has advocated expanding council housing to appease the more left-leaning voters, while pledging himself as a 'pro-business' PM to reassure the centrist right.

• POLICY

What EPFO 3.0 proposes: Pension cover for all, social security for gig workers

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, July 20

A UNIVERSAL pension cover for all workers with option of either annuity or systematic withdrawal plan, first-time social security contributions for unorganised sector workers including gig and platform workers, an upgradation of tech ecosystem to incorporate core banking solution (CBS) — these are some of the key changes being planned by the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) as part of its 3.0 reforms phase.

The EPFO is set to move towards this through a CBS-enabled tech platform, which has been seen as necessary to help it navigate payments for social security schemes covering over 60 crore workers, out of which over three-quarters are in the unorganised sector, with limited or no pension coverage.

Target Retirement Sum

The new pension cover will have a defined contribution framework with contributions from multiple sources including workers themselves, employers, government co-contributions for lower-income workers, aggregators in the case of gig and platform workers, and corporate social responsibility (CSR) or third-party funds. This is the first time that the EPFO is considering such forms of contributions or withdrawals at the time of retirement: presently, it only allows advance claims or partial withdrawals for certain categories such as education, illness, housing, and marriage during the membership tenure, or a lumpsum final settlement at the time of retirement.

The contributions will accumulate over time, and be invested in government-backed securities, with annual crediting of interest, giving two options for conversion of the "Target Retirement Sum (TRS)" at the time of retirement — pension based on prevailing annuity and interest rates, or a systematic withdrawal plan.

"Till the time of retirement, it will operate like PF, you keep on accumulating," an official told *The Indian Express*.

The system will compute the proposed TRS dynamically based on the member's chosen pension goal and expected retirement age. Members will have personalised dashboards showing total contributions, real-time corpus status, and progress towards the TRS for applicable schemes. The system will project the required contribution amount and frequency to achieve the declared TRS.

Inflation-linked simulation

Global models are being studied to incorporate similar features such as that of Singapore, which has a deferred annuity scheme that sets aside savings not just for retirement but also for housing and healthcare. Singapore's social security scheme relies not just on individual contributions for the retirement income as apart from a contribution of 20% of the salary, individual efforts are supplemented by employers, loved ones, and the government.

The flexibility to decide the amount for pension payouts, or the drawdown, will be given to the member as they will also have access to inflation-adjusted projections. The EPFO 3.0 system will allow users to simulate pension amounts based on parameters such as age, corpus, interest rate, and retirement age. It will also include additional input fields for voluntary contributions and contribution frequency.

The system will provide inflation-adjusted projections as an optional feature. The estimated monthly pension, projected corpus at retirement, and comparative graphs will be displayed to the member, allowing multiple scenario comparisons for decision making taking into account variable contributions and multiple employment scenarios.

The member can choose to increase or decrease the drawdown under the systematic withdrawal plan.

Gig and platform workers coverage

As the EPFO expects around 2.5 crore gig workers and building and other construction workers (BOCW) over the next five years, the pension scheme is also being designed keeping in mind their inclusion into social security coverage for the first time. The scheme will incorporate "one-to-many mapping" where one Universal Account Number (UAN) will be registered with multiple employers and aggregators, showing total PF and pension contributions from all sources for these workers while maintaining their employer-wise breakdowns.

The EPFO system plans to allow third-party contributions like NGOs, individuals, donor organisations, CSR, and track all contributions under each UAN with a configurable upper limit.

It also proposes family and survivor pensions for spouse, children, and orphans funded through a pooled "Family Benefit Fund". Members of EPF, General Provident Fund, and other PFs could also be allowed to transfer balances into the new pension initiative.

The 3.0 phase will also pave the way for PF contributions for all unorganised sector workers and gig workers, in line with the Code on Social Security that brings gig and platform workers into the social security net for the first time. The Code mandates aggregator contributions of 1-2% of annual turnover for social security, with the total contribution not exceeding 5% of the amount payable by the aggregator.

While the core scheme's foundation will remain the same — employee PF, pension scheme — the CBS-enabled tech platform will allow changes in the mechanism of contributions that will be built on the split-payment model aggregators use at present. CBS is a centralised payments software which forms the backbone of banks in India allowing operations like deposits, withdrawals, in real time across all branches.

"For example, for unorganised workers, there is no contribution, they themselves can make a contribution. Or else, a third party can make a contribution," the official said.

'RENEWABLES, DIGITAL INNOVATION TO LEAD NEXT GROWTH WAVE; AI WON'T RESULT IN JOB LOSSES'

'FCNR(B) flows to peak in August, Sept; overall target achievable'

PUNJAB NATIONAL Bank Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer **Ashok Chandra** said the bank is on track to achieve the target of $2.50 billion under the FCNR(B) scheme. "Most of the inflows across the industry are likely to come during the latter half of August and September, so I am optimistic that the overall banking target (of over $50 billion) can be achieved," he told **George Mathew** in an interview. Throughout the last financial year, he saw healthy growth in every quarter across retail, agriculture and MSME lending, and there is no point in mobilising excess liquidity if it cannot be deployed productively, Chandra said.

He said renewable energy is one of the sectors they have identified as a champion area, and ruled out any job losses due to AI introduction in banking. Edited excerpts:

Coming to the recent RBI measures on FCNR(B) deposits, how has been the response so far? Are inflows meeting your expectations? What do you expect over the next three months?

Yes, the response has been in line with our expectations. So far, we have mobilised around $425 million.

We have guided the market that we intend to mobilise $2.5 billion before September 30, and we are on track to achieve that target. In fact, we expect to reach it ahead of the schedule.

Has the higher cost of funds created challenges? Since depositors can also borrow overseas, has that affected mobilisation?

No, not at all. While the cost structure has increased, it has not created any significant issue for us. We have a large NRI customer base across several countries, and our teams are actively engaging with them. What has changed is the scale of our outreach. Earlier, we may have focused on a relatively small group of NRIs. Today, we are engaging with a much larger customer base. Our objective is to broaden our overseas deposit base rather than depend on a limited number of customers.

More broadly, do you believe the banking industry as a whole will be able to mobilise around $50 billion under the scheme?

Yes, I believe it will. Most of the inflows across the industry are likely to come during the latter half of August and September, so I am optimistic that the overall target can be achieved.

Is there any significant switching by NRIs from NRE deposits to FCNR(B) deposits?

No, we are not seeing that. It would generally not be advantageous for customers to convert existing NRE deposits into FCNR(B) deposits at the current rates, as they would incur a loss in doing so. The scheme is more beneficial for customers bringing in fresh overseas deposits, and that is where we are seeing the inflows.

EXPRESS interview

ASHOK CHANDRA
MD AND CEO, PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK

Credit growth has picked up significantly over the last few months. Which sectors are driving this growth? Do you expect the momentum to continue?

The retail, agriculture and MSME (RAM) segment has performed very well. Throughout the last financial year, we saw healthy growth in every quarter across retail, agriculture and MSME lending. The bank placed considerable focus on these segments during the last financial year. We conducted extensive outreach programmes across the country. The entire top management — including the MD and CEO, executive directors, chief general managers, general managers, and officials from the Head Office — visited the field. This created significant traction. Retail lending grew by 17.5%, priority sector lending by 16.4%, and MSME lending by 19.8%, nearly 20%. Our corporate loan book also grew by around 10%. In fact, the underlying corporate portfolio grew by nearly 15-16%, but because we repriced and exited certain low-yield advances, the reported growth stands at about 10%. We continue to see strong traction in the corporate segment as well. Overall, the bank has performed well across all segments, and this momentum has continued into the current quarter.

On the corporate lending side, which sectors are generating strongest demand?

Renewable energy is one of the sectors we have identified as a champion area. We are growing faster than many players in the segment, with growth of around 30% in renewable energy financing. Apart from that, we're seeing healthy demand in infrastructure, particularly roads, data centres, agriculture-related businesses, trading activities, and engineering. During the last financial year, we sanctioned nearly Rs 4 lakh crore worth of corporate loans. Our lending is well diversified across sectors.

AI is being adopted rapidly across industries. Do you think it could lead to job losses in banking? How do you see it helping areas such as credit operations and risk management?

Our objective in adopting these digital tools is to improve the customer experience. Customer convenience remains our highest priority. These technologies will enable our employees to engage more effectively with customers and provide better service. At the same time, we will continue to upgrade the skills of our employees through training and reskilling so they can work effectively alongside these new technologies. The objective is to ensure that both our employees and our customers benefit from digital transformation.

So, are you saying AI will not result in job cuts?

No, we do not see AI leading to job losses. What AI will do is improve productivity, streamline processes, enhance the quality of our services and improve the quality of our data. These are the key benefits we expect from adopting these technologies. FULL INTERVIEW ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Hormuz crisis: Crude imports surge 60%; net oil, gas imports up 45%

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, July 20

INDIA'S CRUDE oil import bill surged by over 60% on a year-on-year (y-o-y) basis in the first quarter of the current financial year even as import volumes dipped slightly amid supply tightness and elevated prices due to the West Asia crisis and stifled energy flows through the Strait of Hormuz, as per provisional data from the petroleum ministry.

Similarly, liquefied natural gas (LNG) imports and petroleum product exports declined in volume terms, while rising in value. Overall, the country's net oil and gas imports jumped 45% in value from year-ago levels, underscoring the adverse economic impact of the West Asia crisis on energy import-dependent India.

The country depends on imports to meet over 88% of its crude oil requirement and about half of its consumption of natural gas, which is imported as LNG, or super-chilled gas. Despite depending on imported oil and gas, it is a net exporter of petroleum products due to its massive oil refining capacity, while it also imports some petroleum products like liquefied petroleum gas (LPG).

Around 40% of India's crude oil imports, 60% of its LNG imports, and a whopping 90% of its LPG imports came from West Asia through the strait. Apart from grappling with physical supply tightness due to the Strait of Hormuz crisis, the resultant surge in international prices forced India to import oil and gas at extremely high rates, as the country has been prioritising supply security over price considerations.

The June MoU between the US and Iran brought a sigh of relief for India and the global energy market, but the renewed conflict in the Gulf following the pact's effective collapse is emerging as a major concern as energy flows through the strait have crashed again after a short-lived three-week recovery.

West Asia war impacts energy bill

	APR-JUN FY26	APR-JUN FY27	CHANGE (%)
Oil imports (mn tn)	62.6	59.8	-4.5
Oil imports ($ bn)	30.9	49.8	61.2
Petroleum pdt imports (mn tn)	12.2	7.1	-41.8
Petroleum pdt imports ($ bn)	5.8	4.2	-27.6
LNG imports (mscm)	8396	7674	-8.6
LNG imports ($ bn)	3.4	3.6	5.9
Petroleum pdt exports (mn tn)	15	11.3	-24.7
Petroleum pdt exports ($ bn)	9.1	12.7	39.6
Net oil & gas imports ($ bn)	30.9	44.9	45.3

SOURCE: PETROLEUM PLANNING AND ANALYSIS CELL (PPAC)

Oil & gas trade math

According to latest provisional data released by the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC), crude oil imports in the June quarter rose 61.2% y-o-y to $49.8 billion, even as import volumes declined 4.5% to 59.8 million tonnes (mt), or about 438 million barrels. This translates to about $113 per barrel as the average landed price of imported crude oil in the June quarter, up from around $67 per barrel in the corresponding quarter of last year. The PPAC data shows that India's dependence on imported oil in April-June was 89.1%, flat on a y-o-y basis.

As for LNG imports, while supplies declined 8.6% to 7,674 million standard cubic metres (mscm) in April-June from 8,396 mscm in the corresponding quarter of last year, the LNG import bill rose by almost 6% to $3.6 billion, reflecting the spurt in prices.

Petroleum product imports declined almost 42% in volume terms to 7.1 mt, as supply of major petroleum products that India imports — like LPG — were impacted by the West Asia war. In value terms, the decline in petroleum product imports was relatively lower — down 27.6% to $4.2 billion — due to high international prices.

The country's petroleum product export volumes declined by a fourth to 11.3 mt in April-June from 15 mt in the corresponding period of last year as domestic fuel supplies took precedence amid the global supply crunch. Nonetheless, the exports surged nearly 40% in value due to the jump in international petroleum fuel prices.

Taking into account the overall oil, LNG, and petroleum product imports as well as fuel exports, the country's net oil and gas imports rose 45.3% y-o-y in April-June to $44.9 billion, the PPAC data shows.,Energy imports are a major component of India's overall imports, and any meaningful increase has ramifications for its trade balance, current account, inflation, and the rupee's exchange rate, among others. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Banks mobilise $17.4 billion via special FCNR(B) scheme

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 20

INDIAN BANKS have raised $17.40 billion from overseas after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) unveiled a special window allowing lenders to mobilise fresh three- to five-year Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) — FCNR(B) — deposits until September 2026, a move aimed at boosting capital inflows, shoring up the rupee and strengthening foreign exchange reserves.

The mobilisation came 42 days after the RBI operationalised the special scheme on June 8, 2026. With two months and ten days left for the closure of scheme, banks are expected to raise over $50 billion through the scheme. "The swap facility has seen avid interest and attracted steady forex inflows since June 8," the RBI said while releasing the figures as of July 17.

What banks mobilised

TYPE	AMOUNT *
FCNR(B) Deposits	17,406
OFCBs	1,970
ECBs	1,342
Total	**20,718**

* IN USD MILLION; SOURCE: RBI

The special FCNR(B) dispensation is aimed at strengthening the country's balance of payments and incentivising capital inflows, the RBI said. Following the outbreak of the West Asia conflict, the rupee depreciated and neared 97 per dollar, while foreign investors pulled out funds from the market amid a surge in crude oil prices. The RBI used its forex reserves to prevent a sharper decline in the rupee's value. On Monday, the rupee closed 17 paise down at 96.45 against the dollar.

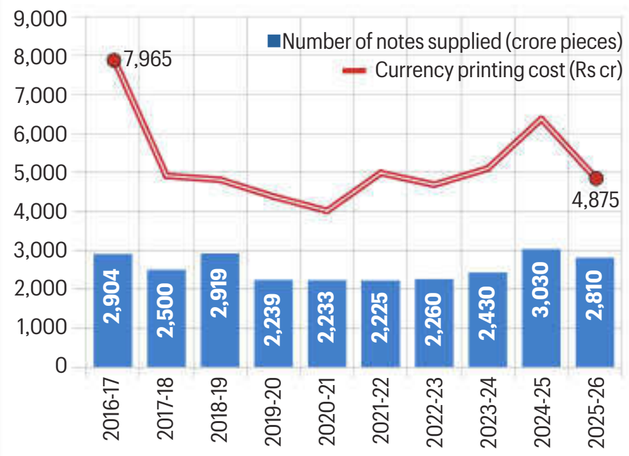
The central bank has permitted banks to swap these deposits with the RBI at a concessional rate, effectively covering the entire hedging cost. By absorbing the hedging burden, the RBI has made FCNR(B) deposits a more attractive source of overseas funding for lenders.

Experts believe the steps announced may attract an additional $50 billion to $70 billion in foreign capital into Indian markets with banks offering higher interest rates of around 7% after considering the hedging sops.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Plastic notes should lower RBI's printing costs

The Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Ltd (BRBNMPL), a wholly-owned subsidiary of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), last week floated a tender for polymer sheets that will be used for a trial project that will see the Indian central banks issue plastic notes for the first time.



- Plastic notes have several benefits over paper currency. For one, they can last 2-6 times longer than a paper note. Not only does this lower the environmental impact of making notes, but also means fewer notes have to be printed in the long run.
- The cost of printing currency is substantial. Over the last decade, the RBI has spent Rs 52,095 crore in total to print nearly 26,000 crore pieces of notes.
- The RBI's currency printing costs had hit an all-time high of Rs 7,965 crore in 2016-17, the year the government had demonetised high-denomination notes.

SOURCE: RBI

No proposal to scrap LTCG tax on equities

New Delhi: The finance ministry told the parliament Monday that there is no proposal to scrap long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax on equities for domestic investors, despite recently easing tax rules for some foreign portfolio investors in government debt.

The clarification follows a decision last month to exempt FPIs from LTCG tax on investments in government securities. FPIs have sold about $28.03 billion worth of Indian equities so far in 2026, with elevated crude prices and rupee's slide to record lows weighing on sentiment. REUTERS

BRIEFLY

Centre releases Rs 44.5k cr capex loans to states

New Delhi: The Centre's interest-free capital expenditure (capex) loans to states reached Rs 44,544 crore till July 15 of the current financial year, nearly 50% more than in the year-ago period, according to the latest data. Under the FY27 capex loan scheme, the Centre has budgeted Rs 2 lakh crore for states. The funds will support infrastructure spending, state capex growth and critical projects including railways, highways, metro rail, power and water supply schemes. FE

Rupee slumps to 2-mth low on oil price concerns

Mumbai: The Indian rupee declined to its weakest level in two months on Monday, as oil prices swayed near $90 per barrel amid the West Asia conflict, with markets acutely sensitive to signs of diplomatic efforts to end hostilities. The rupee's fall could have been steeper if not for dollar-selling intervention by the Reserve Bank of India, via state-run banks, traders said. The intervention helped the rupee close out the session at 96.4450 per dollar, down nearly 0.2% from its previous close. REUTERS

HDFC Bank CEO reappointment delayed

Mumbai: HDFC Bank is awaiting the outcome of an additional review being conducted by its independent directors before it makes a recommendation to reappoint its CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan to the RBI, three sources told *Reuters*. HDFC has faced investor scrutiny since mid-March when its former chairman Atanu Chakraborty resigned saying practices at the bank were not in line with his "personal ethics". An external legal review completed last month found no evidence to substantiate the governance concerns he raised. REUTERS

India has growth capacity of 8-9%, says ex-CEA

New Delhi: India can unlock 8-9% economic growth by accelerating structural reforms to reduce the cost of doing business and the cost of financing, former Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) Krishnamurthy V Subramanian said on Monday. He called for implementing factor market reforms in land, labour, and capital, as well as judicial and bureaucratic reforms. "Macroeconomic stability got India to 7% growth. Institutional reforms can take India to 9%," Subramanian told *PTI* in an interview. PTI

New series: Jun core sector growth 5%, iron ore output jumps 44%

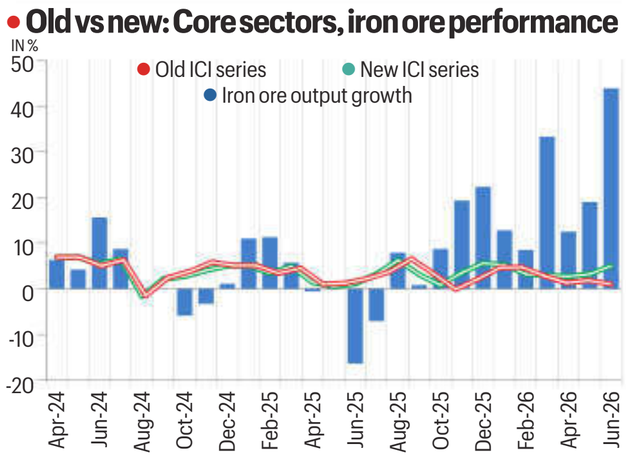
Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 20

THE COMMERCE ministry's revised Index of Core Industries (ICI) surged to a five-month high of 5% in June. The inclusion of iron ore as the ninth sector was instrumental as its output was 43.9% higher compared to June 2025, according to data released Monday, with a low base effect responsible for this outsized rate of growth.

The new core sector data series — which has 2022-23 as the base year as against 2011-12 in the old one — continues the government's overhaul of India's official statistics. So far in 2026, the statistics and commerce ministries have already released updated data series for GDP, Consumer Price Index, Index of Industrial Production, Wholesale Price Index as well as the inaugural Output Producer Price Index and trial numbers for input PPI and an Index of Services Production. The new data series downgrades core sector growth in 2024-25 sharply to 4.3% from 6.9%. However, it has upgraded the figure for 2025-26 to 3% from 1.1%.

While iron ore only makes up 4.9% of the new Index of Core Industries, the 43.9% jump in its production in June was key to the entire core sector output rising the most in five months. The growth for May has been revised higher to 3.2% in the new series from a 1% under the old series.

Old vs new: Core sectors, iron ore performance



NOTE: NEW INDEX OF CORE INDUSTRIES GROWTH DATA STARTS FROM APRIL 2024; IRON ORE IS NEW ADDITION TO CORE SECTOR DATA; **SOURCE** COMMERCE MINISTRY

Iron ore, whose output is estimated to have risen by 19% in May, has been added to the index due to its extensive industry use and significant contribution to industrial development. The other eight sectors part of the ICI are coal, crude oil, natural gas, refinery products, fertilisers, steel, cement, and electricity.

Some of the other key changes in the revised core sector data include the use of gross production data for compiling the steel index, the coal index including only 'raw coal' and not coal middlings and washed coal to eliminate double counting, among others.

Apart from iron ore, core sector growth in June was driven by a 9.8% rise in electricity generation, with the high temperatures and rainfall deficit boosting demand for power. The same sub-par monsoon helped raise coal output by 1.4% after three consecutive months of decline.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

No decision yet on increasing ethanol blending in petrol: Govt

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, July 20

AMID THE backlash on ethanol-blended petrol, the government on Monday informed Parliament that no decision has been taken on raising blending levels beyond the current 20%, and any decision to raise the blending levels will be taken only after detailed studies and stakeholder consultations. There is also no plan to make lower ethanol-petrol blends and pure petrol available at fuel stations.

"So far, no decision has been taken by the Government for increasing ethanol blending with petrol beyond 20%. Any future decision regarding higher ethanol blends will be taken only after detailed scientific and technical studies and consultations with all relevant stakeholders, including automobile manufacturers, Oil Marketing Companies and research institutions," Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi informed Rajya Sabha.

India achieved 20% ethanol blending in petrol last year and at present, the E20 fuel — 80 parts petrol and 20 parts ethanol — is the standard petrol variant across the country. There has been a public backlash over the E20 fuel, with claims ranging from notable reduction in mileage and engine component wear and tear in older vehicles whose engines were not designed for higher ethanol blends.

India achieved 20% ethanol blend in petrol last year. REUTERS

Gopi said that while the E20 fuel can reduce fuel economy by 3-5% in older vehicles whose engines are not designed for this blend, it is cleaner and superior in other performance parameters vis-a-vis pure petrol and lower ethanol-petrol blends.

"With regard to efficiency, studies indicate that fuel economy depends on several factors, including driving conditions, driving habits and vehicle maintenance. Mileage depends on driving habits, tyre pressure, servicing and AC load far more than fuel type. Any reduction in fuel economy in certain older E10-designed vehicles is generally limited to about 3-5%,while E20 offers a higher octane rating, superior anti-knock characteristics, cleaner combustion and smoother engine operation," the minister said.

On its part, the government has been attempting to allay fears, saying that the drop in mileage in older vehicles would be marginal, and would be outweighed by the benefits like higher octane rating, superior anti-knock characteristics, faster combustion, better pickup, smoother acceleration and cleaner engine operation. The government has also consistently rejected claims that E20 fuel could damage engine components. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▲
77,708.52	24,238.50	₹1,42,254	₹96.45
-442.93	-95.80	Silver ▲	Oil ▲
-0.77%	-0.39%	₹2,19,575	$83.06

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 17, 2026

CENTRAL INSTITUTE OF ROAD TRANSPORT

P.B. No 1897, Bhosari, Pune-26. Ph: 020-67345300, www.cirtindia.com

TENDER NOTICE

Tender is invited for Automation of Driving Test Track at Kolkata, Behala.

Tender Last Date submission: 14/08/2026.

Visit website **https://www.cirtindia.com** to download the Tender document.

ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL

SADAR BAZAR ROAD, DELHI CANTT-110010
www.apsdelhicantt.com

TENDER NOTICE

All persons/vendors/parties are invited along with e-certificate for registration. The unserviceable items/stores of APS, Delhi Cantt will be auctioned on 05 Aug 2026 at 1000 Hrs. Desired person/vendor/party are requested to be present at APS, Delhi Cantt. Items to be auctioned- Iron scrap, Computer items, Dessert coolers, Electronic equipment, Plastic scrap, Furniture etc. For any queries contact APS Delhi Cantt on 25693777, 25692720

Presiding Officer

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY AP SOCIAL WELFARE RESIDENTIAL EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS SOCIETY

D.No. 12-467-9, Moksha Sai Plaza, Service Road, Tadepalli, Guntur District-522 501

e-Procurement Tender

NIT No.18 to 21/APSWRE/Tech/2766307/2026, Dated.20.07.2026

Tenders are invited through e-Procurement from eligible registered companies/firms for the following Goods and Services to the Dr.B.R.Ambedkar Gurukulams in AP for AY-2026-27:

i) Supply of **Mattresses to the boarders** with an ECV of **Rs. 12.92Crores**. ii) Supply and delivery of **Kitchen Utensils** with an ECV of **Rs. 1.80 Crores**. iii) RFP for **Providing Cooking Services** with an ECV of **Rs. 3.44Crores**. iv) Supply and delivery of **Peanut and Millet Chikki** (50% each), made with Jaggery, with an ECV of **Rs.11.01Crores**.

The tender schedule, including the commencement of downloading of bid documents from 23.07.2026 and the bid submission closing date, is available on the Andhra Pradesh e-Procurement Portal. Further details may be viewed: **https://tenders.apeprocurement.gov.in**

For any clarification, contact: 0863-2347445 Note: Any corrigendum, addendum, or amendments to the tender, if issued, shall be published only on the Andhra Pradesh e-Procurement Portal. Bidders are advised to visit the portal regularly for updates.

R.O. No. 5263PP/Dt: 20.07.2026 Sd/- **SECRETARY, APSWREIS, Tadepalli**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Md. Safid @ Amjal, S/o Md. Mustafa R/o H-79, Naveen Vihar, Begampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.15674/2018 u/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Safid @ Amjal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Safid @ Amjal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Safid @ Amjal** of **FIR No.15674/2018 u/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.09.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Court No.114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9812/ON/2026

GOVT. OF N.C.T. OF DELHI
DEPARTMENT OF FOREST & WILDLIFE
OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS
WEST FOREST DIVISION, MANDIR LANE, NEW DELHI-60

E-Mail:- dcfwest.gnctd@gov.in

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

An e tender has been invited for **"Maintenance of City Forests Nasirpur, Mitraon Pkt A and Mitraon Pkt B for the duration of 01 year under West Forest Division, Department of Forest and Wildlife, GNCTD, Mandir Lane, New Delhi-110060 (Tender Id 2026_DYCFW_295476_1)"** In case the tenderer/Bidder has any doubt about the meaning of anything contained in the tender document, he shall seek clarification from the office of the Dy. Conservator of Forests, West Forest Division, Deptt. of Forest & Wildlife, GNCT of Delhi, Mandir Lane, Delhi-110060.

The tentative cost of the tendered work is estimated as be is **Rs. 88,81,053/- Rupees Eighty-Eight Lakhs Eighty-One Thousand and Fifty-Three Only).** The details of submission of bid are as follows:

Date of release of Tender through e-procurement portal of Delhi Govt	16.07.2026 at 06:00 PM
Start date/ time for downloading of tender	16.07.2026 at 06:00 PM
Start date/time for submission/ uploading the tender documents	16.07.2026 at 06:00 PM
Last date/time for submission/uploading the tender documents	24.07.2026 at 10:00 AM
Date and time of opening of Technical Bid	24.07.2026 at 11:00 AM
Date and time of opening of Financial Bid	Will be intimated

The last date of submission of bids is **24.07.2026** up to **10:00 AM**. For any further query, contact the O/o Dy. Conservator of Forests, West Forest Division at Mandir Lane, Delhi-110060.

Website link - **https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in/**

Sd/-
DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS
WEST FOREST DIVISION

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0149/26-27

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL GOHANA	HIRING OF TWO SEPTIC TANK SUCKER MACHINE WITH TRACTOR IN MC GOHANA.	16.07.2026 22.07.2026	NA	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01263252013 eo-gohana@ulbharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 47332/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP. /AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	NIT NO.04/CWG/HVPNL/2026-27 DATED 14.05.2026-HEW TENDER REF. NO. 2026984ADDD6 E6F4 4933 B5A9 FB7A9E78C2B8987HVP-(ONLINE TENDER ID 2026_HBC_521586_1)	"CORRIGENDUM NO. 06, THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 27.07.2026 (13.00 HRS) FOR L&C SOCIETIES & CONTRACTOR"	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 47329/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	SUPPLY OF MINERAL SALTS FOR MINERAL MIXTURE	20.07.2026 10.08.2026	AS PER DNIT	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 47342/HRY

RAJASTHAN MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.

Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India, Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064, Website: www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in, CIN : U24232RJ2011SGCO35067, E-mail : edpssrmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref No. :- F.02 (449)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-11/2026-27/4683 **Dated :- 16/07/2026**

Notice Inviting E-Bids

S. No.	Item Name/ Description	Ref. No.	UBN	Estimated Value Rs. in Crore	Last Time & Last date for bid submission
1	Drugs	Ref. No.: F.02 (449)/RMSCL/ Procurement/Drug/NIB-11/ 2026-27/4636 Dated : 15.07.2026	MSC2627GLOB00041	48.81 Crore	17.08.2026 up to 06.00 pm

Raj.Samwad/C/26/7214 **Director (Procurement)**

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (APCRDA)

Rayapudi, Thullur Mandal, Amaravati-522237 (A.P.)

NIT No. 05/A-12024/1/2026-AC-II/2nd call Dt: 20/07/2026

E PROCUREMENT SHORT TENDER NOTICE (SECOND CALL)

Name of Work: APCRDA - "RFP for Selection of Agency for Providing Strategic Resource Augmentation and Knowledge Support Services to APCRDA on Requirement Basis".

The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **21.07.2026 to 29.07.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.** Due date for submission of Bid is **29.07.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs,** Technical bid opening **29.07.2026 @ 16.00 Hrs.** For further details Please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.crda.ap.gov.in.**

Sd/- Addl. Commissioner, APCRDA, Amaravati

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE NO. 11/2026 Dated : 16.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. DSTE/North Central Railway, Agra acting for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through Online only (E-Tendering) for the following work:

E-TENDER NO. : AGRA-ST-2026-25	Approx. Cost of work. : Rs. 2,69,29,119.36

Name of work : Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract of Frauscher Make Multi Section Digital Axle Counters Jamuna Bridge-Tundla Section & Idgah-Bayana section of Agra Division for a period of 03 year.s

Tender closing date : 10.08.2026

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway Website **www.ireps.gov.in.** Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids through web portal **www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs** on above mentioned date. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **1645/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking

(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)

TENDER NOTICE

E-tender is invited for the supply of following item.

(1) 81960 - Triennial Rate Contract for Outsourcing of Repairing of Underground LV Cable Faults in the area of Electric Supply Distribution of the BEST Undertaking Mumbai.

Note: For more details, log on to website **https://mahatenders.gov.in**

PRO/AAM(M)/47/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/
(84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Hirdesh S/o Narender Kumar R/o 5/747 Main Road Burari Outer Distt Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 131/2019, U/s 323/341/506 IPC at PS: Kalyanpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Hirdesh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Hirdesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Hirdesh of FIR No.131/2019, U/s 323/341/506 IPC of PS: Kalyanpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 16.09.2026.**

By order
Prigya Gupta
Chief Judicial Magistrate
East District Court No.29
Karkardooma Courts Delhi

DP/9864/ED/2026

CENTRUM HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

peoplehome

Registered Office :
Unit No.301, Third Floor, Harbhajan Commercial Premises Co-operative Society Ltd., CST Road, Opp. BPCL Petrol Pump, Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai - 400098.
CIN: U65922MH2016PLC273826

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of **Centrum Housing Finance Ltd** under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower/s (the said Borrower), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s issued to them that are also given below. In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to **Centrum Housing Finance Ltd,** within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest and other charges till date of repayment of the dues in full. as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to **Centrum Housing Finance Ltd** by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Loan Account No./ Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	NPA Date / Sec.13(2) Notice Date / FCL Date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1	**MTCMT24016871 / Amit Kumar / Sony Goyal**	**Rs. 8,19,435.00 (Rupees Eight Lakh Nineteen Thousand Four Hundred Thirty Five Only)**	08-06-2026 07-07-2026 03-07-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Residential House within Kh. No. 650, adm. 100.33 sqmts., Village- Bangadpur (Out From Nagar Palika), Pargana & Tehsil- Garhmukteshwar, Distt.-Hapur-245205, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : 4 ft. wide ali & House of Kushal Pal West : 4ft. wide Gali thereafter House of Chiku North : 12 ft. wide Rasta South : plot of Yogesh
2	**MTCMT24019830 / Geeta Devi / Ashok Kumar**	**Rs. 9,28,292.00 (Rupees Nine Lakh Twenty Eight Thousand Two Hundred Ninety Two Only)**	08-06-2026 29-06-2026 25-06-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Khasra No. 478 Mid, adm. 557.41 sqmts.,Village-Chitwana Sherpur, Pargana Kithor, Tehsil-Mawana, Distt.-Meerut-250406, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o Sunil West : H/o Dhup Singh North : H/o Prem Singh South : Rasta 14ft wide
3	**MTCSR23014042 / Virender Kumar / Gurmail Kaur/ Mahindra Singh**	**Rs. 9,59,827.00 (Rupees Nine Lakh Fifty Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Twenty Seven Only)**	03-06-2026 14-07-2026 03-07-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Khasra No. 550 (P), Khata No. 105, adm. 273 sqmts., Wake Gram- Pakhanpur, Pargana -Gangoh, Tehsil- Nakur, Distt. Saharanpur-247341, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : Khet Satyapal West : Khet Sandeep North : Remaining Part of Kh. No. 550 South : Rasta
4	**AGRMH24017164 / Suraj Singh / Saroj Devi/ Dayashankar Singh**	**Rs. 4,68,186.00 (Rupees Four Lakh Sixty Eight Thousand One Hundred Eighty Six Only)**	08-06-2026 08-07-2026 08-07-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing House bearing Western Part of Plot No. 15, Part of Kh. No. 179Mi, adm. 83.61 sqmts., Radhey Shyam Colony, Mauza- Jaisinghpura Bangar, Tehsil & Distt. Mathura-281001, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : Part of Plot No.15 West : Plot No.14 North :Road 15ft wide South : Plot No.2
5	**MTCMR22008764 / Santosh Kumar / Om Prakash Sharma/Gomti Devi**	**Rs. 9,93,224.00 (Rupees Nine Lakh Ninety Three Thousand Two Hundred Twenty Four Only)**	08-06-2026 08-07-2026 08-07-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing House situated at Mauza Barari, adm. 150.49 sqmts., Pargana, Tehsil & Distt. Mathura-281005, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o Kishanlal West :H/o Banwarilal North :H/o Kanhiya & Pooran Devi South : Exit of Land

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to **Centrum Housing Finance Ltd** as aforesaid, **Centrum Housing Finance Ltd** shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of **Centrum Housing Finance Ltd.** Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Place : Uttar Pradesh Date : 21.07.2026 **Sd/-, Authorised Officer For Centrum Housing Finance Ltd**

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, N.W.Rly. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works up to 15:00 Hrs on 14/08/2026 as below:- **S.N.: 1. Tender No.:** 06R-2026-GSU-BKN, **Name of Work with its Location:** Civil work in C/W Augmentation of Coaching Maintenance Facilities at Lalgarh (Phase-II). **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 822082358.67. **Bid Security Amount (in Rs.):** Rs. 16441700.00. **Date and Time for submission of tender & opening of tender:** Bidding start date on 31/07/2026 & Tender closing Date & time up to 15:00 Hrs on 14/08/2026. **Note-** Other terms & conditions will be shown on the website **www.ireps.gov.in.** **1041-MG/26**

Follow us on: /NWRailways /NWRailways_

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, गिरिडीह
e-Mail – eercdgiridih-jhr@nic.in

शुद्धि पत्र

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि पी0 आर0 संख्या 383750 पथ (2026–27) एवं निविदा आमंत्रण सुचना सं0 RCD/GIRIDIH/698/2026-27 द्वारा प्रकाशित Construction of High Level Bridge over Basokando River at Ch. 15.562 Km. of K.B More to Tiranga Chowk (Nourango) (Including Approach Road) Road under Road Division, Giridih For The Year 2026-27 हेतु आमंत्रित निविदा को अपरिहार्य कारणवश रद्द किया जाता है।

ह0/–
कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, गिरिडीह

PR 385358 Road (26-27)_D

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	HIRING OF VEHICLE FOR TRANSPORTATION OF SFSMP TO GOVT. SCHOOLS IN BLOCKS OF ROHTAK, SONIPAT, JHAJJAR, REWARI DISTRICTS	20.07.2026 27.07.2026	AS PER DNIT	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 47331/HRY

Govt. of Jharkhand

Office of the Director, Ranchi Institute of Neuro-Psychiatry & Allied Sciences
Kanke, Ranchi – 834006 (Ph.:2450303, 2450813, 2450188)
https://rinpas.jharkhand.gov.in,,
Director-rinpas@jharkhandmail.gov.in & Directorrinpas@gmail.com

E-tender notice No **DIR/07/07/2026-2027/Medicine at RINPAS, Kanke, Ranchi** are invited in two bid system (Technical & Price Bid) through e-tendring process only from competent and eligibel agencies, for a period of minimum one year.

Date on publication on website	**22/07/2026, 11.00 A.M.**
Pre bid	**25/07/2026, 11.30 A.M.**
Date of start of Online Bid Submission	**28/07/2026, 11.30 A.M.**
Last Date and time for submission of Bids	**11/08/2026, 17.00 P.M.**
Opening of bidding	**13/08/2026, 12.30 P.M.**

Note:- For further details, please visit website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Letter no. **1830** date **18/07/2026**

Sd/-
Director,
RINPAS, Kanke, Ranchi

PR 385328 RINPAS(26-27).D

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD DIVISION KHERWARA (UDAIPUR)

File No. 301 **Date: 13/07/2026**

Notice Inviting Bid

Bids for Nit No 05/2026-27, (DMFT and TAD Scheme Road work for F.Y 2026-27 on various Roads) 02 Nos. are invited from interested bidders upto Date 03.08.2026, 11.00 A.M. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the state. and departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 418.36 Lacs.

NIB-PWD2627A1634

UBN NO. - PWD2627WSOB06916, PWD2627WSOB06917

Sd/-
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PWD DIVISION KHERWARA

DIPR/C/12537/2026

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

NOTICE
INVITATION OF EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR COACH REFURBISHMENT WORKS

Notice No: MIBW-2026-19-06-09/EOI **dt. 16.07.2026**

Motibagh Workshop, SECR invites Expressions of Interest (EOI) from competent, experienced, and financially sound firms located in and around Nagpur to undertake comprehensive coach refurbishment works.

The primary objective of this EOI is to identify qualified local agencies capable of upgrading, restoring, and refurbishing railway Inspection carriages. The scope of work shall broadly include, but is not limited to:

- Interior Panelling Works, Carpentry & Furnishing, Plumbing & Toilet Upgrades and Electrical Fitting Works.

Interested firms' primary workshop, manufacturing unit, or registered office should preferably be located within Nagpur or surrounding districts (within a radius of 100 km. from Nagpur city center).

Last Date for Submission	**01.08.2026**
Submission Mode	Hardcopy via Registered Post/Courier OR e-mail to: **dycme.mibw@gmail.com**
Address for Submission & Queries	Office of the Chief Workshop Manager, Motibagh Workshop, South East Central Railway, Near Kadbi Chowk, Kamptee Road, Nagpur – 440004

PAM/25/55 **Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, Moti Bagh Workshop/SECR/Nagpur**

South East Central Railway @secrail

GOVT. OF N.C.T. OF DELHI
DEPARTMENT OF FOREST & WILDLIFE
OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS
WEST FOREST DIVISION, MANDIR LANE, NEW DELHI-60

E-Mail:- defwest.gnetd@gov.in

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

An e tender has been invited for **"Maintenance of 30,297 numbers of plants at Najafgarh Range for 01 Year under West Forest Division (Tender Id 2026_DYCFW_295491_1)"** In case the tenderer/Bidder has any doubt about the meaning of anything contained in the tender document, he shall seek clarification from the office of the Dy. Conservator of Forests, West Forest Division, Deptt. of Forest & Wildlife, GNCT of Delhi, Mandir Lane, Delhi-110060.

The tentative cost of the tendered work is estimated as be is **Rs. 1,77,25,696/- (Rupees One Crore Seventy Seve Lakhs Twenty-Five Thousand Six Hundred and Ninety-Six Only) Rupees Eighty-Eight Lakhs Eighty-One Thousand and Fifty-Three Only).** The details of submission of bid are as follows:

Date of release of Tender through e-procurement portal of Delhi Govt	**17.07.2026 at 01:00 PM**
Start date/time for downloading of tender	**17.07.2026 at 01:00 PM**
Start date/time for submission/uploading the tender documents	**17.07.2026 at 01:00 PM**
Last date/time for submission/ uploading the tender documents	**24.07.2026 at 10:00 AM**
Date and time of opening of Technical Bid	**24.07.2026 at 11:00 AM**
Date and time of opening of Financial Bid	**Will be intimated**

The last date of submission of bids is 24.07.2026 up to 10:00 AM. For any further query, contact the O/o Dy. Conservator of Forests, West Forest Division at Mandir Lane, Delhi-110060.

Website link - **https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in/**

Sd/-
DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS
WEST FOREST DIVISION

DIP/SHABDARTH/CLASSIFIED/0148/26-27

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, IC-59276 late Lt Hari Singh Bisht, Shaurya Chakra (P) of 3/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice while fighting with terrorist in Mendhar Sector on 21 July 1999. He boldly led his Ghatak Team and eliminated two hard core terrorist. His raw courage volour and martyrdom will remain a source inspiration for all of us.

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

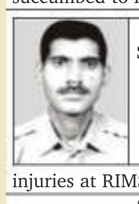
BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HEAD CONSTABLE PREM SINGH 28 BN BSF 03.02.1945 – 21.07.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Prem Singh on his Balidan Diwas.On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Sri Hargobindpur area, Punjab and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CONSTABLE SUDESH KUMAR 33 BN BSF 27.03.1971 – 21.07.1997

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Sudesh Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On 19th July 1997, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Bandipur area, J&K and later succumbed to his injuries at 92 base hospital on 21 July 1997.



CONSTABLE SATBIR SINGH 2 BN BSF 05.08.1967 – 21.07.2001

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Satbir Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Thoubal area, Manipur and later succumbed to his injuries at RIMS Imphal.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Constable Soma Sundaram 18 Bn 6-5-1963 To 21-7-1990

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Soma Sundaram of 18 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during a cordon and search operation in Ferozepur district, Punjab on 21 July 1990. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Deen Mohd. 124 Bn 1-6-1969 To 21-7-2001

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Deen Mohd. of 124 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 21 July 2001 after sustaining grievous injuries while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Tirap district, Arunachal Pradesh on 12 July 2001. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

RIFLEMAN JAYADRATH SINGH

On 21 Jul 2017, Rifleman Jayadrath Singh made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty and attained martyrdom while serving at Line of Control in Akhnoor Sector (J&K) in 'Operation Rakshak'. We bow our heads in reverence of the martyred soldier. He, in the true traditions of the 2nd Battalion the Rajputana Rifles, made the supreme sacrifice for the motherland. It is because of soldiers like him, that today every member of the 2nd Battalion the Rajputana Rifles holds his head high.

'MAY THE ALMIGHTY CONFER EVERLASTING PEACE TO YOUR NOBLE SOUL'
REMEMBERED AND REVERED BY COMMANDING OFFICER AND ALL RANKS
2nd BATTALION THE RAJPUTANA RIFLES (EVER VICTORIOUS)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No. DRM/C/AGRA/MPP/ENQUIRY TENDER/2026 **Date : 16.07.2026**

Gem Bid Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites GeM Bid Number : GEM/2026/B/7795849, Date :- 16.07.2026 as per details given as under:

GeM Bid Number : GEM/2026/B/7795849, Date : 16.07.2026

GeM Bid Details : Custom Bid for Services - Contract for Manning of Enquiry, Passenger Information & Rail Madad Counters at 08 Stations over Agra Division for 1095 Days.

GeM Bid End Date and Time :	GeM Bid Opening Date and Time :
Date : 06.08.2026 Time : 20:00	Date : 06.08.2026 Time : 20:30

Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit GeM Portal website **(https://gem.gov.in).** The above mentioned GeM Bid details are available therein under the above mentioned GeM Bid Number. **1653/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

TATA POWER

THE TATA POWER COMPANY LIMITED

Regd. Office: Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: 91 22 6665 8282, **CIN:** L28920MH1919PLC000567
Email: investorcomplaints@tatapower.com **Website:** www.tatapower.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

NOTICE is hereby given that the certificate(s) for the undermentioned securities of the Company has / have been lost / misplaced and the holder(s) of the said securities/ applicant(s) has / have applied to the Company to issue duplicate certificate(s).

Any person who has a claim in respect of the said securities should lodge such claim with the Company at its Registered Office within 15 days from this date, else the Company will proceed to issue duplicate certificate(s) without further intimation.

Sr. no.	Folio No.	Name of Shareholder(s)	Kind of securities and face value	No. of securities	Distinctive Number(s)
1.	H5P0013727	Puspa Silla	Equity Shares of ₹1/- each	4,200	16178641-16182840

For **The Tata Power Company Limited**

Sd/-
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary
FCS 7021

Place: Mumbai
Dated: July 20, 2026

BIHAR SCHOOL EXAMINATION BOARD

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender Notice No. : PR 161/2026

Bihar School Examination Board, Patna invites e-tenders under two bid systems from the reputed Manufacturers/ Suppliers/ Firms /Companies/ Agencies/ Societies for **"Supply of Packing Materials i.e., Envelope, Corrugated Box with Variable Printed Adhesive Stickers and Poly Bag (LDPE) for Intermediate & Secondary Examination, 2027 (Annual/ Compartmental) and other Examinations."** Detailed tender document containing eligibility criteria, other terms and conditions are available on the website **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** and **https://biharboardonline.bihar.gov.in**

Tender Schedule

Date and Time for Activity	Date/Time: Duration
Online Sale/ Download Date of Tender Documents	**From: 21/07/2026 (16:00 Hrs.) to 11/08/2026 (16:00 Hrs.)** (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Pre-Bid Meeting	**27/07/2026 at 12:30 Hrs.** (Bihar School Examination Board, Sinha Library Road, Patna-800017)
Last Date/ Time for Submission/ uploading of Online Bid	**11/08/2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.** (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Last Date and Time for Submission of EMD (Only in case of BG) / Samples	**12/08/2026 at 13:00 Hrs.**
Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid	**12/08/2026 at 14:00 Hrs** (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Date & Time for Opening of Financial Bid	Date to be announced later by Competent Authority.
Cost of the Tender Document	**₹5,900/-** (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Tender Processing Fee	**₹5,900/-** (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Earnest Money	**₹1,00,000/-** (One Lakh Rupees only) (Refundable)

- Contact Details: **Nodal Officer, Mobile No.: +91 62999 23095, E-Mail ID: eproc-bseb-bih@gov.in/ eproc.bseb@gmail.com**
- **Note:** Bihar School Examination Board reserves the right to accept/ cancel/ reschedule tenders without assigning any reasons. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in.** Corrigendum/ Amendments etc., if any, will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.

Secretary

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Zabun Nisa,W/o.Khursheed Ahmed,r/o.2487,Bazar Chitli Qabar Jama-Masjid DELHI-110006,have changed my name to Zaibun Nisa,for all purpose. 0040867065-7

I, Usha D/O Sardar Singh R/O Flat No.95, Jamna Apartment, Sector-9, Rohini, Delhi-110085, inform that Usha and Usha Saroha both the names are one and same person. 0040867091-3

I,Esha Chadha,D/O Ramzan Chapri,R/O N-19B,Jangpura Extension,Jangpura,South Delhi,Delhi-110014,Have Changed my Name to Esha Chapri. 0040867095-3

I,Seema Khan,D/O Mukhter Ahmed Khan R/O H.No.P-16, A-4,Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095, inform that Seema and Seema Khan both the names are one and Same person. 0040867067-6

I, Shehla Saba, W/o Mohd Khurram, R/o 672, 3rd Floor, Gali Mem Wali, Chitli Qabar, Jama Masjid, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Shehla, for all future purposes. 0040866952-1

I,MOH EBRAHIM RAYEEN alia MOHAMMAD IBRAHIM,s/o NAWAB ALI r/o F-10/2,Shaheed-Nagar,Chikamberpur,Sahibaba d,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201006,has changed my name to MOHAMMAD EBRAHIM permanently,for all,future purpose. 0040867075-7

I Veena Devi W/o Amarnath R/o U - 1/16, Phase - 1, Budh Vihar, Sultanpuri C Block, North West Delhi, Delhi - 110086, have changed my name to Veena Rani 0071048803-1

YAG PARKASH , R/o 2780 JAWAHAR COLONY NIT FARIDABAD HARYANA Changed my name as YAG PRAKASH SHARMA S/o SOHAN LAL 0130067031-1

I,Sunil Kumar,S/O-Kishan Lal Juneja,R/O H,No-113-A,Gali No-5,South Anarkali Krishna-Nagar,Delhi-110051,Have Changed My Name To Sunil Kumar Juneja Permanently. 0040867065-9

I,VIJAYANTI NARANG,D/O-THAKUR DASS DEASTHA R/O-A-1304 ANTRIKSH KANBALL SECTOR-77,NOIDA GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH-201301,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM VIJAYANTI NARANG TO HAZEL,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040867095-5

I, Priyanka Kumari D/o. Jaskaran Singh R/o. F-237 Sector-23 Sanjay Nagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Priyanka Singh for all purposes by an affidavit sworn before a Notary Public dated 18-07-2026. 0130067028-1

I Tamanna D/o Mukut Bihari Lal R/o V.P.O - Kakrana, District-Rohtak, Haryana-124412, have changed my name to Tamanna Vashisth for all purpose. 0090407290-1

I,NITIN SEHDEV,S/O-VIJAY PAL, R/O-OLIVE 1605, GULMOHAR RESIDENCY AHINSA-KHAND-2, INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-2010114,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME,FROM NITIN SEHDEV TO.NITIN V SAHDEV,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040867067-8

I, Ashu Verma D/O Mahesh Verma R/O H/N 327, 2nd floor (Gulmohar Residency) Ashoka Enclave Part 3 Sector-35 Faridabad Haryana-121003 Have changed my name to "Vishakha Verma" for all purposes. 0040866945-1

I,ABINDER KUMAR PRAJAPATI,S/O-NANHE RAM,R/O-60, 1ST FLOOR, BLOCK-B, POCKET-11,SECTOR-23 ROHINI, DELHI-110085,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AVINDER KUMAR 0040867075-9

I Asgari W/o Sh. Md. Shamshad R/o Jhuggi No.726, Block F-6/H.G.I. Labour Colony, Sultanpuri, Delhi-86,have changed my name to Asgari Khatoon for all future purposes. That Asgari and Asgari Khatoon is the one and same person. 0040866970-1

I, Mahesh Kumar Virmani S/o Sushil Kumar Virmani R/o Flat-403, B-19, Nirala Aspire Low Rise, Sector-16B, Greater Noida West, UP-201308, have changed my name to MAHESH VIRMANI for all future purposes. 0071048839-1

I,MUNAWAR AHSAN MALICK, S/o-Sarfaraz Ahsan Malik,R/o-A-51,First Floor,Joshi-Colony,IP Extension,East Delhi-110092, have changed my name,from MUNAWAR AHSAN MALICK to MONOWAR AHSAN MALIK,for all,future purposes. 0040867065-2

I, Mahin Atique, W/o Mohd Muaaz Khan, R/o 3018, Kucha Neel Kanth, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Mahin Khan, permanently. 0040867067-1

I, Sabir S/O Mohd. Bundu Salmani R/O H.No. F-171, Street No.7, Chand Bagh, Delhi-110094, have changed my name to Mohd. Sabir Salmani. 0040867091-4

I, Shaheen Chaudhary W/o Babuddin Khan Chaudhary R/o D-231/10, Vijay colony, New Usmanpur, Near Vijay Jyoti School, Delhi 110053, declare that my husband's name has been wrongly written as Babuddeen Khan Chaudhary in my Passport No.-Y8059965. The actual name of my husband is Babuddin Khan Chaudhary, which may be amended accordingly. 0071048838-1

I, SUDARSHAN KARWAR W/o No.6314685 RANK Ex NK HIRA LAL R/O RZ 265 F LOHIA MARG RAJ NAGAR -2 ,PALAM DELHI - 110077 have changed my name to SUDARSHAN KARWAL vide affidavit date 18-7-2026 before Delhi. 0071048784-1

I,Gauri Gupta,W/O-Mohit Kumar Gupta,R/O-72 Patti Hulasrai, Near-Bugrasi chauraha, Siyana, Bulandshahar,UP-245412,Have changed my name to Gavri Gupta,for all future,purposes. 0040867095-7

I, Mohammad Anas Khan, R/o M-90, 2nd Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, South-East Delhi 110025, Declare That Mohd Anas Khan & Mohammad Anas Khan is same person. My DOB 14.01.1997 Aadhaar 4667 4546 9828. 0130067029-1

I,MOON MOON DUTTA MAZUMDAR,wife of,Arun Dutta mazumdar presently,residing at,village-chaliha,gaon,P.O-chaliha,Dist-Jorhat,Assam-785004,have changed my name from MOON MOON DUTTA MAZUMDAR to MOON MOON SAIKIA,vide-Affidavit, date-08/07/2026. 0040867067-11

It is for general information that I, VISHAL RAGHAV S/O LATE VIRENDER SINGH RAGHAV, R/O L-2/74, L-2 BLOCK, SHASTRI NAGAR, PO: ASHOK VIHAR, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI-110052 declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as VIRENDER SINGH in my 10th and 12th Class educational documents. The actual name of my father is VIRENDER SINGH RAGHAV, which may be amended accordingly 0040866945-4

I,PRAKHARDEEPKARDAM,S/O ANIL KUMAR,R/O Null-591,Raispur, Ghaziabad,Kavi Nagar,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201002,have changed my name to PRAKHARDEEP KARDAM. 0040867065-4

I,Mahesh Singh,S/O Jeet Singh Rana R/o G-8/69, Sector-16,Rohini,Delhi-110089,have changed my name to Mahesh Singh Rana. 0040867067-3

I,ANUJA MITKARI W/O RITESH ASHOKRAO,R/O D-1404 WHITE LILY BY PARKER SECTOR-8 SONIPAT HARYANA-131001.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANUJA DESHBHUSHAN MITKARI. 0040867075-4

I, Himanshu S/o Krishna Kumar Tyagi R/o I-456, Greater Noida Beta-2, UP-201306, have changed my name to HIMANSHU TYAGI for all future purposes. 0071048789-1

My father's name in my 10th/12th school certificate is Rajesh Kapoor and in my other documents it is Rajesh Kumar. Inform that Rajesh Kapoor & Rajesh Kumar both are one & same Person Name. # Piyush Kapoor son of Shri Rajesh Kumar Residence of Plot No.105-A, Om Vihar Phase-3, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059. 0040866989-1

I,Sanjay Jain S/o Daya Chand Jain, R/o-710, First Floor, Sector-12,Friends Society,Vasundhra Ghaziabad,U.P-201012,have changed my name to Sanjay Kumar Jain. 0040867075-2

I, Ranjeet Singh Saroha S/O Rattan Singh Saroha R/O Flat No.95, Jamna Apartment, Sector-9, Rohini, Delhi-110085, inform that Ranjeet Singh Saroha and Ranjeet Saroha both the names are one and same person. 0040867091-2

I, Mitlesh W/o Ombir Singh R/o A-197,Sector -47,Noida-201301(Uttar Pradesh), have changed my name to Mithalesh. 0040867095-2

I Cholesh S/o Mukut Bihari Lal R/o V.P.O - Kakrana, District-Rohtak, Haryana-124412, have changed my name to Cholesh Vashisth for all purpose. 0090407292-1

I,VINOD KUMAR RATHORE S/O SH. SARDARI LAL R/o 1703,Royce Vaishali,Sector-3,Vaishali, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201010,have changed my name to VINOD KUMAR. 0040867067-5

I,Shreyanki Yadav,D/o-Mr.Surendra Yadav,R/o-Ghar No.1742,Yadav Bhavan, Teka-Naka,Kamptee-Road, Uppalwadi,Nagpur-City,Nagpur-440026, Maharashtra,hereby state that my name is incorrectly written as "Shreyanki Surendra" in my passport. My correct name is "Shreyanki Yadav" for all future purposes. 0040867075-6

I Amar Nath S/o Nandlal Makkar R/o U-1/16, Budh Vihar Phase-1, Sultanpuri C Block, Delhi - 110086, have changed my name to Amarnath Makkar 0071048800-1

I, Neha W/o Yogesh Kanwadia R/o Flat No. 246-A, 3rd Floor, Pocket-1, Paschim Puri, West Delhi -110063, have changed my name from Neha Kanwadia to Neha for all future purposes. 0040866954-1

I,Sadanand Thakur,S/O Sautari Thakur,R/o.FLAT No-222,2nd Floor, Hind Apartment,Block-A,Pcket-1B,Sector-A-1,A-4, Narela,Delhi-110040,have changed my name to Sadanand Prasad Thakur. 0040867065-8

I,Hema Mishra W/o-Amit Kumar R/o Plot-249,Ram Vihar-2,Chhapraula, G.B.Nagar, have changed my name Hema Dixit. 0040867067-2

I Km. Akanksha W/o Jitendra Singh R/o H.No-260/4,Sector-16B Vasundhra, Ghaziabad, U.P-201012 have changed my name to Akanksha singh. 0040867075-3

I, Karan Bisht, S/o Virender Singh, R/o RZH-253, Gali No.8, Raj Nagar-2, Palam Colony,Palam, New Delhi-110077, declare that name of my mother has been wrongly mention as Rama Singh in my 10th Class educational documents. The actual name of my mother is Rameela, which may be amended accordingly. 0040866947-1

I,NITIN V SAHDEV,R/O-C-902,SHIPRA NEO VAIBHAV-KHAND INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD UTTAR PRADESH-2010114,HAVE CHANGED-MINOR DAUGHTER'S NAME FROM RIANNA SEHDEV TO RAINA SEHDEV,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040867095-4

Sushma Bisht W/o Kuldeep Singh, R/o 79/1F B Block Baba colony Burari Delhi, Changed my name as Sushma. 0130067027-1

I,Megha Arora,D/O Ram Kumar Arora R/O C-232,First Floor,Jhilmil Colony, Delhi-110095,have changed my name to Megha. 0040867067-7

I,Kamal Chhabra S/o Balbir Chhabra,R/o-C-111,Surajmal Vihar,Delhi-110092,inform that my father name wrongly written in my passport as Balbir Chander Chhabra instead of Balbir Chhabra. 0040866953-1

I,SHABEENA BEGUM,w/o-MOHAMMAD EBRAHIM,r/o F-10/2,Shaheed Nagar, Chikamberpur,Sahibabad,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201006,has changed my name to SHABEENA, permanently,for all future purpose 0040867075-8

I,PRABHDEEP SINGH S/o SUKHDEV SINGH,R/o-FF-13,Ansal Chiranjeev Homes,Shastri-Nagar, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201002,have changed my minor daughter name AMBER to AMBER KAUR ROOP RAI. 0040867065-6

I,HIMAYUN,S/o-Akbar Ali,R/o-29,Masjid Wali Gali.No.-1, Chhajju-Gate, Babarpur, Shahdara,Delhi-110032,have changed my name,from HIMAYUN to HIMAYU CHAUHAN,for all future purposes. 0040867065-1

I,Radhika Amit Sachdeva,W/o Amit Sachdeva,resident of A-52,Near-A Block Park,Chander-Nagar, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201011,hereby declare that Radhika Sachdeva and Radhika Amit Sachdeva are one and the same person. Henceforth, both names may be treated as referring to me,for all official and legal purposes. 0040867065-10

I,ATISH GUPTA S/o-SURESH GUPTA R/o-PLOT NO.-8,3RD FLOOR,KH.NO.-497, EXTENDED LALDORA,SHAKTI ENCLAVE, BURARI,DELHI-110084,have changed my name to ATISH KUMAR GUPTA. 0040867075-1

I, Madhubala, wife of Ajay Kumar residing at E-1 sector-12, Noida-201301, District:Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P., do hereby declare that in the school records and ongoing CBSE registration forms for the Class-10E board examinations of my minor Son, Aditya Kark, a student of Class-10E at Modern School sector-11 Noida, my name has been wrongly recorded as Madhu Kumar. My correct and legal name is Madhubala. In future, I should be known and addressed as Madhubala. 0071048779-1

I,THIRUNELLAYI VAIDYANATHAN,S/O Rama Krishna Iyer,R/O-House No. 540,Group-3,Pkt-C-Janta Flats Hastsal,Uttam Nagar,Delhi-110059,have changed my name to T R VAIDYANATHAN 0040867095-6

I,PRIYA SHARMA,D/o SHRI.JAI KUMAR SHARMA,R/o-House No.C-244-A,Gali No.9,Ganga Vihar,Gokalpur,North East Delhi, Delhi-110094,inform that my,father name JAI KUMAR SHARMA and JAI KUMAR,both names are same person. 0040867067-9

I Jatin Kumar Gautam S/o Shri Ravinder Singh R/o GH-14, Flat No.1144, Near Haryana Sweet, Paschim Vihar, Sunder Vihar, New Delhi-110087 have changed my name to Jatin Gautam for all purposes. 0040866945-3

I,SANCHIT PRAJAPATI,S/O-AVINDER KUMAR,R/O-60, 1ST FLOOR,BLOCK-B, POCKET-11 SECTOR-23 ROHINI, DELHI-110085,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SANCHIT KUMAR 0040867075-10

I, Sandeep Tandon R/o Eh2/506,5th Floor, Gh-03, Sector:93a Eldeco Utopia, Noida Gautam Budh Nagar, Pin: 201301 Uttar Pradesh, India have changed my minor son's name from Hrythm Tandon to Hridaan Tandon. 0040866972-1

I,Navyanaveli Srivastava,D/o Sunil Kumar,R/o-Flat.No.KM-406,Amrapali Vilage,Nyay Khand-2,Indirapuram, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201014,Have Changed My Name to ANEKA SRIVASTAVA,for All Future Purposes. 0040867065-3

I, Mukesh Arora S/O Nand Kishore Arora residing at H.No.2888/A, Near Maniram Mandir, Bihari Colony, Bhola Nath Nagar, Shahdara East Delhi, Delhi-110032, hereby declare that Mukesh Arora and Mukesh Kumar Arora refer to the same person. Henceforth, I shall be known as Mukesh Arora for all official and future purposes. 0040867091-1

I, SHAFFINA W/O ABDUL WAHID R/O PLOT NO - 373, SHAHZADA BAGH, PHASE-1, INDERLOK, DELHI - 110035, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAFINA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071048788-1

I Usha Rani W/o Duli Chand R/o 180, Bhor Garh, North West Delhi, Delhi - 110040, have changed my name to Usha Devi 0071048809-1

I Santosh Kumari Goel D/o- Ram Bhaj Agarwal R/o- D-248, Prashant vihar, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Santosh Goel for all purposes. 0040866945-5

I, Gulshan Kumar S/o Vinay Singh R/o T -98,Farid puri,West Patel Nagar,New Delhi-110008, have changed my name to Gulshan. 0040867095-1

I,Golu,S/o Joginder lal,R/o-H.no b238,gali no-10,near-Krishna Jewellers-25 feeta-road sant-nagar burari,Delhi-110084, Have changed my name to Ravi kumar. 0040867065-5

I,VINOD RATHORE S/O SARDARI LAL,R/o 1703, Royce Vaishali, Sector-3, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201010,have changed my name to VINOD KUMAR. 0040867067-4

I,Ishu Rani W/O yogesh Singh house no-147,dda janta flats,pul pehladpur, Delhi-110044, have changed my name to ishu. permanently. 0040867075-5

I Widha Devi W/o Arun Prasad Singh R/o 130, Road- 3, Rajput Nagar, Hajipur, Vaishali, Bihar - 844101, have changed my name to Vidha Devi 0071048797-1

I, Ganga Wati D/O Suresh, R/o B-18/501, Jhuggi Indra Camp, Kalyan Puri, East Delhi -110091. have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as Siya Thakur. 0040867036-1

LOST & FOUND

I have lost Awas Vikash parishad Allotment letter and Possession letter of my flat No-4C/4229 Vasundhara Tehsil & Distt- Ghaziabad UP pin code :-201012.If any one found, please Contact-9560197400, Ramesh Meghraj Kalwani S/o Meghraj Chainmal Kalwani 0040867091-5

I Ruchika Malhotra D/o Late Sh. Satish Vasudeva would like to inform the general public that I have lost the original allotment letter, possession letter, possession certificate of Unit No.0202 Floor 02 Block 01 in Unitech located at Plot No. 9 Sector Pi-II Greater Noida UP 201310 issued by M/s Unitech Ltd. The use of these documents by any person or company will be illegal. I have registered an FIR dated 26.06.2026 bearing No.399492/2026 for all the lost original papers with respect to the above-mentioned property at New Friends Colony Police Station, District South East. Mobile No.9811234443 0040866945-6

I Harish Chandra Gupta, R/O H-9, G.S. Apt., Sec-13, Rohini, Delhi-85, lost IMT Ghaziabad Diploma-2024, Roll No. 23A2021487. FIR 454576/2026 0130067026-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

"My client **Sh. Sunil Jain** S/o Late Mitar Sain & Smt. Sadhana Jain W/ o Sh. Sunil Jain R/o H. No. 1/5251 3rd Floor Street No. 10, Balbir Nagar Near Jain Mandir Shahdara Delhi 110032 has break all the relation with their son **Sh. Abhay Jain @Tinu** and his wife **Smt. Avni Jain @ Riya** and their grandson namely as **Master Reyansh Jain** due to misbehavior, misconduct & out of control and disowned them from their movable and immovable properties. My client shall not be responsible for the any act of **Sh. Abhay Jain @ Tinu** and his wife **Smt. Avni Jain @ Riya** and their grandson namely as **Master Reyansh Jain** in any manner in future.

Sd/-
SURESH KUMAR
Advocate
Ch. No. C-34. C.L. Joseph Block
Tis Hazari Courts Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is declared in general public that my client Subhash S/o Balwant Singh, R/o 253, Bawana, Delhi disown/ debarred his Son Aman due to his irresponsible behavior and non fulfill his moral duties towards my client. My client dissolve all the relation & business with above named person. After this notice the above named person will lost all his right with the moveable and immovable properties of my client, if any person will have any dealing and concerned with him in any manner he/she will be responsible for the consequences of the same

Ram Pervesh (Advocate)
Off. No. 1, Opp. SDM Office, Naya Bans, Delhi-82
Ph.- 9711083095

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to General public that my client Harbans Kaur Thapar Wife of Late J. S. Thapar R/o S-393 Third Floor Greater Kailash Part-1 New Delhi-110048 has disowned and debarred her Son namely Gurpreet Singh Thapar and his Wife from severed her all relations and her all moveable, immoveable properties and also severed all her relations with them due being them disobedient and disloyal towards my client. My client shall not be responsible for any their acts deeds done by them anyone dealing with them shall be on their risk and consequences.

Firoz Ahmed (Advocate)
Chamber No 619, Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DISOWNMENT NOTICE

It is for information of general public that my client Shri Jagan Lal S/o Shri Lekh Raj R/o B-376, Jawahar Mohalla, Patparganj, Delhi-110091, has disowned/debar his son Shri Ajay Kumar S/o Shri Jagan Lal R/O 26/8, 26-Block Mini Market, Trilok Puri, Delhi-110091, from all his moveable and immoveable properties, as he is disobedience, misbehaving, having immoral attitude and out of control of my client, if anybody deals with him, shall do at his own risk and responsibility. My client and/or his family members shall not be held responsible for his acts, deeds, things, liabalities etc. etc.

PARMANAND (ADVOCATE)
Enrolment No.D-1729/2001

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that My client Mr. Satnam Singh S/O Bishamber Singh residents of K-442, Gali No.5, Kushak Road No.2, Swaroop Nagar, Libas Pur, Delhi-110042, do hereby declare that he has disowned and debarred his Son Navneet Singh daughter in law Harpreet Kaur & grandson Prabnoor Singh from all mova-ble and immovable properties due to their disrespectful behavior and out of control. All relations with them have been severed. Any dealings with their/ them will be at the risk, cost, and conse-quence of the parties involved. My client shall not be liable or responsible for any such dealings.

AMRENDRA NATH SHUKLA (ADVOCATE)
(Enrl.No.D-1819-E/04)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my client Sh. Naveen Nagpal S/o Sh. Kashi Ram Nagpal and Smt. Kiran Nagpal W/o Sh. Naveen Nagpal both R/o Block FF 51B, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092 disinherited their son Aman Nagpal from their all moveable and immoveable properties and severed all their relation from the said son Aman Nagpal and his wife Smt Simran Gupta for ever and any body dealing with them will be doing so at his/her own risks and consequences and my client shall not be liable for their acts and deeds.

Neeru (Advocate)
Ch. No.367, Saket Court New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that my client Ms. Manjot kaur w/o Sh. Kulvinder Singh D/o Joginder Singh resident of Flat No. 219B, DDA Green Flats, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi-110027 entered into agreement to buy property No. J-206A, Entire first floor, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi-110027 from Mr. Kamal Kumar Longani, owner of property.

Any person has any claim/objection with regard to sale transaction of the said property shall contact the buyer through her advocate telephonically or through email within 30 days from the notice.

Sd/-
(Manoj Tewari)
Advocate
CH. No. 133, Patiala House Court,
New Delhi-110001.

"IMPORTANT"

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PUBLIC NOTICE

HEREBY, IT IS INFORMED TO THE GENERAL PUBLIC AT LARGE THAT MY CLIENT LT. COL. KANWALJEET SINGH S/O LATE DR GURBACHAN SINGH R/O THIRD FLOOR OF H. NO. S-518, GREATER KAILASH-PART-I, SITUATED AT VILLAGE BAHAPUR, DELHI-110048. IS THE ABSOLUTE OWNER & IN LAWFUL POSSESSION OF THIRD FLOOR WITH ROOF RIGHTS OF RESIDENTIAL BUILT-UP **FREEHOLD** PROPERTY BEARING NO. 518, BLOCK-S, AREA MEASURING 500 SQ.YDS., IN THE RESIDENTIAL COLONY KNOWN AS GREATER KAILASH-I, SITUATED AT VILLAGE BAHAPUR, DELHI.

HEREBY IT IS INFORMED THAT IN THE CHAIN OF TITLE DEED ORIGINAL **WILL** DATED 08.05.1994, EXECUTED BY LT. COL. SH. BISHAN LAL RAINA S/O LATE SH. SURAJ NARAIN RAINA IN FAVOUR OF HIS WIFE NAMELY SMT. SARASWATI RAINA W/O SH. BISHAN LAL RAINA IN RESPECT OF BASEMENT FLOOR, GROUND FLOOR & TERRACE FLOOR OF ABOVESAID BUILT UP FREEHOLD PROPERTY HAVE BEEN LOST SOMEWHERE **BY MY CLIENT** AND SAME IS NOT TRACEABLE TILL DATE.

LOST INTIMATION HAS BEEN GIVEN BEFORE P.S. CRIME BRANCH DELHI.

HAVING S.O. NO. 430/2014 LR NO. 450486/2026 DATED 15.07.2026.

ON THE WEBSITE OF DELHI POLICE, BY MY CLIENT.

HERBY IT IS INFORMED TO THE PUBLIC THAT WE THE ABOVE NAMED OWNER OF THE ABOVESAID PROPERTY ENTERED INTO AN AGREEMENT TO SELL DATED 24-05-2026 WITH SH. DEEPAK GUPTA S/O BIJENDER KUMAR GUPTA & SMT. VANDANA GUPTA W/O SH. DEEPAK GUPTA AND THE BUYERS OFFERED FOR MORTGAGE THE ABOVSAID PROPERTY IN THEIR HOUSING LOAN TO BE AVAILED FROM PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK PLP-RAM NORTH PRASHANT VIHAR DELHI.

FOR MOST, FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE PUBLIC IT IS INFORMED, IF THE ABOVESAID ORIGINAL COPY OF WILL DATED 08.05.1994, IS USED OR MISUSED BY ANY OTHER PERSON IN ANY WAY, IT WILL BE AT THEIR OWN RESPONSIBILITY/ RISK.

IF IT IS FOUND IN CUSTODY OF ANYONE PLEASE HAND OVER TO THE CONCERN.

FOR MOST, IF ANY PERSON (S),LEGAL HEIR(S), CLAIMANT(S), OR ANY OTHER PARTY HAVING ANY RIGHT, TITLE, INTEREST, CLAIM, OR OBJECTION IN RESPECT OF THE ABOVE-MENTIONED PROPERTY BY WAY OF INHERITANCE, SALE, MORTGAGE, LIEN, GIFT, POSSESSION, OR OTHERWISE, HOWSOEVER AND OF WHATSOEVER NATURE IS HEREBY REQUIRED TO CONTACT TO THE UNDER SIGNEE IN WRITING WITH SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS THERE OF WITHIN SEVEN DAYS FORM THE DATE OF PUBLICATION OF THIS PUBLIC NOTICE, OR ELSE ANY SUCH OBJECTION/ CLAIM SHALL NOT BE CONSIDERED AND SHALL BE DEEMED TO HAVE BEEN WAIVED AND/OR ABANDONED, AND NO CLAIM SHALL BE ENTERTAINED THEREAFTER AND THE TRANSACTION SHALL BE COMPLETE WITHOUT ANY FURTHER REFERENCE.

ANUJ KUMAR GOEL (ADVOCATE)
CH. NO.319, LAWYERS CHAMBER BLOCK,
ROHINI DISTRICT COURT, DELHI-110085
E-MAIL: advanuj2000@gmail.com
MOB NO.: 9654315397

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page

The Indian EXPRESS
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

L. No. Dy. CE-JHSW-99 Date : 18.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Engineer/ workshop/ Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invite "Open Tender" through On Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: DY-CE-JHSW-99, **Description of work:** Construction of New Tank Wagon office along with Deluxe toilet in Wagon Repair Workshop Jhansi.

Approx Cost (₹): 54,28,541.60 (Fifty Four Lakh Twenty Eight Thousand Five Hundred Fourty One Rupees And Sixty Paisa Only)

Earnest Money (₹) : 1,08,600/- **Cost of Tender Form (₹):** NIL

Date of closing of Tender: 11.08.2026 At 15:30 hrs.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months

Note: For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in**. **1658/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Pankaj @ Lambu S/o Jugal Kishore R/o H. No. 912, A Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 42/2022, U/s 25/54/59 Arm Act, Dated 07.01.2022, PS Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Pankaj @ Lambu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Pankaj @ Lambu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Pankaj @ Lambu** of case **FIR No. 42/2022, U/s 25/54/59 Arm Act, Dated 07.01.2022, PS Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **14.10.2026.**

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9846/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Akash Malawat S/o** Sh. Harish Malawat **R/o** H. No. 25, Gali No. 25, L- Block Sangam Vihar New Delhi **Also At:** Village - Rajpur, Tehsil Distt. Kekri Rajasthan has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 374/2023 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act IPC PS: Neb Sarai Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akash Malawat** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akash Malawat** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Akash Malawat** accused of **FIR No. 374/2023 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act IPC PS: Neb Sarai Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Devanshi Janmeja
JMFC-03, Room No. 212
Saket Court, Delhi

DP/9962/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

ENGINEERING WORKS UNDER ALIPURDUAR DIVISION

E-Tender Notice No.: 35/W-2/APDJ; Dated: 14-07-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work: **Tender No:** 10-AP-III-2026. **Name of Work:** "Repairing of damaged protection work of Bridge No. 79 at Km 37/7-9 (Span-5×18.3m), Br. No.- 91 at km-42/4-7 (Span-7×18.3 m), Br. No.-132 at km-59/8-9 (span-3×45.70m), Br. No.-73 at km-33/8-9 (span-1×4+8×2.60), Br. no.-76 at km-35/1-2 (span-4×6.10) & Br. no.-173 at km 79/0-1 (span2×6.10+2×12.20) Under the Jurisdiction of SSE/Works/MBZ. Tender Value: ₹4,31,39,850.55; Earnest Money: ₹8,62,800.00. E-tender will be **closed** at 15:00 hrs. on 05-08-2026 and **opened** at 15:30 hrs. on 05-08-2026. The complete information with the tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website **http:// www.ireps.gov.in**

DRM (Works), Alipurduar Jn.
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE No. ELG-08R1-M05-2026-27 Date: 17.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N.C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites **"Open Tender"** through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No. ELG-08R1-M05-2026-27

Name of work with its location & Completion Period: Electrification work in connection with 50 Room (100 Beds) at NDLS for decongestion at MSRR NDLS due to existing dormitory rooms.,

Completion period- 08 months

Approx. Cost of the work: Rs.7913389.06

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in**. Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:00** hrs on **14.08.2026.** **1662/26 (D)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Akash Malawat S/o Harish Malawat R/o H. No. 25, Street No. 25, L-Block, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi** also at **Village Rajpur, Teh. & Distt. Kekri, Rajasthan** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 374/2023, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Neb Sarai, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Akash Malawat** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Akash Malawat** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Akash Malawat** of case **FIR No. 374/2023, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Neb Sarai, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **19.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Devanshi Janmeja
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
South, Court Room No. 212
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/9906/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

GUJARAT MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Gujarat Undertaking)
Regd. Office: Block No. 14/1,
Dr. Jivraj Mehta Bhavan, Sector-10, Gandhinagar
☎ 079-23250767, 23250766, 23257698

TENDER NOTICE NO:GMSCL/ D-33/2026-27

Tenders are invited online from reputed Manufacturers/formulators/ Direct importers for Surgical Item on Rate contract basis and details of specification, quantity is available on, https://gmscl.gujarat.gov.in All tender documents can be downloaded free on the website: https://tender.nprocure.com Interested bidders are requested to submit the tender through e-tender process.

Duration of downloading of tender document (online):- 18/07/2026 to 03/08/2026 up to18.00 Hrs

Last date for Submission (online): **03/08/2026** up to **18-00 HRS**

Last date for submission of EMD/Tender Fee (Physical) : **04/08/2026 upto 18:00 HRS**

Due Date and Time of Physical Submission of Samples: **04/08/2026** upto **18:00 HRS**

Opening of Technical Bid Date (online): **06/08/2026** At **15-00 HRS.**

Pre-Consultation meeting (Pre-Bid)

Interested Manufactures/formulators/Direct Importers are requested to remain present for pre- Consultation meeting to be held on 23/07/2026 at 11.30 am at Committee room at above mentioned address. Only one representative from each Manufacturer carrying authority letter would be allowed to participate in the pre-bid.

INF-928-2026-27 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-Tender for the following works before 15:00hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30hrs. **Sl No.(1) Tender No: E-KGP- EAST-45-2026; Description of works** : Howrah - Kharagpur : Provision of subways, Height Gauge, Drain in different locations in connection with speed 130kmph and above.(Route-A) under Sr DEN/East/KGP; **Tender value:** ₹ 32,11,56,590.52; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 64,23,100.00; **Sl No.(2) Tender No: E-KGP-EAST-46-2026; Description of works**:Provision of track machine siding line with all infrastructure (11 stations) Scope - Bauria, Bagnan, Mecheda, Amta, Haur, Bhogpur, Uluberia, Nalpur, Chengail, Balichak & Madpur. under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 50,68,73,417.94; **Earnest Money** : 1,01,37,500.00; **Sl. No. (3) Tender No: E-KGP- EAST-47-2026; Description of works:** Construction/ Improvement of approach road at Shyam Chak, Radhamohanpur, Haur, Khirai, Panskura, Narayan Pakuria Murail, Bhogpur, Nandaigajan P.H., Mecheda, Ghoraghata, Bauria, Nalpur & Abada (13) under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 7,34,98,786.42; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 14,70,000.00; **Sl. No. (4) Tender No: E-KGP-EAST-48-2026; Description of works**:Howrah - Kharagpur - Provision of platform shelter at 19 Stations under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP; **Tender value:** ₹ 31,16,15,296.85; **Earnest Money:** ₹ 62,32,300.00; **Sl No. (5) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-29-2026; Description of works**: Modernization/ Upgradation of infrastructure of Kharagpur Goods Shed under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP.; **Tender value:** ₹ 2,53,53,470.10; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 5,07,100.00; **Sl No. (6) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-30-2026; Description of works**: Execution of the work:- (1)Kharagpur Yard : Correction of layout at West & East end by shifting conversion & slew of lines and removal of existing Scissors Cross Over, (2) Nimpura Yard: Rectification of defective layout of Point at R/Yard & faulty layout correction of points at Through yard & D-Cabin, under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 3,65,39,283.54 ; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 7,30,800.00; **Sl. No. (7) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-31-2026; Description of works**: Midnapore yard modification under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 7,78,97,863.72; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 15,58,000.00 ; **Sl No. (8) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-32-2026; Description of works**: Development of Satellite Depot facility at Kharagpur for maintenance of Track Machines under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 7,24,99,175.23 ; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 14,50,000.00; **Sl No.(9) Tender No: E-KGP-HQ-29-2026** ; **Description of works**: Development of new passenger halt station named Chandipur between Kalikakhali (KLKL) & Lavan Satyagraha Smarak (LSGS) station along with Construction of new Platform, Retaining wall, Booking office, Station road & Hand tube well etc. in Tamluk-Digha section under the jurisdiction of ADEN/TMZ.; **Tender value:** ₹ 2, 16,68,301.08 ; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 4,33,366.00 ; **Sl No.(10) Tender No: E-KGP- HQ-30- 2026; Description of works**: Transportation of P.Way materials by road from different places for track renewal works in Panskura-Haldia and Tamluk-Digha section under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN(HQ)/KGP (2nd Call). **Tender value:** ₹ 1,96,30,742.23 ; **Earnest Money** : ₹ 3,92,600.00 ; **Cost of tender document**: ₹ 0.00 (for Sl. No. 1 to 10); **Date of Opening** : 12/08/2026 (for Sl. No. 1 to 10); **Completion Period of The Work:**12 Months (for Sl. No. 1 to 10); **Bidding Start Date:** For Sl. No. 1 to 10 from 29/07/2026 and up to 15:00 hrs. on 12/08/2026. Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/descriptions/ specifications of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **"www.ireps.gov.in"** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-495)**

कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम सतना (म.प्र.)

क्र. 01 (E.T.) /SBM/ न.पा.नि./ 2026-27 सतना, दिनांक 17.07.2026

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

नगर पालिक निगम, सतना द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्रीयकृत प्रणाली में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से ऑन लाइन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट https://www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

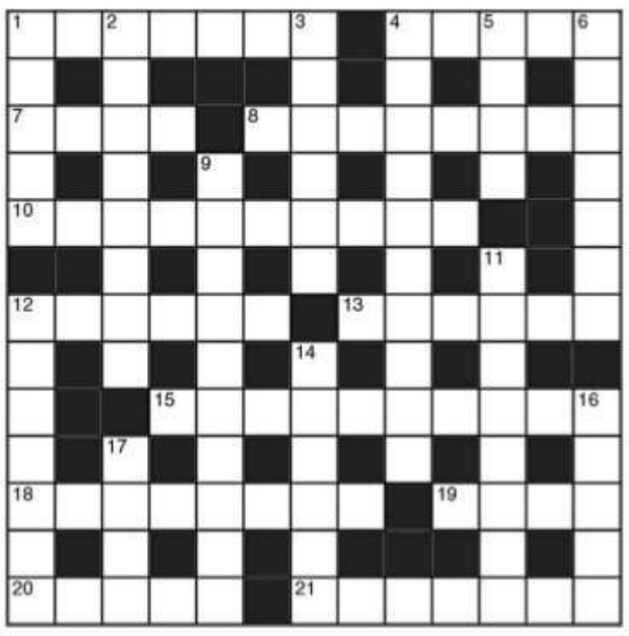
क्र.	निविदा क्र. व जारी दिनांक	टेण्डर क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत	अमानत राशि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य की समयावधि
01	01 17.07.2026	2026_UAD_522305_1	स्वच्छ भारत मिशन (शहरी) - 2.0 के तहत निगम क्षेत्रान्तर्गत विभिन्न स्थानों में सामुदायिक शौचालय एवं मूत्रालयों का निर्माण।	1,19,20,273/-	1,19,300/-	12,500/-	06 माह

शर्तें:-

1. निविदा प्रपत्र वेबसाईट https://www.mptenders.gov.in पर दिनांक 18.07.2026 समय 10.30 से दिनांक 17.08.2026 समय 17.30 बजे तक ऑनलाईन भुगतान करने पर प्राप्त हो सकेगा।
2. निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन का प्रकाशन ऑनलाईन https://www.mptenders.gov.in की वेबसाईट पर ही किया जावेगा, पृथक से समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशन नहीं किया जावेगा।

Sd/-
कार्यपालन यंत्री
नगर पालिक निगम, सतना (म.प्र.)

CROSSWORD 6046



ACROSS

1 Holder of the colours (7)
4 It's put on a horse that's a sure thing (5)
7 It's kept in cellars (4)
8 Returns from work? (8)
10 So I'd tip her for a top post in journalism (10)
12 Pensive — about wanting a family? (6)
13 Means business (6)
15 Put on the rack and extracted information? (4,3,3)
18 Sort of contest that goes on in the ring (4-4)
19 A direction to lower a boat (4)
20 Open award (5)
21 Bore fruit but abandoned (7)

DOWN

1 Beat with a stick (5)
2 Crush pill in pool to make confection (8)
3 Please pass another way (6)
4 Gin cocktail a constituent of happy party (10)
5 They have good reason to renounce the world (4)
6 His conservative report of events (7)
9 Spanner used by motorists (4,6)
11 Compelled to use violence in the end (8)
12 Favourable publicity for high-rise construction (5-2)
14 Score is two love (6)
16 Dragged to the altar? (5)
17 It turns on an opponent (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6045 ACROSS: 1 Quarterdeck, 9 Hold out, 10 Owlet, 11 Watt, 12 Parsifal, 14 Fisher, 16 Degree, 18 Academic, 19 Acme, 22 Drive, 23 Asphalt, 24 Past masters DOWN: 2 Unlit, 3 Room, 4 Extras, 5 Doorstep, 6 Call for, 7 Show of hands, 8 At all events, 13 Reverent, 15 Stamina, 17 Cicada, 20 Chair, 21 Spot.

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Don't try to solve ____ ____ in the middle of the night
- Philip K Dick (7,7)

IAEER

CHWITT

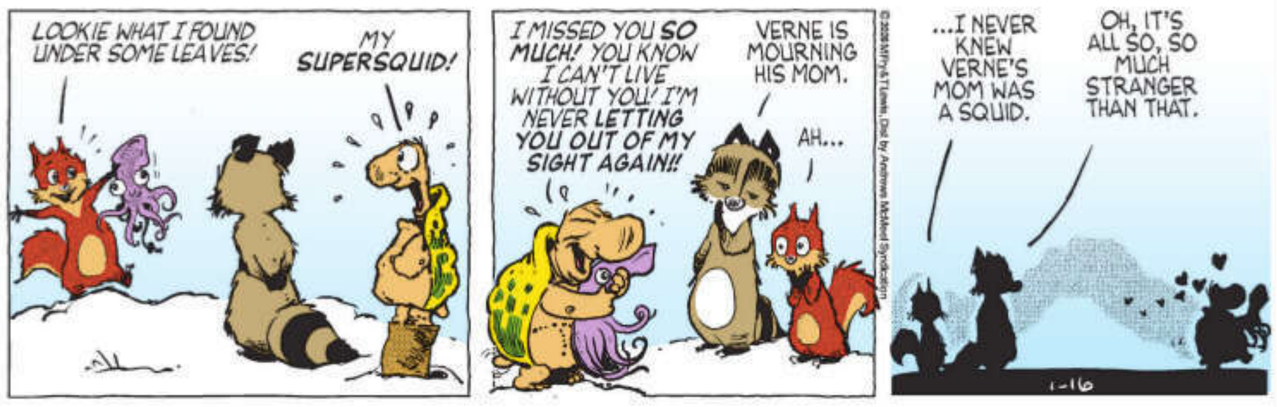
DORSS

HILMSU

SOLUTIONS: Aerie, Dross, Twitch, Mulish
ANSWER: Don't try to solve serious matters in the middle of the night
- Philip K Dick

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON

MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6386

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

	4				2	9		1
		3	4		7	8		
	7			9		3	6	
3	2		5			4		7
			6		3			
5		4			9		8	3
	3	7		5			4	
		9	1		8	2		
6		1	2				5	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6385

2	7	9	5	4	3	8	1	6
1	6	4	8	2	9	3	5	7
8	3	5	6	7	1	2	4	9
9	4	6	2	3	5	7	8	1
3	8	7	9	1	4	6	2	5
5	1	2	7	8	6	9	3	4
4	5	8	3	6	7	1	9	2
6	9	3	1	5	2	4	7	8
7	2	1	4	9	8	5	6	3

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Financial speculation might be rewarding today. Expect surprise invitations to socialise. You also might suddenly decide about a vacation or a future sports event. Relations with kids will be spontaneous and fun. Tonight: Check your finances.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Avoid power struggles with partners, spouses and close friends today. Something special, favourable or financially attractive might benefit your family today. You might buy something for your home. You might receive a gift. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Short trips and chances to meet new faces and places will please you today. Work-related discussions might be challenging. Steer clear of subjects like politics and religion. Tonight: Get organised.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): You might suddenly make more money or get a bit richer for some reason. If you have a chance to pursue a new job offer or ask for a raise, do it. Be patient with your kids and romantic partners to avoid arguments. Tonight: Socialise.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): An encounter with a friend or a member of a group might surprise you today. It will turn out to be something other than what you expected. It will increase your connections. Perhaps you will meet a new friend. Meanwhile, be patient at home. Tonight: Relax.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Avoid arguments with daily contacts, siblings and relatives, especially if you are trying hard to convince others to agree with you. Focus on some inner realisations that might occur. Listen to your inner world. Tonight: An interesting discussion.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Friendship might delight you today. You'll become involved with an organisation or club. Whatever happens will be unexpected and sudden. Avoid disagreements. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today you might give in to impulsive or compulsive behaviour. You also might encounter an emotional power struggle with someone. Something unexpected favours you! Tonight: You win.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Unexpected opportunities to travel might fall in your lap today. If so, act quickly, because this window of opportunity will be brief. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Avoid money squabbles today or arguments about possessions. Keep your eyes open, because you might benefit in practical ways or financial ways through the wealth and resources of someone else. Or you might get money back from the government. Could be anything. Tonight: Be friendly.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You're high-viz today, which is why it's in your best interest not to have a public argument somewhere. Focus on partnerships and close relationships. Something unexpected will delight you. Be open to whatever happens. Tonight: You're admired.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Steer clear of controversial subjects today because they could become emotionally charged. This is a great day to suddenly improve your health or your job. Your chance to do so will have a very short window. Be prepared to act fast. Tonight: Explore.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

PNB recently signed an MoU with the Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD) at its corporate office in Dwarka, New Delhi. The MoU was formalized in the presence of M. Paramasivam, ED, PNB; Amitabh Nag, CEO, Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD); & Atish Kumar Rout, CGM Digital Banking Transformation Division (DBTD), PNB. Through this partnership, BHASHINI's advanced multilingual AI capabilities will be integrated into PNB's digital platforms.

IREDA Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty, Chairman & MD & Director (Finance), IREDA align with Deepak Kumar Barik, ED (Law & HR), dedicated the company stall at Bada Danda near Gundicha Temple, Puri during the 9 days' Rath Yatra of Lord Jagannath. The stall will function till 24th July during Jagannath Yatra serving devotees attending the Chariot Festival. Besides, IREDA is distributing water and food to pilgrims, while creating awareness among devotees.

PMFME The Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises Scheme was launched under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan. The scheme reflects a conviction of our Prime Minister and the credit - linked component of PMFME has crossed two lakh sanctions. It is an achievement worth celebrating, and a moment to honour those who made it possible. By enabling ordinary Indians to build enterprises and employ others, PMFME is carrying forward the Prime Minister's vision of turning job-seekers into job-creators.

IRTC Following the resignation of Sanjay Kumar Jain as Chairman & MD, IRCTC, the Ministry of Railways has assigned the additional charge of CMD to Rahul Himalian, Director (Tourism & Marketing), IRCTC. A 1999-batch IRTS officer with over 26 years of experience, he has been serving on the IRCTC Board since February 2024 and oversees Tourism, IT, HRD, Infrastructure, Administration and Rajbhasha. He graduated in Electrical Engineering with a Gold Medal from NIT Hamirpur &completed his post-graduation in Engineering from IIT Delhi. He was also awarded the prestigious President's Gold Medal for being the Best All-Round Student.

PSB Punjab & Sind Bank has recently donated a state-of-the-art Hemodialysis Machine to District Hospital, Tanakpur, under its CSR initiative. Hon. CM of Uttarakhand inaugurated the machine during the Uttarakhand Dialogue CSR 2026 programme, in the presence of the MD & CEO of Punjab & Sind Bank & other dignitaries. The installation of the Hemodialysis Machine at District Hospital, Tanakpur signifies the hospital's strength in dialysis services, providing quality services to patients suffering from kidney-related ailments.

DPP Union Minister of State Dr. Jitendra Singh addressed the plenary session of the 2nd National Workshop on Pension Litigation in New Delhi on recently. The workshop brought together nodal officers, panel counsels & legal experts from various Ministries & Departments to strengthen pension litigation management. Discussions focused on addressing recurring issues such as delays in pension benefits, family pension, rule interpretation and pension disparities to reduce litigation through better coordination and timely redressal.

GAIL The ormalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises Scheme was launched under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan. The scheme reflects a conviction of our Prime Minister and the credit - linked component of PMFME has crossed two lakh sanctions. It is an achievement worth celebrating, and a moment to honour those who made it possible. By enabling ordinary Indians to build enterprises and employ others, PMFME is carrying forward the Prime Minister's vision of turning job-seekers into job-creators.

ICG The Indian Coast Guard has successfully completed the Factory Acceptance Trials of India's first indigenously-manufactured Marine Jet Power waterjets in Goa. Developed under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative through a technology transfer from MJP AB Sweden, the systems will power 14 Fast Patrol Vessels being built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders, marking a major boost to indigenous defence manufacturing. Established through a Transfer of Technology arrangement with MJP AB Sweden, the facility is a dedicated manufacturing and testing centre for advanced waterjet propulsion systems in India.

UGB Uttarakhand Marking the traditional festival of Harela, Uttarakhand Gramin Bank organised a plantation drive at GIC Gujrada Man Singh, Dehradun. More than 100 officers and employees participated in the initiative, planting saplings of various species and pledging to care for them. Senior bank officials, including General Managers Rajeev Prakash and Ashish Gupta, were present, reaffirming the bank's commitment to environmental conservation.

NHPC NHPC Limited, in association with PM Kendriya Vidyalaya No. 2, Faridabad, recently organised a Van Mahotsav under the Mission LiFE & 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam 3.0' campaigns, promoting the theme "One Child – One Sapling." NHPC CMD Bhupender Gupta, along with Sanjay Kumar Singh, Director (Technical) Suprakash Adhikari,Director (Finance & Personnel) Mahesh Kumar Sharma, Chief Patron of the NHPC Mahila Kalyan. Samiti, Shikha Gupta & senior officials, participated in the event. Addressing the gathering, Gupta stressed that environmental conservation is a shared responsibility & urged everyone to plant more trees. He also highlighted the importance of instilling environmental values in children and appreciated the students' creative presentations on nature conservation.

ALLEN CAREER INSTITUTE ALLEN has inducted Aviral Maheshwari, Anand Maheshwari and Keshav Maheshwari to its Board of Directors, marking a key milestone in its long-term institutional journey. The move aligns with the founders' vision of building a future-ready institution that contributes to India's education ecosystem. The new directors will bring fresh perspectives while working alongside the founders and professional leadership team to support ALLEN's next phase of growth and its vision for the next century.

CEO OF MBDA MBDA has appointed Jean-Brice Dumont as Chief Executive Officer, effective 1 November 2026, succeeding Eric Béranger. Dumont joins from Airbus Defence and Space with over 14 years of leadership experience across Airbus and a strong track record in leading major aerospace and defence programmes. He succeeds Eric Béranger, whose seven-year tenure saw significant growth in MBDA's revenue, workforce, order book, and position as a leading European defence company. Commenting on his appointment, Jean-Brice Dumont said he was honoured to lead MBDA at a pivotal time for European defence and looked forward to building on the company's strong foundation, innovation, and people to meet future challenges.

CCIC The Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India, under the Ministry of Textiles, is showcasing India's rich handloom, handicraft and sustainable lifestyle heritage at Bharat Tex from 14- 17 July at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. The Cottage Pavilion was inaugurated by Textile Secretary Neelam Shami Rao, who also launched CCIC's latest product catalogue featuring authentic, artisan-made products sourced from craft clusters across the country. The exhibition aims to connect Indian artisans and weavers with domestic and international buyers while promoting traditional craftsmanship and sustainable products on a global platform.

GAIL As a part of nationwide observance of Swachhata Pakhwada 2026, GAIL has recently undertaken a series of cleanliness, hygiene and community engagement initiatives across its offices, plants, project sites and operational locations throughout the country. The fifteen days campaign reflects GAIL's continued commitment towards promoting environmental responsibility. During the observance, GAIL organized a wide range of activities such as cleanliness drives, Swachhata Pledge ceremonies, awareness rallies, tree plantation programmes, waste segregation campaigns, health check-up camps & many more. Deepak Gupta, CMD, GAIL, & Ayush Gupta, Director (HR), GAIL, along with GAIL employees, participated in a cleanliness drive at Bhikaji Cama Place, New Delhi, as part of the Swachhata Pakhwada initiative.

REC REC Ltd, under the Ministry of Power, has renewed its ISO 31000:2018 Letter of Recognition for Risk Management Guidelines following a comprehensive reassessment by the BSI. The recognition reaffirms REC's commitment to globally benchmarked enterprise risk management practices and organisational resilience. The assessment evaluated REC's Enterprise Risk Management framework against evolving regulatory requirements, emerging risks and industry best practices. REC had become the first Indian public sector NBFC to receive this recognition in July 2025, reinforcing its leadership in institutionalising a robust risk management framework.

SC DAV Public School, Noida organized a teacher training session on "Inclusive Classrooms: Identifying and Supporting Students with Special Needs". Led by experts Ms. Swati Jain, Counseling Psychologist, and Ms. Ananya, Special Educator, the workshop aimed to sensitize teachers to inclusive education. The key objectives of the session were special needs, recognizing classroom 'red flags', understanding early intervention, and implementing practical strategies. It also covered neurodiversity, ADHD, autism, learning disabilities, giftedness, and 21 disabilities under the RPWD Act and CBSE policies.

"I just want the new generations to see my example as an opportunity – when you go down, you can rise again. This is my philosophy for my entire life." **RODRI**, SPAIN MIDFIELDER

423 Spain touched the ball over 400 times more than Argentina, a marker of their total hold on the game. The victors had 20 shots on goal, as against Argentina's two

Spanish players celebrate with the trophy after outclassing Argentina 1-0 in the FIFA World Cup 2026 final. *La Roja* were crowned champions for the second time. AP

On pass-masters, and the space-masters who came after

EXPRESS AT WORLD CUP

Sandip G
New Jersey, July 20

Spain, Rodri, and the argument that a second golden generation has already begun

WITH HIS headmaster-like demeanour, Spain's manager Luis de la Fuente waited patiently to lay his hands on the most prized sporting trophy in the world. He was in no haste, perhaps because he knew the trophy would be his and the wondrous band he has assembled would remain in contention for the next four years; perhaps he is fascinated more by the journey than the destination, or maybe he knows his team is not yet finished piling trophies onto the federation's mantlepiece.

He, and the whole world, could see the tidings of a footballing dynasty that could rule the world for the next decade. The second Spanish dynasty of the century, and as artful and delightful as the previous iteration, the tiki-takians.

The route to the crown was flawless, steadily raising their tempo from a goalless draw against Cabo Verde to the remorseless annihilation of a magnificent France to gently dismembering the fight and bravado of Argentina, the defending champions, the men of moments. In the post-match presentation, de la Fuente stressed on "being faithful to our idea of football" without ever directly detailing what that idea was. There is no clearly defined or perceptible ideology here, the way there was with tiki-taka during their reign. Perhaps their idea is amorphous, too broad to pin down to a specific act.

But their leitmotif is clear: to minimise the variables of knockout football and make themselves near-unbeatable, to wrap themselves in invincibility. To entirely suck the risk out of the game, not by refraining from attacking football and parking the bus, but by ensuring that everything is in order, the shape and structure, the creaks and crumples covered, like a freshly ironed suit.

To kill teams softly, to marinate them on a slow fire, draining their hope drip by drip. It's the most brutal murder, because they concede no chance of survival. They have not produced thrillers, because their game is fine-tuned to such precision that they avoid wild fluctuations. They have never been in a crisis, because their vision is not to wait for one but to avoid it altogether, through dynamism in pressing and clarity in thinking, passing and positioning.

> ***If their backline is impenetrable, the midfield is unbreakable, and the forward line uncontainable when in full flow***

If their backline is impenetrable, the midfield is unbreakable, and the forward line uncontainable when in full flow. The level of sustained concentration required to defend against them, attack them, or overpower their midfield is almost indecent. Their defence wore down Cristiano Ronaldo, Kevin De Bruyne, Kylian Mbappe, Michael Olise and Lionel Messi. Only once has their backline been breached in the whole tournament. Only 43 shots have been attempted against them. The midfield outclassed all and sundry; the pack of forwards took turns to strike. Goals sprung from everywhere, they had seven different goalscorers. Every match had a different hero, yet there is little arrogance or ego. They can't be conquered mentally, physically or tactically.

No theatrics needed

A flimsy argument could be raised that they don't thrill, that their game is bereft of flourishes, more opera than heavy metal, even with a spirit as blithe as Yamal's. The truth is they are so evolved that they need no theatrical embellishment or showmanship to assert their supremacy. They will be celebrated as a team that engaged the brain more than the soul, a connoisseur's delight rather than a layman's.

Watch closer, and there is a contained beauty in every stride they take. The half-turns of Dani Olmo, the torqued first touches of Yamal, the gorgeous pass-reading of Pau Cubarsi, the svelte, slick passing patterns, their graceful control of emotions, the surreal serenity in times of crisis (if at all they face one), the geometric passing style has a Euclidean mastery to it.

There could have been more entertaining teams, more romantic ones. But maybe not a more perfect one. As perfect as the tiki-taka era, when they collected three trophies in four years. De la Fuente's group could match that, even surpass it, and transform into a footballing dynasty. The nucleus is still young, the average age is 26.2. The two most important cogs in the title triumph were 19-year-olds, Yamal and Cubarsi. They could rule football for a decade, with more talent still to spring from the vibrant youth academies of Barcelona, Atletico, Villarreal and Real Madrid (even though there was no Madrid player in the squad).

If the 2008-12 vintage, the team that post-modernised the game, had two pass-masters of virtuosic grandeur in Xavi Hernandez and Andres Iniesta, de la Fuente's batch had the irresistible Rodri, the team's ticking heartbeat. His stifling of Messi was a defensive masterclass. Messi turned him once early on, but thereafter Rodri pushed him into an airless chamber, suffocating him like a boa constrictor, tightening his grip over the greatest player ever and making it harder and harder for him to breathe. If Xavi and co. were pass-masters, Rodri and friends are space-masters. He is a role model in his words as much as his deeds. "I just want the new generations to see my example as an opportunity – when you go down you can rise again. This is my philosophy my entire life," he said after the game. His advice to his players was simple: "We need to face them. We have to look into their eyes and see it. We win this game, and then life gives you the World Cup, or not."

In every sense, they could make a compelling case to be one of the greatest teams ever. The debates will no doubt escalate. The Brazil of 1970 is the romantic ideal. Or the French dazzlers led by Zinedine Zidane. Or Spain's own golden generation. De la Fuente's men belong rightly in that pantheon of greats, for the graceful efficiency with which they minimised the variables of knockout football and made themselves near-unbeatable. And their era is far from nearing its end.

853 passes, one goal and total control: How Spain won World Cup

SPAIN'S WORLD CUP final victory went as their tournament had. Luis de la Fuente championed a Spanish squad built on an unyielding defensive structure from the back – one which provided the dual engine of being one-third of Spain's possession providers, and snuffing out any buildup of chances in their midfield itself. That bedrock of their football was never challenged by Argentina in a final that was going only one way.

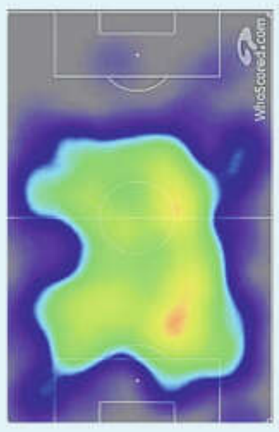
Touches, passes & not giving away the ball

SPAIN WERE not going to give the ball up. Lionel Scaloni wasn't even going to try – he said so by relegating his best midfielder, Leandro Paredes, to the bench. France had suffered the consequences of what happened when you dared to try to take on the Spanish.

Spain passed the ball 853 times in the final – to put it into context, they passed the ball 715 times in the 2010 World Cup final against the Netherlands with Xavi, Andrés Iniesta and Sergio Busquets running that midfield. In yesterday's final, Spain touched the ball over 400 times more than Argentina, again a marker of their abject hold of the game.

Rodri-Cubarsi-Laporte's Bermuda Triangle

NO WORLD CUP has ever seen the defensive influence of three players quite like the Spanish centre-back pairing of Pau Cubarsi, Aymeric Laporte and deep-lying midfielder Rodri. They took 359 of the 1091 total Spanish touches in the final. Their hold on two-thirds of the entire MetLife Stadium pitch was absolute. Giving up only a goal in an entire World Cup campaign, an all-time tournament record, is an act of complete and total authority. Rodri's Golden Ball and Cubarsi's Young Player award rightfully acknowledge where Spain won this World Cup.



This area was where a third of Spanish touches came from Cubarsi, Laporte, Rodri.

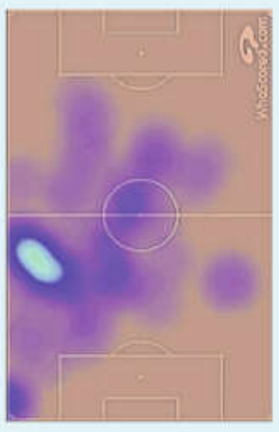
Total authority in attack

SPAIN'S IRONCLAD control led to 20 shots, with twelve of them on target. Argentina recorded a mere two attempts, one from Lionel Messi and one from Simeone, both coming deep in extra time after Ferran Torres had given Spain the lead.

Argentina held their end of the bargain, defending violently and doggedly. 12 of Spain's 20 attempts came from outside the box, as Scaloni set his team's blockade with an eye to not allow Spain a high number of good quality attempts at goal. But in the end, Argentina brought the same pressure onto themselves against Spain that they had watched England invite onto themselves in the semi-final.

Messi completely shut down

LOST IN a match with few touches (56) and even fewer influences, Lionel Messi remained closer to the touchline and the crowds than the Spanish goal. The 39-year-old ran over ten kilometres in the final, the fifth-highest among his teammates, but was relegated to defensive duties, and one stinging shot late in the game was blocked by Mikel Merino. Both Messi and Alvarez rarely saw entries into the Spanish box and were relegated to an afternoon of being the first line of Argentina's defence. A tough, possibly final day in the office for Messi, who is now 1-for-3 in FIFA World Cup finals.



Lionel Messi was largely relegated to defensive work, as depicted in this heatmap.

*HEATMAPS FROM WHOSCORED.COM

SHASHANK NAIR

● BROTHERS IN ARMS

Williams & Torres: A tale of immigration, a battle with depression

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 20

105:28. NEW JERSEY.

Final of the World Cup. 0-0.

Nahuel Molina glanced over his shoulder. Nico Williams lingered a few yards behind. Should a cross arrive from the opposite flank, Argentina's right-back assumed he would have it covered.

Molina set himself to meet Pedro Porro's delivery. Then came the chill. Williams was no longer behind him. He was in front. Molina had been beaten by the sprint.

It is what Williams does. Second among Spaniards on top speed, third on number of sprints per 90 minutes.

He scores, creates, dribbles and dances. Mostly, though, he runs. He runs because two others once walked.

●●●

1994. Akim Oda, eastern Ghana.

Maria Comfort Arthur and Felix Williams wanted a life their jobs — hairdresser and electrician respectively — could not provide. England, they had learned, was a thriving hub for Ghanaian immigrants – Haringey, Southwark, Croydon.

"Go to Spain instead," suggested a friend. "It'll be a lot cheaper." Cheaper, it was. What they were not told, however, was the excruciating pain their 5,000-kilometre journey entailed. They would cross most of the Sahara Desert on foot. Temperatures touched 50°C. If sand could melt flesh and char bones, it would.

Nico always knew his father limped. Only later did he learn the injury originated in that desert.

Maria, three months pregnant with her elder son, Inaki, was convinced she would not make it to Spain. Along the path that crossed five nations — Burkina Faso, Niger, Algeria, Morocco, and finally, Spain — she would bury — literally, not metaphorically — many friends. In the hunt for a better life, many sacrificed the one they had.

She did, however, make it to Melilla — the autonomous Spanish city nestled in Morocco. Only to be caught by the civil guards. There would not have been a Spanish fairytale without the lawyer who suggested the Williams destroy every document that could trace them back to Ghana, and claim they had fled the Liberian civil war. Only this way would they be eligible to seek asylum.

Felix found work in a chicken slaughterhouse. Maria took whatever jobs she could — pizzeria, supermarket, airport. Inaki would become Athletic Bilbao's first Black star, and Nico one of the brightest talents the nation has ever produced.

The talent was displayed at the Euros. A goal in the final against England. This World Cup had been crueller — predominantly owing to injuries. Sports hernia at the start of the season, hamstring issues towards the end, and then a contact injury in the World Cup game against Uruguay.

"Today is one of the worst days of my life," he had said after the game, disconsolate. Sunday was one of his best.

●●●

105:33. New Jersey.

The angle was acute when Williams met Pedro Porro's cross, but the rare opportunity of being a national hero at 24 beckoned. Seductive as it was, he — perhaps to the surprise of Argentine goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez — laid off his header in the direction from where the ball had come.

Nico Williams (right) and Ferran Torres combined to net Spain's winning goal in the final. AP

Growing up, Williams had been raised on one maxim. It was his mother Maria's favourite saying, the one Iñaki has tattooed on his arm.

"If you want to go fast, go alone; if you want to go far, go together." Heroes are usually remembered for choosing themselves. Williams chose the better option. Ferran Torres.

●●●

2024. Barcelona, northeastern Spain. A rare season without a trophy. A 4-1 El Clasico defeat in the Supercopa de España. Same scoreline against Paris Saint-Germain in the Champions League.

When seasons unravel at Barcelona, blame rarely remains unclaimed. Ferran Torres became its custodian.

Signed for €65 million when the club could scarcely afford such extravagance, he had scored only 25 goals in his first 113 appearances. 0.22 per game.

The vitriol was relentless. Social media became a conveyor belt of ridicule.

Torres muted much of it, but not enough. He did not want to play football anymore. The joy had left him, and all that was left was an existential burden.

"I fell into a bottomless pit; I didn't know how to get out. I was at a place where I had lost all confidence in my abilities. When you're in that place, you have no desire to do anything. I even lost the joy of playing football."

Torres sought therapy.

Wait, a psychologist? Is football — the male variant, at least — not supposed to be all about machismo, masculinity, bravado? Why could Ferran not smash into someone to feel better, as Roy Keane would have it?

He never cared enough about stigma. Equally unashamedly, he declared himself a Swiftie, once naming Taylor Swift's Blank Space among his favourite songs.

'Oh my God, look at that face // You look like my next mistake.'

One could imagine Keane, if he were to discover these lyrics, twitching his eyebrows.

The sessions helped. In the next two seasons, he would score 40 goals in 94 matches. 0.43 per game.

"This (seeking a psychologist) should not be a taboo subject. I don't go to a psychologist because I am sick. I go to get a perspective outside of my family and inner circle, and to vent. Sometimes, letting your feelings out sets you free."

●●●

105:36. New Jersey.

Williams headed Porro's cross into the path of Torres. A stunning left-footed shot nestled into the roof of the net, past a scrambling Martinez and a helpless triad of Argentine defenders. Spain has the second star on the jersey — courtesy of their two stars.

One — a self-proclaimed 'citizen of the world' — broke the shackles of geographical borders. The other broke the shackles inside his mind.

Two escapists. Escaping into euphoria.

Gukesh blunders against Erigaisi to lose from a winning position

Amit Kamath
Chennai, July 20

AFTER ANOTHER day brought another defeat for the world champion there was one final act of cruelty that fate had in store for Gukesh D. He suffered his second loss at the Chennai Grand Masters 2026 tournament on Monday, losing to Arjun Erigaisi in a game that he was winning at one point but then allowed the game to equalise before resigning. When the game ended, a dejected Gukesh was mulling the loss in the lift back to his hotel floor. It was a moment where he would have wanted to be left completely alone. Instead, Erigaisi unwittingly entered the lift and Gukesh had to endure a few more seconds in the company of the man who had just compounded his misery.

Monday's defeat was Gukesh's second in five rounds of his home tournament; he previously lost to Firouzja in round 2. All his other games have been draws. He now has two final games left in the tournament. Defeat to Erigaisi saw Gukesh slump to sole last position in the standings with 1.5 points while Erigiasi is now the joint leader with Alireza Firouzja with 3.5 points.

It could have been so different. On move 23 of their battle, Gukesh held a winning position despite Erigaisi having an additional pawn on the board. Erigaisi's king on e8 was left in a vulnerable position and Gukesh's rook moved in from h1 to h8. Then Gukesh's bishop jumped in on d6. Here Erigiasi did well to defend, attacking Gukesh bishop with his rook. Gukesh's white bishop and Erigaisi's black rook danced around a couple of times before the 20-year-old had to avoid a threefold repetition.

Gukesh gave away his advantage when his bishop moved in from the other side to mount an attack. The game looked headed for a draw after that, till the 45th move when Gukesh's knight hop gave Erigaisi a slight edge.

But on move 54, with Gukesh courting deep time trouble, he moved his rook to f5 to deliver a check on Erigaisi's king. The engine showed that it had been a blunder and a significant one. The game had turned on its head.

Now Gukesh, with barely any time on his clock, would have to pull a rescue act. He could not manage that, even though he had an additional rook on the board compared to his opponent's bishop and two more pawns.

On the 63rd move, he resigned. Gukesh now faces the young Pranesh M, who comes from RB Ramesh's stables, on Tuesday before his final game against Hans Niemann.

TEARY FAREWELL

EOMessi Magic

Argentine's dream shattered as his last act on the grandest stage ends with a tragic twist, a reminder of triumph of collectivism over individual dazzle

Argentina great Lionel Messi reacts after losing to Spain in the World Cup final in New Jersey on Sunday. AP

Sandip G
New Jersey, July 20

EVEN THE bright sun over Metlife Stadium lost its glow a touch. The elements mourned with Lionel Messi, his dream shattered and his last act on the grandest stage ending with a tragic twist, reminding the world of the triumph of collectivism over individual dazzle.

He resisted tears, as he sat on the ground, crushed and crestfallen, the dream falling apart in front of his eyes. For once in the tournament, he could not flip the script of his fate, or of the team, or of the country. He dragged himself onto his feet, staggered towards the tunnel, unfeelingly accepting the hugs and handshakes of commiseration. But then he stopped amid the crowd, leaving their heartache aside, chorusing his name. He stopped and waved. He was consoling them. But something had to give away.

Messi cried, not perhaps for his personal anguish, but because he failed his countrymen this day. No one would crucify Messi for the defeat, he was the sole reason they reached this far, but only himself.

It's the price Messi had to pay for being Messi. Maybe, he would have wished he had farewelled in Qatar, his dream fulfilled, the destiny completed.

America was a gamble, but a beautiful one. When the winds of change sweep the debris of destiny away, the world would thank Messi for his last flicker, for the implacable sorrow he leaves the World Cup. Maybe, World Cups in the USA are meant for tragic heroes—Roberto Baggio in 1994 and Messi in 2026. Two men who ran solo shows until the last note fell awry.

More than the defeat, its nature would hurt him; the negligible bursts of creativity, the anarchic and callous defending, the clumsy tackles and disruptive fouls. A regimented defensive pack had bolted him, stripping him of ball and creativity. He could not create a single chance; he couldn't touch the ball even once inside the penalty box. Penetration and precision deserted his crossing and passing.

When Messi cried, the world around him cried too. Sections of the Argentina crowd literally wailed. In the press conference room, Lionel Scaloni choked for words and burst into uncontrollable sobs. He praised and thanked Messi. "I hope that everyone feels proud of him, of what he's achieved because he's the best football player ever to set foot on a pitch," he said. The world around Messi cried, too. His loss was theirs too. Even the Spain fans kept their celebrations on hold, to cheer for Messi. The music stopped. Only the most stone-hearted of spectators would have left unmoved by the poignancy of the moment.

But nothing would tarnish the legacy of Messi. Stripped off the immediacy of a defeat in the final, he was the World Cup's most defining personality. It's unfathomable to even imagine a footballer with two decades of sustained influence, of unwavering relevance, of singularly bearing the burden of his country's hope.

His idol Maradona's prime years were a decade at the most, with intermittent years of irrelevance. Pele's Brazil heyday spanned 14 years, in those days when football leagues were not as frenetic as it is now. There were Messis within Messi. The Messi that sprinted; the Messi that walked; the winger Messi; the false nine Messi; the playmaker Messi; the inside forward Messi; the saintly Messi; the provocateur Messi. Most footballers would contend if they could perform successfully in just one of these facets.

Messi would be wondering about the paradoxes of life. In his peak years, with a cast of stars beside him, his quadrennial expedition to the tournament ended in tears. Barring the final of 2014, Argentina's ousters were maddeningly premature and harrowingly miserable. He was drained and disillusioned, contemplating folding up his Argentina shirts forever. His misery was beyond tears, before emoting. Only the deepest chambers would fathom the pain and rage, the emptiness and frustration.

But the sporting middle age was kinder and sparkling. He was 35 in Qatar, most of his luminous teammates had departed, the manager was not an ideologue, but anonymous and uncelebrated, but in the winter of his career, he lit a torch of fire, an unstoppable, raging flame that rolled on endlessly. He retuned in only a way as he could. The supposedly flat-lined peak spiked again, like the undulating waves of a mighty ocean.

Athletes come with a use-by-date, a peak of 10, perhaps 15 years, before they wither. Even the great Roger Federer fought time, with all his heart and wits, yet he could never rekindle the spring of youth. Usain Bolt vanished with aching legs. Sporting glory is transient. Messi had been an exception, not in the way he has resisted age, but how he accepted the irreversible passage of time and continued to remould his game for productive longevity. But like Donald Bradman's last innings, Federers's final Wimbledon final, the last tune was tragic. Even sporting immortals are fallible. And the sun over Metlife lost its glow.

> ***America was a gamble, but a beautiful one. When the winds of change sweep the debris of destiny away, the world would thank Messi for his last flicker, for the implacable***

Emiliano Martinez makes a save off Nico Williams during Sunday's final. AP

The Argentina player with most touches: Their goalie

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, July 20

EVEN AMIDST the anti-football approach adopted by Argentina in the World Cup final, one man kept the Spanish armada at bay.

Emiliano 'Dibu' Martinez, a vital element in their two Copa America titles and the 2022 World Cup glory, was singularly responsible for keeping his team in the game for as long as he did. The golden glove winner from the 2022 edition of the World Cup cut a despondent figure as the Spaniards celebrated their second world title.

11 saves, 70 touches.

The first figure Martinez could be really proud of. The second, less so. Having the most touches after 120 minutes of football in a team with Lionel Messi, Julian Alvarez, and Enzo Fernandez doesn't paint a rosy picture of the team's display.

Martinez is known more for producing a performance of lifetime in the 2022 World Cup final, getting the better of elite strikers in psychological battles during penalty kicks. Out of the 11 saves he made on Sunday, a few were routine but his theatrics made every one of them eye-catching.

Martinez has an equal share of fans and critics in Argentina and at his club Aston Villa. He is comfortable being an antagonist or anti-hero in hostile stadiums and feeds off that energy. When he is in the middle of a tense situation, Martinez's nonchalance can throw opponents off guard. "What people think doesn't affect me. They can have all their opinions, good or bad, but I know who I am, the kind of person I am," he had said in 2025.

During the UEFA Europa League final against Lille in 2025-26, he was subjected to whistles and boos. He was reprimanded for his gestures against France during and after the 2022 World Cup final, that many found in poor taste. However, Martinez thrived on the energy that brought the best out of him.

"He thrives on the boos. He's been conditioned to steel himself against people who say 'You can't do it'. He gets into a mindset where negativity motivates him," former Aston Villa goalkeeper Mark Bosnich had told *The New York Times*.

The propensity to antagonise a bunch of people and use that energy for incredible performances has been a part of his upbringing in Mar de Plata, a coastal city on the Atlantic coast. One of his first coaches, Jorge Peta, revealed that he used to spill shots on purpose, so that the attacker could have more attempts.

"He always used to talk a lot. He used to do tricks as a kid. If he would feel unchallenged, he would spill easy shots so that strikers can strike more," Peta told AP.

However, the goalkeeping persona of Martinez was not the same when he arrived as a 20-year-old at Arsenal in 2012 and became the third-choice goalkeeper.

Eight years on the bench, six loans and being told that he wasn't first-choice created a chip on his shoulder and resulted in a feeling that he needed to impose himself.

"If you look through his career and where he's come from, he has a tinge of insecurity, which is understandable. I can understand why people think he's arrogant but it's insecurity disguised as arrogance. You don't achieve what Emi has done without confidence, but I know what it is because I was accused of arrogance and deep down, it wasn't that: it is confidence with a tinge of insecurity," Bosnich told *NYT*.

But if a player can't back the theatrics, payback arrives soon.

After moving to Villa from Arsenal, Martinez was called up to the Argentine national team in 2021 when was 30 years old. He became a national hero during the Copa America that year after his tactics helped them win the penalty shootout against Colombia in the semi-finals. Martinez's imposing figure was sometlhing Argentina could rely on as they won two consecutive continental titles, which sandwiched the 2022 World Cup triumph. Throughout the World Cup, whenever the team was in trouble, it was Messi who bailed them out. But on Sunday night, when he was kept quiet by Spain, it was Martinez who ensured La Albiceleste had a chance.

At 33, there is no guarantee he will return for the 2030 edition, but he will always be remembered as a goalkeeper who refused to shrink on the biggest stage. Even in defeat, Martinez ensured the spotlight did not move away from him.

Number plate

70 Emi Martinez had most touches among the 17 Argentines who took the field.

11 Number of saves Martinez made which is also the highest number of saves made in WC final.

20 Total number of saves made by Martinez in the tournament which placed him at joint-third.

> **"He (Martinez) thrives on the boos. He's been conditioned to steel himself against people who say 'You can't do it'. He gets into a mindset where negativity motivates him."**
>
> **MARK BOSNICH,** FORMER ASTON VILLA GOALKEEPER

Bumrah's absence exposes India's bowling depth

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, July 20

WHEN ROHIT Sharma admitted after Sunday's ODI series-decider defeat to England that India's bowling attack was "inexperienced", he was stating the obvious. Arshdeep Singh, Prince Yadav and Gurnoor Brar have played a combined 27 ODIs between them. But England's victory also exposed a deeper issue. India's reserve fast bowlers are still trying to master a format that has changed over the last few years.

Jasprit Bumrah's absence was always going to weaken India. Mohammed Siraj's absence only added to India's problems. But if they are to succeed without Bumrah before next year's World Cup, the question is not whether the backup seamers are inexperienced. It is whether they possess the skill set modern ODI cricket now demands.That, more than inexperience alone, is the challenge India's selectors and coaches must solve before the World Cup.

England's opening pair quickly exposed India's lack of control. Arshdeep found movement but lacked consistency, Prince sprayed the ball around, and Gurnoor Brar struggled after the powerplay. Duckett and Bethell simply waited for India to err before putting on 192 for the opening wicket.

It would be simplistic to blame the defeat solely on Bumrah's absence. But it reinforced how much India's attack depends on the contrasting skills of Bumrah and Siraj.

Bumrah remains arguably the most complete white-ball fast bowler. He offers swing, yorkers, pace variation and control. Siraj's hard lengths and three-quarter seam make scoring difficult even when wickets do not come. Sunday's attack showed flashes of those skills but not enough consistency.

Arshdeep remains one of the best new-ball swing bowlers in world cricket, but modern ODI batting often neutralises that early movement. Once the shine fades, bowlers need other weapons. Bumrah has yorkers, Siraj hard lengths and Mohammed Shami had reverse swing. Arshdeep is still developing that second skill, while India's backup seamers are yet to maximise the semi-new ball introduced after the 34th over.

Prince arrived with a reputation as a reverse-swing exponent, but India never generated that movement at Lord's. Prasidh recovered from a poor start to remove Bethell and Harry Brook before leaking runs at the death.

That should not overshadow what has otherwise been an encouraging ODI run. Since October 2025, Prasidh has picked up five wickets in the Powerplay at an economy of 4.96 and nine more through the middle overs at 6.04. He has also quietly established himself as one of India's more reliable death bowlers, claiming seven wickets in 10 matches at the end of the innings. Sunday, however, was one of those rare days when none of his strengths proved enough.

India are not facing a bowling crisis. Bumrah and Siraj's return will restore experience, but Sunday's defeat showed how quickly the quality drops in their absence.

With the World Cup just over a year away, India's biggest task is developing bowlers equipped for the demands of modern ODI cricket.

With stats inputs from Lalith Kalidas

> ***India are not facing a bowling crisis... but Sunday's defeat showed how quickly the quality drops in Bumrah's absence***

● ENDING A LONG DROUGHT

How a cryptic Kohli remark sparked Sindhu's revival

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, July 20

PV SINDHU once asked Virat Kohli how he dealt with the long wait for a century. The cricket star said he needed to rediscover the joy of scoring runs. Husband Venkata Datta Sai, listening in, noted the import of those words.

During a consultation with Dr Dinshaw Pardiwala a few months later, after snapping a toe ligament, Sindhu was put on a three-month complete rest. But she kept asking the doctor how soon she could return to the court. The surgeon took Datta aside and told him, "Look, there's no comeback for three weeks. She needs a break or she will burn out."

Datta booked the next flight to Atlanta, where his sister Amu lived, to whisk his wife away from the constant refrains of why she wasn't winning, and why she was even playing.

"We had to rebuild her joy," Datta recalls, "and Virat's words kept ringing in my head. At Atlanta's Exos Sports Performance facility, she trained with three excellent trainers. My sister would drive her to the facility everyday for 3 weeks for rehab and strengthening. We rekindled the love surrounded by family where she wasn't a star, just a regular person."

Datta insists the bedrock of Sindhu's resurgence is 'stability'. It's why 13 members of her support staff, each a specialist, had tears in their eyes when she won the Japan Open and flashed a wide smile on the podium. For Datta, every improvement is measured in numbers. The World No.7's support team is steeped in sports science. South African Wayne Lombard was brought in before the Paris Olympics, to devise a programme that helps prepare her for the challenges of being a 30+ athlete.

Coach Irwansyah was a critical addition, but Team Sindhu was clear she would need the backing of cutting edge science if she had to make good her 3.0 return.

"After the Paris Olympics, we pulled out data that revealed two things. The attacking mindset was down. And she was needing the second, third or fourth attack in a rally to get points against top players. So the chances of errors increased. And while she used to make two line judgments earlier, now she was taking six. She was 'hoping' to get easy points," Datta recalls.

Both pointed to low confidence in her fitness. Speed and strength needed shoring up.

He deployed seven devices last April-May, tweaking Sindhu's training and "hyper-controlling her load." Heart rate, sleep, sleep quality, stress levels in rally - everything was monitored every single hour.

Heera Mundluru came in as the physio, Shreyasi Sanjay was on strength and conditioning duty, while nutritionist Nicol Haria monitored every morsel.

It was 230 gm chicken (protein punishment) and an ice-cream ("which Sindhu loves") as a treat after winning the Japan Open. Reducing 3.5 kg in her 30s without reducing muscle mass was tough. "Even reducing 1 kg is tough. So we told Sindhu to not gain weight," Datta says.

On the Tour, even when she lost to Unnati Hooda at the China Open, the game reconstruction was underway. Sindhu, her husband claims, has VO2 Max numbers that belong to the top 1 percentile of female athletes in the world. Sindhu sits in red-light chambers for infrared therapy that top footballers use for recovery. "Recently, we had her on an inversion table just to get the blood flow (draining lactic acid). She sleeps on a temperature-controlled bed."

Datta insists that stability was behind zeroing in on Irwansyah as coach. With some like Park Tae-Sang, Sindhu had stagnated into a defensive rut. She had stopped training at the academy where Hafiz Hashim trained. Another Korean coach could train only on wages of $12,000 + expenses a month. So the churn continued, till Irwansyah arrived. "Our fear was that he was a men's singles coach, but he's been excellent," he says. Sindhu's net game has become a serious weapon. Irwansyah has brought in pushes and flat exchanges, improving Sindhu's reflexes so opponents don't trap her on defence.

"Players like An Se-young grew up on defensive games. So though we want to add to Sindhu's deceptive strokes, we can't ask her to change her footwork and micro-movements she has been used to for 22 years." Teaching Sindhu to create openings needed a show-and-teach approach. "We pulled videos to show she was getting restless to kill a shuttle." Snatching at shots and overhitting brought unforced errors.

Once she was convinced, Irwanshyah could drill in the patience. The World Championships are an immediate goal, but Team Sindhu isn't ruling out an LA28 medal. "You can quote me on this - we will go for gold," Datta says.

PV Sindhu along with coach Irwansyah. BWF/BADMINTON PHOTO

> **"After the Paris Olympics, we pulled out data that revealed two things. The attacking mindset was down. And she was needing the second, third or fourth attack in a rally to get points against top players."**
>
> **VENKATA DATTA SAI,** PV SINDHU'S HUSBAND

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